

Beaconhouse United Charter Schools



UNITED CHARTER
SCHOOLS
A Project of Beaconhouse

Franchise School Operations Manual

Rev : 00



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DOCUMENT HISTORY

Version	Approved By	
	Name & Designation	Date
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EXPLANATION OF TERMS AND ABBREVIATIONS

The explanations to the terms and abbreviations used in this Manual are as under:

Terms and Abbreviations	Explanation
BA	Branch Accountant
BDS	Bank Deposit Slip
BEAMS	Beaconhouse Enterprise Application Management System
BH	Branch Head / School Head – of Franchise Branch
Board	Board of Directors – Educational Services (Pvt.) Ltd.
BOQ	Bill of Quantities
BPC	Branch Purchase Committee
CEO	Chief Executive Officer (ESL)
CF	Conveyance Form
CNIC	Computerized National Identity Card
CP	Chairperson (ESL)
CSQ	Comparative Statement of Quotations (The expression Quotations include, Quotations, Bids and Tenders)
DD	Deputy Director UCS
DM	Deputy Manager
ERC	Employment Reference Check
ERF	Employee Requisition Form
ESL	Educational Services (Pvt.) Ltd.
FA	Fixed Assets
FI	Functional Incharge
FM	Franchise Management (BH / FO)
FO	Franchise Owner
GL	General Ledger
GRN	Goods Received Note
HF	Head Finance (ESL)
HHR	Head Human Resource (ESL)
HO	Head Office
HOD	Head of Department
HOTO	Handing Over / Taking Over
HR	Human Resource
HS&A	Head Systems & Audit
ICR	Income Classification Report
IEF	Interview Evaluation Form
IEP	International Educational Programmes
LFA	Limits of Financial Authority
LM	Line Manager
MRR	Manual Registration Receipt
NDA	Non-Disclosure Agreement
OIR	Other Income Report
OMS	Online Management System



Beaconhouse Group

Franchise School Operations Manual

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Terms and Abbreviations	Explanation
Opex	Operational Expenditure
PC	Purchase Committee
PEF	Probation Evaluation Form
PIF	Personal Information Form
PIP	Performance Improvement Plan
PO	Purchase Order
PR	Purchase Requisition
PRO	Parent Relations Officer
PSD	Parent Satisfaction Department
PSHE	Personal, Social and Health Education
PTM	Parent Teacher Meeting
RFQ	Request for Quotation (includes Invitation to Bids/Tenders)
RH	Regional Head (UCS)
RO	Regional Office
RR	Registration Receipt (System Generated)
S&A	Systems & Audit
SIP	School Improvement Plan
SM	Senior Master/Mistress
SMF	Senior Manager Finance – UCS
SMS	Short Message Service
SM SC	Senior Manager Supply Chain
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
SPC	Students protection coordinator
SRC	Security Reference Check
SRF	Withdrawal and Security Refund Form
UCS	United Charter Schools
UCS-FSOM	United Charter Schools Franchise Operations Manual
WDV	Written Down Value
WO	Work Order



SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION & SCOPE



1. INTRODUCTION

- 1.1 This Manual has been developed to meet basic guidelines and recommendations to UCS Franchise Branches (Schools). For the purpose of efficient and smooth operations, fundamental processes, key controls and relevant guidance has been incorporated in this Manual. Policies and procedures relevant to various operational areas such as students' admission/transfer, HR, procurement, fixed assets, finance etc. have been incorporated in this Manual.
- 1.2 This Manual aims to meet all basic guidelines and recommendations to the franchise management. It aims to ensure that an effective control environment is established at Franchise Branches comprising of the desired internal controls, checks and other forms of control.
- 1.3 In order to make its understanding and implementation easier at Schools, the UCS-FSOM has been divided into the following sections:
- Admissions, Transfers and Withdrawals
 - Students Relations, Fee Concessions and Scholarship
 - Students Discipline and Well Being Policies
 - Academics
 - HR Policies and Procedures
 - Finance and Accounts
 - Assets and Related Records
 - Procurement Activities
 - Construction, Renovation and Maintenance
 - Annexure
- 1.4 The Manual contains various forms/templates to be used in different activities for the sake of record maintenance. These forms/templates intend to facilitate the Franchise Management (FM) in implementing the standardized policies and procedures set out by the UCS Management uniformly in all Franchise Branches/Offices of United Charter Schools.

2. SCOPE

- 2.1 This Manual is applicable to all employees and students of UCS Franchise Branches.
- 2.2 Relevant provisions of this Manual shall also be applicable on HO and RO employees of UCS.
- 2.3 Terms and conditions mentioned in agreement with Franchisee shall supersede the provisions mentioned in this Manual.

3. OWNERSHIP & CUSTODIANSHIP

- 3.1 Franchise Owners and UCS Management (concerned Functional Incharges authorized by Deputy Director) shall be responsible for implementation of relevant policies and procedures prescribed in this Manual.
- 3.2 UCS Management (Group S&A Department) shall be responsible for maintaining the UCS-FSOM. This Manual shall be maintained in both soft and hard form.



4. IMPLEMENTATION

- 4.1 The best practices and policy guidelines of suggestive in nature have been marked as “Recommended”. Policies and guidelines, compliance of which is mandatory has been marked as “Mandatory”.
- 4.2 Franchise Management shall be responsible for compliance of “Mandatory” guidance/policies, however, compliance of recommended guidance/policies shall be at the discretions of Franchise Owner.
- 4.3 This Manual shall be applicable with effect from 31st March 2022.

5. AMENDMENTS AND REVISIONS TO THE MANUAL

- 5.1 This Manual shall be subject to updates and amendments to ensure that the policies are in line with the functions and objectives of UCS Management. The three (03) types of changes, which can affect the Manual, are:
- Amendments to the laws of Pakistan
 - Changes as a result of updating in manual on periodic basis
 - At a minimum, the Manual shall be reviewed after every year to identify any changes which are required to be made.
- 5.2 Any amendments and revisions to the Manual as deemed necessary will be incorporated as per UCS SOP No. S&A/SOP/003 for “Development and Amendment of Policies & Procedures”.

6. EXCEPTIONS TO THE MANUAL

In special circumstances, the UCS Management (Director S&A and Deputy Director-UCS) may approve exceptions to this Manual as the situation may warrant, keeping in view the practical considerations.



SECTION 2: ADMISSIONS, TRANSFERS & WITHDRAWALS



7. STUDENTS REGISTRATION AND ADMISSIONS-MANDATORY

7.1 REGISTRATION INTRODUCTION

- 7.1.1 Registration is a first step towards admission. It is announced for each upcoming academic session through several suitable media. Registrations at a school is basically an appointment of students with the school for test /interview to assess / gauge their eligibility for admission.
- 7.1.2 Registration period can be extended or reduced depending on when the school requirement of student intake is met. In other cases, registration remains open throughout the year.
- 7.1.3 The date of test and interview is communicated to the students at the time of payment of registration fee.
- 7.1.4 After the admission tests, interviews are held, successful candidates are informed and advised to deposit applicable dues within a prescribed timeline. Admission is only finalised after deposit of applicable dues (security, admission and tuition fee, as applicable).
- 7.1.5 Getting a student registered with the school does not, in any way, imply or guarantee admission, which is subject to clearing an admission test / interview as well as seat availability.
- 7.1.6 Students' affairs shall be looked after by the Parent Satisfaction Department. It serves as a liaison between students/parents, faculty and administration. The primary function is to address concerns related to the admission process, transfers, withdrawals and long leave, and to be of assistance to parents/students if and when required.

7.2 REGISTRATION SCHEDULE

Dates for registration are announced individually by each School. As a general practice, registration remains open throughout the year, however, majority of the registrations are completed during the period starting from the month of January. Under special circumstances, where only a limited number of students are to be enrolled, registrations may be closed after a certain period of time. The period may be extended or reduced depending upon whether the school requirement of student intake is met.

7.3 REGISTRATION PROCESS

- 7.3.1 At the time of registration, students are charged a non-refundable registration fee in accordance with the rates, approved by the UCS Management.
- 7.3.2 The registration of the student shall be made through OMS (Online Management System).
- 7.3.3 Registration Fee shall be collected in cash and System generated Registration Receipt (RR) **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-001)** shall be issued to Parents / Students as an acknowledgment of cash received.
- 7.3.4 The registration process including fee collection should be handled by the PRO.



- 7.3.5 Parents/Student can register with UCS by filling out online forms at <https://www.ucs.edu.pk/admissions/> which is self-explanatory. After providing all necessary information, the form shall be submitted by clicking the “Submit” button.
- 7.3.6 Upon submission of the online form, following auto generated message appears: “Your Admission Query Form Has Been Submitted Successfully. Thank you for contacting United Charter Schools. Our admission officer will be in touch soon”.
- 7.3.7 Alternatively, the parent shall visit the Campus and respective PRO (Parent Relations Officer) shall fill the registration form of the student.
- 7.3.8 The PRO shall receive the registration amount from the parent/student.
- 7.3.9 A tentative time for the test/interview will be given to the parent. Preferably, the interview/test shall be conducted within two days from the date of registration in BEAMS. PRO should make sure that the test is scheduled according to the comfort and the ease of the parents.
- 7.3.10 PRO shall inform the BH and any designated Official that they have to be present at the time of the test/interview.
- 7.3.11 The date and time of interview/test shall be entered in the online registration process.
- 7.3.12 The PRO shall click the “Update” button to generate a Registration/System ID.
- 7.3.13 The PRO shall obtain the print of the Registration Receipt (RR) from the System **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-001)**. The RR shall be signed by the PRO and parent/guardian.
- 7.3.14 Three copies of RR shall be distributed as follows:
- Parent’s copy (handed over to parent)
 - Accounts’ Copy
 - PRO’s Copy
- 7.3.15 In case of non-availability of OMS, a PDF printout of “System Generated Receipt (Manual Registration Receipt - MRR) shall be filled and issued as acknowledgement of registration cash received.
- 7.3.15.1 The reason causing the issuance of MRR must be mentioned on MRR.
- 7.3.15.2 Any type of cutting/alteration on MRR shall be validated by BH.
- 7.3.15.3 On availability of the OMS, the system generated RR shall be recorded based on the information on MRR. System generated RR is mandatory for appearance in interview/test.
- 7.3.16 At the time of registration, “Prospectus” and “Rules Pertaining to Admission” and any other material specified by the UCS Management shall also be handed over to the parent/student.
- 7.3.17 To keep the track of admission process, Registration Receipt (RR) shall also be issued to students who are exempted from registration fee e.g., employee children, pre-mature transfers. Such receipts shall be marked as “Exempted” along with the reason/basis.



- 7.3.18 PRO must close the case in visitors log module as per guidelines provided by UCS Management (Incharge Parent Relations HO/RO).

7.4 BANK DEPOSIT OF REGISTRATION FEE

- 7.4.1 Cash collected as registration fee shall be deposited in the main bank account designated for collection, by close of every working week. However, in cases where the collection exceeds PKR 10,000/- the same must be deposited immediately.
- 7.4.2 Cash collected on account of student registration shall not be utilised by the Branch under any circumstances.
- 7.4.3 BA or Official authorised by BH shall fill the Bank Deposit Slip (BDS) and deposit the cash into bank. Deposited BDS along with detail of registrations made shall be handed over to the BA.
- 7.4.4 Registration fee collected and deposited shall be reported to the HO through “Other Income Report” (OIR) on a monthly basis by the BA.
- 7.4.5 The BA shall maintain/update the record of OIR and relevant BDS.

7.5 ADMISSION PROCEDURE

- 7.5.1 After the registration and passing the interview/test, the admission of students shall be processed by the PRO.
- 7.5.2 PRO shall update the details of student, declared eligible for admission, in OMS (Online Management System) and get approval from BH through the OMS .
- 7.5.3 Upon approval by BH, OMS shall generate an automatic intimation for HO.
- 7.5.4 Concerned staff at HO shall generate 1st fee challan that may include admission fee, security deposit, tuition fee, other charges, as applicable.
- 7.5.5 An auto generated email shall be generated to the PRO upon completion of registration process. The PRO shall get print(s) of challan form(s), from the OMS and deliver it to parents within two day of the interview/test.
- 7.5.6 The challan should be valid to pay within three days from the date of issuance.
- 7.5.7 The fee challan shall be payable through specified bank.
- 7.5.8 Cash collection against fee (other than the registration fee) is not permissible under any circumstances.
- 7.5.9 The PRO shall be responsible to obtain the copy of the paid first fee challan from parents/students before allowing the student to join the class. Alternatively, the PRO may obtain a “screen print” of the paid challan from the Module.
- 7.5.10 The PRO shall prepare the student file and obtain the print of Admission Order from the OMS. The Admission Order must be signed by BH and dated.
- 7.5.11 Following documents are required for preparation of student’s files:
- Student Registration Form
 - Admission Form



- Two recent passport size photographs of student
- Birth Certificate (NADRA) / CNIC / first two pages of passport (for foreign national student only)
- Copies of CNIC of parents/guardian
- Copy of first two pages of passport of parent's / guardian's (foreign nationals only)
- Copies of last School Report (if applicable)
- School Leaving Certificate (if applicable)
- Health Forms ([Annexures UCS-FSOM-010, UCS-FSOM-011, UCS-FSOM-012, UCS-FSOM-013](#)) shall be signed by the parent/guardian (as applicable).
- Terms & Conditions signed by the parent/guardian
- Acknowledgement of Student Discipline and Behaviour Management Policy.
- Admission Test/Assessment
- Admission Order
- First Paid Fee Challan
- Other (as per system requirement)

7.5.12 OMS generated Student I.D. (computer number) of the student shall be mentioned on cover face of the student's file.

7.5.13 New students shall not to be allowed to attend classes without payment of all applicable dues and system generated Admission Order approved by the BH.

7.6 STUDENT FILES

7.6.1 It is the responsibility of the PRO to prepare the file for each student upon finalisation of the student admission process.

7.6.2 A printed file with the UCS monogram must be used for this purpose. The following information shall be mentioned on the cover page of each file:

- Student's name
- Computer ID
- Date of birth
- Father's name
- Date of admission
- Class in which admitted
- Date of withdrawal (along with withdrawal #)
- Class from which withdrawn
- Branch name
- Region
- Student Promotion Record - year-wise

7.6.3 The student file shall remain in the custody of the PRO and may be issued upon request to concerned personnel only e.g. PRO, Teacher and Coordinator etc.

7.6.4 A detailed Student File Check List is attached as [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-002\)](#). This checklist shall be pasted on the inside of the file cover. The PRO shall ensure that



all the required documents are filed in personal files of students as per the check list pasted in the file.

- 7.6.5 Leave applications of students **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-003)** approved by the Class Teacher / BH shall be placed in student's file.
- 7.6.6 In case of transfer of a student, in any it shall be the responsibility of the PRO to promptly send the student file to the transferee Branch after entering information in student module.
- 7.6.7 In case of a student's withdrawal, the PRO shall file the application for School Leaving, Withdrawal Order, Clearance Certificate, a certified copy of the student Withdrawal and Security Refund Form etc. and close the file.
- 7.6.8 All closed files must be retained and kept in safe custody in accordance with the Company's record retention policy.

7.7 PARENT INTERACTION

- 7.7.1 FM is responsible to ensure that parents acquaint themselves with the criteria and procedures for admissions. Parents, coming for admission of their children, shall be deemed to have consented to abide by these criteria and procedures.
- 7.7.2 Parents shall be given reasonable opportunity to carefully read and understand Company policies relevant to students/parents e.g., rules pertinent to admission, payment of fees, transfer, withdrawals, security deposits, "Student Discipline and Behaviour Management Policy" etc.
- 7.7.3 The parents shall be briefed about "Student Discipline and Behaviour Management Policy" and acknowledgement from him/her shall be obtained, preferably at the time of the student admission. Otherwise, the said document could be signed by the parent(s) during a subsequent parent-teacher meeting.



8. PAYMENT OF TUITION FEE AND OTHER CHARGES - MANDATORY

8.1 GENERAL

Fee is payable in advance on a monthly basis, through the specified bank(s) as approved by the management from time to time.

- 8.1.1 Fee is collected through OMS generated fee challans (Green challans).
- 8.1.2 Re-admission shall only be allowed on payment of applicable dues, as mentioned in **Section 13**.

8.2 FEE CHALLAN GENERATION AND DISTRIBUTION

- 8.2.1 Fee challans are generated by the OMS and printed by Branch.
- 8.2.2 Fee challans shall be printed by Branch in accordance with the schedule finalized by UCS Management. Generally, challans are printed before the start of “fee month”.
- 8.2.3 BA shall be responsible for obtaining the challans forms, from UCS Management.
- 8.2.4 BA shall circulate fee challans along with class lists to concerned teachers for distribution to students.
- 8.2.5 Teachers shall distribute challans to respective students/class/section and sign it on the class list.
- 8.2.6 Undelivered challans should be returned to BA. In case of any missing challan, respective teacher must inform the BA.
- 8.2.7 Fee challans (issuance/revalidation) data shall be sent to banks after each 30-minute interval on daily basis from 8 am to 6 pm. It implies that parents/students can pay the issued/revalidated challans in banks on the same day after 30 mins.

8.3 FEE CHALLAN PAYMENT

- 8.3.1 Parents shall deposit the fee within the “due date” without any extra charges. However, payments made after the “due date” but before the “valid date” shall be subject to a prescribed late fee fine. “valid date” may be extended by UCS Management (HO), on request from parents. If the challan remains unpaid for four consecutive months then upon expiry of the validity date of 4th unpaid fee challan, auto withdrawal process shall be initiated. In special circumstances, concerned PRO may request on behalf of parents for any installment plan subject to approval by UCS Management (Incharge Parent Relations HO).
- 8.3.2 Student are not allowed to attend class after withdrawal. Once the name of student has been removed from Attendance Module, the class teacher shall ensure that the student is not attending the class.
- 8.3.3 In case of nonpayment, the fee shall be added in fee challan, of next fee cycle, as arrear along with additional fine.
- 8.3.4 Readmission in this case shall be allowed on payment of pending dues.



8.4 FEE CHALLAN EXECUTION AND SMS MECHANISM

8.4.1 Routine Challan (Green Challan)

8.4.1.1 The routine fee challan (Green challan) shall be generated by the OMS before the beginning of a fee cycle. Simultaneously the OMS shall automatically send SMS to parents on their registered mobile number.

8.4.1.2 OMS shall generate two further SMSs.

- 1st reminder SMS is delivered before 48 hours of fee challan “due date”
- 2nd reminder SMS is delivered after 48 hours of fee challan “due date”

8.4.1.3 After 24 hours of expiry of fee challan “valid date” the System (OMS) shall automatically generate a list of students, whose fee remained unpaid, under intimation to the concerned PRO and BH.

Note: “Valid date” of Green Challan may be extended by HO/RO on request of parents.

8.4.2 The PRO shall contact parents telephonically to follow up the payment and inform them about the auto-withdrawal process.

8.4.3 The PRO shall be responsible to raise exemption, if any, for landlords/court cases on OMS before expiry of “valid date”.

8.5 PROPOSED CONTENTS OF SMS

SMS No	SMS Text	Responsibility
Routine Challan (Green Challan)		
1st SMS	Dear Parents, Fee Challan for the month of XYZ has been generated. The due date of this challan is dd/mm/yy. Please collect the fee challan from the campus. The fee can be paid at authorised banks i.e. UBL & MCB. Fee can also be paid via UBL Mobile App.	IT
2nd SMS	Dear Parents, The due date for XYZ fee challan is dd/mm/yy. Kindly pay before the due date and if already paid, please ignore this message.	IT

8.6 RECEIPT OF STUDENTS' SECURITY

Student security deposit is a sum received from each student at the time of admission as a security to cover the unpaid dues, if any. The amount shall be refunded to student at the time of passing out / withdrawal, as the case may be, after making applicable adjustments, if any.

8.7 COLLECTION OF SECURITY DEPOSIT

8.7.1 Student security fee shall be charged to students through fee challan, at the time of admission, in accordance with the rates approved by UCS Management. The rate may vary across Regions.



8.7.2 Student security fee shall be accounted for in the books of accounts of Franchise Branch. It shall be reported to UCS Management on monthly basis.

8.8 CONCESSION TO CONFIRMED EMPLOYEE

8.8.1 Confirmed employees shall avail student concession in accordance with the **Section 15** of this Manual.

8.8.2 Where children are enrolled before confirmation of employees, Admission Fee and Student Security will be charged at the time of admission. However, the Student Security (only) shall be refunded once the employee is confirmed in accordance with the applicable fee concession policy.

8.8.3 Where children are enrolled after confirmation of the employees no student security will be charged at the time of admission.

8.9 CANCELLATION OF STUDENT SECURITY EXEMPTION

8.9.1 Children of confirmed employees are entitled to student security deposit exemption in accordance with the UCS Management policy (please refer to **Section 15** of this Manual). However, this exemption is withdrawn upon retirement, resignation, or termination of an employee. In these cases, Security deposit shall be charged as per the current applicable rates.

8.9.2 Cancellation of the facility will take effect as follows:

8.9.2.1 Where an employee's services are terminated on account of misconduct or where an employee resigns without serving any notice _____ with immediate effect.

8.9.2.2 Where an employee's services are terminated with immediate effect for reasons other than misconduct or where an employee resigns and serves a notice period _____ on the expiry of the notice period required to be served as per the terms of appointment.

8.9.3 A student security fee exemption cancellation order shall be generated and duly signed by the FM. There shall be five copies of the order and be forwarded as follows:

- Ex-employee
- Line Manager/HOD/FO- where applicant was serving
- BH where children are studying
- SMF UCS Management
- Fee Concession File

8.9.4 Upon withdrawal of the facility, challan printing process shall be initiated to collect the applicable security deposit.



9. ONLINE ATTENDANCE ON OMS (STUDENTS) - MANDATORY

9.1 GENERAL

- 9.1.1 Today's learning is based on yesterday's instruction. School success starts with regular attendance. Consistent attendance offers the most effective opportunity for students to understand concepts, materials and expectations of the courses in which they are enrolled.
- 9.1.2 Branches, in partnership with parents, play a key role in promoting regular attendance of students. Students who attend school regularly feel more connected to their community, develop important social skills and friendships, and are significantly more likely to set themselves up for a strong future.
- 9.1.3 Marking of attendance is a mandatory activity for the homeroom teacher. All Branches shall use the student attendance module as only mode for recording the student attendance. Where the attendance module is temporarily not working, manual attendance may be marked on attendance registers but the same shall be updated on the module on priority basis.

9.2 ONLINE ATTENDANCE

- 9.2.1 Given below are the guidelines / precautions to follow when marking the attendance using the OMS.
- 9.2.2 The PRO shall enter student information in the OMS respectively at the time of admission. Thus, the student's name will automatically appear in the OMS attendance system from the date of admission.
- 9.2.3 BH shall authorise the class teacher, through OMS, to mark the class attendance in the Attendance Form of OMS.
- 9.2.4 Edit in attendance shall be allowed within 5 days of marked attendance / absent.
- 9.2.5 BH shall play the role of an observer for student attendance.
- 9.2.6 OMS shall generate and send an automatic email alert to the BH if the attendance is not marked for any class.
- 9.2.7 Overview of student attendance shall also be available on BH's dashboard of OMS.
- 9.2.8 Reports required by the UCS Management / BHs may be generated through OMS.
- 9.2.9 Student's name shall continue to appear in the OMS attendance module for 30 days after the auto-withdrawal. Such names shall appear in a different color, to allow teachers, to distinguish between on-roll and withdrawn students. Names of withdrawn students shall automatically be removed from OMS after 30 days.

9.3 UCS DESK (STUDENT INFO APP) MOBILE APP

The UCS DESK (Student Info App) Mobile App can be downloaded through App and Play Store.



9.4 **ABSENCE**

- 9.4.1 The BH must have an effective measure in place to monitor and follow-up on students' absences.
- 9.4.2 A student is required to notify the class teacher or PRO about planned leave in advance.
- 9.4.3 The class teacher is responsible for informing the PRO within three working days of a student's absence in case of no prior intimation is given.
- 9.4.4 The PRO is responsible for undertaking all reasonable measures to contact parents promptly and to note their response. The response must be communicated to the concerned class teacher and BH.
- 9.4.5 In case of a student being absent for 30 consecutive days without intimation, the class teacher shall inform the BH and PRO who will then process withdrawal of the student.



10. STUDENTS TRANSFER - MANDATORY

10.1 ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

- 10.1.1 UCS Management offers as one of its advantages the facility of student transfers where UCS / Franchise Branch has presence.
- 10.1.2 A student may apply for transfer subject to the following:
- 10.1.2.1 A student shall only qualify for transfer subject to availability of a vacancy in the transferee Branch. However, the decision of the transferee UCS Management / BH remains final in this regard.
 - 10.1.2.2 Student has cleared all dues in the Branch from which he/she is seeking transfer.
- 10.1.3 If a student qualifies for any transfer:
- 10.1.3.1 No admission fee shall be charged by the Branch to which the student is seeking transfer.
 - 10.1.3.2 The security deposit amount shall not be refunded in student transfer cases but shall be transferred to the UCS Management / FM to which the student is being transferred by the Transferor Branch.
- 10.1.4 For the purpose of this section (transfer) the expression BH includes BHs of UCS owned campuses.

10.2 TRANSFER PROCESS

- 10.2.1 Transfers are classified into the following:
- 10.2.1.1 Promotional Transfer/Relocation
 - 10.2.1.2 Intra- Region Transfer (within same Region)
 - 10.2.1.3 Inter- Region Transfer (across different Regions)
- 10.2.2 Promotional Transfer Cases/Relocation Cases
- 10.2.2.1 In this case, the entire class after the final assessment is moved to another Branch due to unavailability of advanced classes in the current Branch.
 - 10.2.2.2 No transfer request needs to be raised on OMS.
 - 10.2.2.3 All student files shall be handed over to the transferee Branch directly by the PRO of transferor Branch.
 - 10.2.2.4 The UCS Management shall have no role in handing and taking over of these files.
- 10.2.3 Intra - Region Transfers
- It includes all transfers within the same Region e.g. a student transfer from UCS Johar Town campus to UCS Paragon Campus. Process flow for Intra - Region Transfer shall be as follows:
- 10.2.3.1 The student/parent seeking transfer shall apply for the transfer at the transferor Branch by submitting an application in the PRO Office.



- 10.2.3.2 The PRO shall get approval from the BH, on the application, for further processing through OMS.
- 10.2.3.3 PRO shall check student account for any outstanding dues and ensure clearance before further processing.
- 10.2.3.4 Approved scanned copy of application shall be uploaded in student module for BH approval in OMS/BEAMS.
- 10.2.3.5 On approval by the case shall automatically get processed in concerned.
- 10.2.3.6 Every transfer case shall be allotted its own system generated unique identification/reference number which shall be provided to parents/student as an acknowledgment of their submitted application and future follow up.
- 10.2.3.7 After necessary evaluations, UCS Management (Incharge Parent Relations HO) refers the case to BH of transferee Branch to check seat availability.
- 10.2.3.8 In case of availability of seat, BH of transferee Branch accepts the request.
- 10.2.3.9 A system generated email shall be transmitted to all personnel involved in the process of Student Transfer.
- 10.2.3.10 At the time of joining of the transferred student, the transfer letter or system generated reference number shall be provided to the PRO of transferee Branch for further processing.
- 10.2.3.11 The Region shall be intimated through system generated email and the STUDENT IN / STUDENT OUT process takes place automatically.
- 10.2.3.12 On completion of transfer process, systems generate a ticket for PRO (transferor Campus) to enter student file dispatch details along with details of courier in the system.
- 10.2.3.13 PRO of transferor Branch shall ensure the completeness of student file before its dispatch. The PRO of transferee Branch shall also ensure the same.
- 10.2.3.14 If the applicant cannot be transferred to a Branch of his/her choice, UCS Management then suggests a Branch where the applicant may be transferred.

10.2.4 Inter - Region Transfers

It include a student transfer taking place between two different Regions e.g. a transfer from Centre Region to South Region. Process flow of Inter - Region transfers shall be as follows:

- 10.2.4.1 PRO shall raise the transfer request on BEAMS (transfer out Branch).
- 10.2.4.2 BH of transferor Branch shall provide the approval.
- 10.2.4.3 UCS Management (Incharge Parent Relations HO), shall review the request.
- 10.2.4.4 BH of transferee Branch shall provide the approval.



- 10.2.4.5 UCS Management (Incharge Parent Relations HO transfer in) shall review the case.
- 10.2.4.6 UCS Management shall provide the final approval.
- 10.2.4.7 PRO (transferee Branch) shall verify the transfer in.
- 10.2.4.8 UCS Management (designated Finance Official) shall process the request.

10.3 GENERAL PROVISIONS FOR TRANSFER

- 10.3.1 Transfer is subject to the seat availability.
- 10.3.2 Transfer from/to sister concerns to/from UCS Franchise Branches is allowed.
- 10.3.3 The student will not be allowed to sit in the transferee Branch, until the completion of transfer process on OMS/BEAMS and appearing of student in the class list of transferee Branch.
- 10.3.4 For **New Admission Transfers** – The student needs to clear the first fee voucher along with the Admission fee and Security deposit after securing admission to be eligible for transfer.

10.4 TRANSFER OF STUDENT FILE

- 10.4.1 Upon final approval from the UCS Management, PRO of transferor Branch shall transfer the student file to PRO of transferee Branch.
- 10.4.2 The turnaround time for this is 1 week.



11. WITHDRAWAL POLICY - MANDATORY

11.1 GENERAL

- 11.1.1 The term “Withdrawal”, as per UCS policy, refers to the student leaving school indicated by a request raised by parents, or as an action taken by the school. Completion of Schooling does not fall under this process.
- 11.1.2 The PRO at Branch shall be responsible for initiating the process in the OMS as well as for coordinating with different stake holders for completion of the process.

11.2 WITHDRAWAL ON PARENT’S REQUEST

- 11.2.1 The process is initiated when a parent comes with a withdrawal request.
- 11.2.2 The PRO investigates the reason for leaving. If there is anything that can be done by the Branch to retain the student, the PRO must take an initiative of getting the issue resolved.
- 11.2.3 It is mandatory that a meeting with the BH is arranged so that he/she can address the parent’s issues and help to retain the student. If the parent is not convinced the PRO will raise the request using OMS.
- 11.2.4 The PRO must check that there are no outstanding dues for the student before raising the request.
- 11.2.5 The parents should be informed that as per UCS policy, they will be contacted by the UCS Management to re-verify the reason for withdrawal within one week after withdrawal has been processed by the Branch.
- 11.2.6 The parent must be informed that one month notice in writing must be given to the school (Branch). Alternatively, one month’s fee must be paid to the Branch in lieu of such notice. However, no notice is required if a student is withdrawn one month from the date of completion of the final examinations.
- 11.2.7 Upon the completion of the withdrawal process, the security deposit shall be refunded after adjusting the dues payable.
- 11.2.8 Once the withdrawal process is completed, the school leaving certificate can be collected from the school.

11.3 WITHDRAWAL BY SCHOOL

- 11.3.1 Disciplinary Action & Detainment
 - 11.3.1.1 At times the withdrawal process is initiated by the BH. This can happen if the student has been involved in severe disciplinary violation or the student has been detained twice in successive years. The PRO will initiate the request in OMS. There is NO notice period and the withdrawal will be in effect immediately. The parent will not be contacted by the UCS Management in all such cases.
 - 11.3.1.2 The school leaving certificate can be collected from Branch.



11.3.2 NON-PAYMENT OF FEE

In case the student's name is in critical fee defaulter list (unpaid dues of 4 consecutive months), the student will be withdrawn by the UCS Management through batch withdrawal. There is NO notice period and the withdrawal will be in effect immediately. The school leaving certificate will also not be issued unless the dues are cleared.

11.3.3 LONG ABSENCE

In case the student has not been coming to school for 30 days, without any written notice, the PRO will contact the parent to determine the reason. The PRO will inform the parent that as per UCS policy, the student may be withdrawn if no written leave application is given, irrespective of whether the fee has been paid for the time period or not. If the parent is not contactable, the PRO will raise withdrawal request in OMS. There is NO notice period and the withdrawal will be in effect immediately.

11.4 **NOTICE PERIOD (FOR STUDENT WITHDRAWAL)**

11.4.1 Parents are required to give one-month notice, in writing, if they wish to withdraw their child from the Branch.

11.4.2 The notice will be effective from the date of submission of notice in the School (Branch).

11.4.3 Submission date of notice, at Branch, shall be considered as effective date of the notice;

11.4.4 Where no such notice is served, one-month tuition fee in lieu of such notice shall be adjusted from the student security deposit. However, no notice is required under the following circumstances:

11.4.4.1 Where the student is withdrawn one month after the annual examination.

11.4.4.2 Where the student has completed schooling.

11.4.4.3 Where the student has been detained.

11.4.4.4 Where the student has been withdrawn for non-payment of fee/prolonged absence.

11.4.5 If a student is withdrawn from the Branch due to disciplinary reasons, the Branch is not required to give any notice before enforcing its decision.

11.5 **STUDENTS WITHDRAWAL REQUESTS PROCESS**

11.5.1 Parents may request for withdrawal of their child from Branch.

11.5.2 Concerned PRO shall arrange a meeting with parents and inquire about the reason for withdrawal. The PRO shall try to retain the parents by addressing their concern(s).

11.5.3 In case, parents change their decision, the PRO shall apologize the parent for the issue and give the end greeting.



- 11.5.4 In case, parents insist on withdrawing their child, the PRO shall log the withdrawal request by marking the exact issue type in OMS.
- 11.5.5 PRO shall give confirmation to parents within 72 hours.
- 11.5.6 The withdrawal request shall be forwarded to BH through OMS within 24 hours.
- 11.5.7 BH shall contact the parents and inquire about the withdrawal reason. BH shall try to retain the student by addressing their concern(s), in case parents are convinced, BH shall address the parent's concerns/issues and closes the withdrawal request in OMS with appropriate remarks.
- 11.5.8 In case, parents insist to withdraw their child, BH approves the withdrawal request by entering the appropriate remarks and forward the same to UCS Management (Incharge Parent Relations HO)
- 11.5.9 Incharge Parent Relations HO shall review the withdrawal request in OMS and provide response.
- 11.5.10 Incharge Parent Relations HO may call the parents and tries to resolve the matter by ensuring the best possible solution given to them, if parents agrees to retain their child in Branch, Incharge Parent Relations HO shall address the concerns of parents, if any, and inform the BH about corrective action(s)/measures. Incharge Parent Relations HO shall close the withdrawal request in OMS with appropriate remarks.
- 11.5.11 If parents continue with their decision of withdrawal, Incharge Parent Relations HO shall enter the appropriate remarks and forward the withdrawal request same to concerned Finance Official.
- 11.5.12 A periodic report is sent to UCS Management about the logges withdrawal cases verses retained cases as per the agreed format for further discussion and solution.
- 11.5.13 In case any discussion is required from UCS Management, Incharge Parent Relations HO shall hold the case and discuss the consolidated cases with UCS Management. After the discussion, the matter shall be disposed of as per instructions by UCS Management.



12. REFUND OF STUDENT SECURITY - MANDATORY

12.1.1 Security deposits shall be refunded, after approval by FO, in following cases:

- Concession to confirmed employees
- Passing out
- Withdrawal of students

12.1.2 All claims for student security refund shall be approved by the FO.

12.2 ADJUSTMENT FROM REFUND

Adjustments against the security deposit paid to the FM shall be under the following circumstances:

- 12.2.1.1 Where a student is withdrawn from the School for any reason, outstanding fee should be adjusted against the security deposit and attempt should be made to recover the balance amount from the students/parents.
- 12.2.1.2 In case of non-submission of the notice of withdrawal, in accordance with **Section 11.4** of this Manual, one month fee shall be deducted from the security deposited.
- 12.2.1.3 Any other amount due from the student e.g. recovery on account of library books.

12.3 REFUND OF SECURITY DEPOSIT TO EMPLOYEE UPON CONFIRMATION

12.3.1 Upon confirmation of employee refund shall be initiated on the basis of the Fee Exemption/Concession form.

12.3.2 Fee exemption/Concession Form shall be submitted to FM, where the employee is serving, for verification. Employee confirmation letter shall be attached as a supporting document.

12.3.3 The fee exemption/concession form will be maintained serially.

12.3.4 The serial number will be the Student OMS ID number generated by the OMS for each student.

12.3.5 There must be five copies of the form (or Order) for:

- Applicant
- FO / Head of Department (UCS) where applicant is serving
- BH where children are studying
- UCS Finance (HO)
- Fee Concession File

Note: Where children are enrolled after confirmation of an employee, student security shall not be received at the time of admission.



12.4 REFUND OF SECURITY DEPOSIT IN CASE OF PASS OUT / WITHDRAWAL

- 12.4.1 Withdrawal of a student refers to the student leaving the School. There could be a number of reasons for withdrawal as mentioned in the Withdrawal Order attached as [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-004\)](#).
- 12.4.2 A withdrawal order shall be issued in each case of withdrawal, whether withdrawal by the school or through parent's request, for whatever reason, even in the case of students completing education.
- 12.4.3 There will be 4 (four) copies of the withdrawal order:
- Parents copy
 - Student file
 - Office copy (Branch)
 - UCS Finance HO copy
- 12.4.4 BA will file withdrawal orders serially School wise.
- 12.4.5 Based on the withdrawal order, refund process shall be initiated.
- 12.4.6 BA shall attach the copy of the withdrawal order with the Withdrawal and Security Refund Form (SRF). The format of SRF is attached as [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-005\)](#).
- 12.4.7 There will be one copy of the SRF (UCS Finance Copy).
- 12.4.8 Where, for any reason, a student is withdrawn by the school, the SRF shall be prepared by the BA and submitted to the FO for adjustment or payment.

12.5 SECURITY REFUND PROCEDURE

- 12.5.1 The parents should be informed that the security refund process will take around 2 weeks. The security will be refunded after deduction of outstanding dues.
- 12.5.2 Once the security refund case (fee exemption/concession form or the SRF) is approved by the FM, a payment voucher and cheque shall be prepared by the BA.
- 12.5.3 A crossed cheque shall be prepared in favour of the parent/guardian, as the case may be, unless the student security needs to be adjusted.
- 12.5.4 The payee name on the cheque should be correct and not have any spelling errors to allow for smooth issuance of the cheque.
- 12.5.5 Entry of the refund shall be maintained in student security register, which is part of OMS.
- 12.5.6 The cheque shall be dispatched through courier to the address provided on the forms by the parent/guardian.
- 12.5.7 If the entire student security has been adjusted, thus rendering the payable student security nil, then the student withdrawal and security refund form/fee exemption



form stating the calculation shall be dispatched to the applicant for their information and to avoid unnecessary confusion;

- 12.5.8 The courier receipts are attached in support of the fee exemption/concession form or the SRF, as the case may be.
- 12.5.9 The school leaving certificate will not be issued unless all outstanding dues are cleared.

13. RE-ADMISSION - MANDATORY

- 13.1 Admission fee shall not be charged from students who apply for re-admission within 30 days of withdrawal, however:
 - 13.1.1.1 If the student security deposit was not refunded, then the withdrawal shall be cancelled and no adjustment shall be made out of the student security. Such case shall be treated as if no withdrawal had ever taken place.
 - 13.1.1.2 If the student security refund was processed and payment was made to the student then the student will be required to pay outstanding dues along with student security at current prevalent rates.
- 13.1.2 Where a withdrawn student applies for re-admission after 30 days of withdrawal, the admission shall be treated as a new admission and fee shall be charged at current applicable rates for Security, Admission and Tuition etc. However, in special cases FO may grant exemption of Admission Fee subject to clearance of all outstanding dues at the time of withdrawal. Such an exemption, if any, can only be granted once during a student's academic career with UCS.



SECTION 3:

STUDENTS RELATIONS, FEE CONCESSIONS AND SCHOLARSHIP



14. ADVANCE PAYMENT OF FEES - MANDATORY

Additional discounts that may be offered on advance payment of School fees are as follows:

- 14.1 Advance payment of School fee for 6 months - 3% discount
- 14.2 Advance payment of School fee for 12 months - 6% discount))

15. FEE CONCESSION FOR EMPLOYEES - MANDATORY

- 15.1.1 Children of staff of Franchise Branches shall have following fee concessions in other Franchise Branches.

Cadre	Child	Concession in %age		
		Tuition Fee	Admission fee	Security
Up to 3 Children for Executive, Administrative & Teaching Staff. Up to 1 Child for Office Staff.	1 st Child	100%	100%	100%
	2 nd Child	50%	100%	100%
	3 rd Child	50%	50%	100%

- 15.1.2 Full Tuition Fee Concession up to 3 Children for Executive, Administrative & Teaching Staff shall be allowed where both husband & wife are employed by UCS (with 50% admission fee for 3rd child).
- 15.1.3 Employees of UCS and employees of Franchise Branches shall not have any fee concession in Franchise Branches and UCS owned Branches, respectively.



16. STUDENT RECORD CHANGE - MANDATORY

16.1 TYPES OF CHANGES

16.1.1 Record change applications can be categorized as following:

- 16.1.1.1 Student's name change
 - Name change
 - Name addition/removal
 - Name spelling rectification
- 16.1.1.2 Date of birth change
- 16.1.1.3 Parent information change

16.2 PROCEDURE

Kindly follow these steps while sending out a Record Change request to UCS Management:

16.2.1 Name Change

If name of the Student (First or Last) is changed by the parent in NADRA record then following documents shall be required:

- 16.2.1.1 Written application from the parent
- 16.2.1.2 UCS Registration Form
- 16.2.1.3 B-Form/ Birth Certificate/ CNIC (updated)
- 16.2.1.4 Duly signed undertaking (affidavit)
- 16.2.1.5 Copy of advertisement in Newspaper (In case of first name change only)

16.2.2 Name addition/removal

If a surname e.g. Chaudhry or Muhammad is added before or after the name of the student then following documents shall be required:

- 16.2.2.1 Written application from the parent
- 16.2.2.2 UCS Registration Form
- 16.2.2.3 B-Form/ Birth Certificate/ CNIC (updated)
- 16.2.2.4 Duly signed undertaking (affidavit)

16.2.3 Name spelling rectification

If only the spellings of the Student's name has to be changed then following documents shall be required:

- 16.2.3.1 Written application from the parent
- 16.2.3.2 UCS Registration Form
- 16.2.3.3 Birth Certificate / CNIC / Smart Card / B-Form/ (updated)

16.2.4 Date of Birth Change

- 16.2.4.1 If date of Birth of the Student is changed by the parent in NADRA record then following documents shall be required:
 - Written application from the parent
 - UCS Registration Form



- B-Form/ Birth Certificate/ CNIC (updated)
- Duly signed undertaking (affidavit)

16.2.4.2 PRO need to review the case to check what would the age of the Student be at the time of admission in Branch if the date of birth is changed now.

16.2.4.3 If the record shows an age which conflicts with the admission policy of UCS then the parents are required to mention this clearly in written application and affidavit that they have made this rectification from NADRA.

16.2.5 Parental Information Change

PRO can change following parental data, using update addresses (if student is not withdrawn) at their own discretion after carefully reviewing the case and there is no need of any approval from UCS Management. Please note that the amended record should reflect on supporting documents i.e. B-form etc.

- Name Change
- National Identity Card Number
- Email Addresses

Note: All changes must be authorized by UCS Management.

16.3 PROCEDURE FOR CHANGE

16.3.1 Any kind of data rectification emails need to be sent directly to UCS Management (Incharge Parent Relations HO).

16.3.2 Record of parent or guardian could be changed upon enough piece of evidence that shows the relation of both Parent/Guardian and the student.

16.3.3 Record Change Form for approval is attached as [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-006\)](#).

16.3.4 Google form is to be submitted by the PRO.

16.3.5 Affidavit collected from the parent should be original and color scans of both sides needs to be attached in Record Change Form.

16.3.6 Signature of the parent is mandatory on the affidavit and has to be attested from Oath Commissioner.

16.3.7 If the record was entered wrong in OMS and data is correct on Registration Form then email directly to UCS Management (Incharge Parent Relations HO) for further directions. Following shall be required to record the change:

- Registration / Admission Form
- B-Form/ Birth Certificate/ CNIC (updated)



17. UCS FEEDBACK PROCESS MANAGEMENT SYSTEM - MANDATORY

UCS Parent/School complaint feedback management system (OMS) contains following key features:

- Student search
- User friendly interface
- Student ticket history
- Complaint category wise ticket history
- TAT period wise ticket history
- Color coding depicting TAT levels
- Auto escalation during and after TAT days
- Auto SMS broadcast to the parent at the time of ticket generation
- Auto feedback SMS broadcast to the parent at the time of resolution
- Multiple reason tags for reporting purposes
- Ticket reporting

This system helps to increase the efficiency of the School PROs, BHs, PRMs and HO Staff in management of complaints.

18. EXTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS - MANDATORY

- 18.1 Any message addressing someone outside of our school — be it parents, prospective staff, the press, or the local community — is an external communication.
- 18.2 We live in a climate of environmental complexity. It is important for us to be conscious of how we are perceived by others. Transmitting the right message and using the most suitable tone are crucial, whether posting on a school social media account, sending an SMS, or a press release etc. On the other hand, positivity and clarity of the messages must also not be ignored. Our exchange of communication should aim/intend to enhance public image and limit miscomprehension to the least.
- 18.3 Effective external communication can position our school as a prestigious institution that is committed to excellence, and delivers a high standard of education. With regards to this matter of importance, USC has set parameters which must be strictly adhered to.
- 18.4 Please refer to the following before initiating an external information of exchange:
- Sending SMS to Parents
 - School Circulars

18.5 COMMUNICATION WITH PARENTS

- 18.5.1 Parents are one of the key stakeholders and a good institution uses their feedback and suggestions to further improve the quality of service provided by the school.
- 18.5.2 Parents may not always be right, but they do have the right to be concerned. Therefore, they deserve to be listened to and helped.



- 18.5.3 Effective communication is a two-way process. School leaders and teachers learn more when they are listening actively and working towards a workable empathetic solution.
- 18.5.4 It is essential that all members of staff have a thorough understanding of the topic or area of discussion when interacting with parents. This understanding will give them the confidence to deal with queries effectively.
- 18.5.5 In order to gain the trust of parents it is essential to complete or carry out actions that are agreed upon.
- 18.5.6 As qualified and trained professionals, school leaders and teachers maintain a calm yet cheerful demeanor under all circumstances.

Phone calls and email

- 18.5.7 Treat calls and emails as an important part of the job. These are often the first experience parents have of your school.
- 18.5.8 Teachers and school leaders should only communicate with parents through the official email address and school phone.
- 18.5.9 Use the email subject line to your advantage, that is, as a short summary.
- 18.5.10 Put aside time to answer phone calls and emails.
- 18.5.11 Answer phone messages and emails within 24 hours if possible but don't rush answers that you need longer to think about.
- 18.5.12 Do not share your perceptions or personal information with parents
- 18.5.13 Make sure the section teacher makes a follow-up call to the absent / on leave student. This is a key strategy for developing rapport with parents. Use this opportunity to connect with parents. Reasons for poor attendance? Is the child unwell? Are the parents thinking of changing school is the parent going through a tough time? Transport issues? How poor attendance impacts academics?
- 18.5.14 Documentation and methodical record keeping is key. In particular, record agreed times and dates. Tell the person you are talking to what you are recording. Put follow-up actions in your calendar.

SENDING SMS TO PARENTS

- 18.5.15 **SMS** (Short Message Service) is used as an important information broadcasting tool by the schools. In USC, the SMS sending functionality is built into OMS.
- 18.5.16 No other software should be used by school staff to send a message to parents. No phone number data should be collected by individuals in the school for the purpose of sending an SMS or communicating over the phone. **SMS should ONLY be sent using the BEAMS module.**
- 18.5.17 Composing an SMS
- Teachers, Academic Staff, Security etc. have been given the rights to draft an SMS and select appropriate recipients.



18.5.18 Approving an SMS

Before approving an SMS, the BH shall ensure that:

- the SMS is necessary.
- the language of the SMS is appropriate.
- the SMS is free of grammatical and spelling errors.
- repeated SMS is not generated during a day.

SCHOOL CIRCULARS

18.5.19 School Circulars are a standard mode of written communication between the school and parents. UCS Management (Education team at HO) may be contacted for standardized circulars for Branches.

18.6 FACE-TO-FACE COMMUNICATION

18.6.1 It is extremely important to keep the doors open and welcome parents to share in the educational goals of the student.

18.6.2 BH should train their office staff to deal politely with parents. The office staff often conveys the first impression of the school (Branch) to the parents. It is important that the impression given is one of courteousness and consideration.

18.6.3 Parent-teacher meetings (PTM) are to be held privately between a teacher and a student's parents and are an opportunity to exchange ideas and communicate feelings. They must not be held in public.

18.6.4 Appreciate constructive criticism and thank parents for their feedback.

18.6.5 Treat each conversation as being crucial.

18.6.6 Difficult conversations with adults will occur. Don't become defensive – breathe and count to 10.

18.7 PRESENCE ON SOCIAL MEDIA (FB, TWITTER ETC.)

18.7.1 UCS Management (Head Office Marketing team) has ultimate responsibility for digital footprint of the School (Branch).

18.7.2 Marketing team shall be responsible to choose platforms that is easy to use for the school and audience(s). Following should be considered:

18.7.2.1 The contents should be clear, concise, professional, and safe for example, do not post images of students without parental permission (see e-safety policy).

18.7.2.2 Ensure the content enhances your school's key messages, values, and beliefs, and does not contradict the image of the UCS/Beaconhouse or hurt the feelings of specific groups of people e.g. the minorities, etc.

18.7.2.3 Have protocols in place to manage the content.

18.7.2.4 Have more than one person responsible for producing content, moderating content, and monitoring for inappropriate responses.



- 18.7.2.5 Make sure that the channel is not used for personal postings and only for school activities.

18.8 NEWSLETTERS

- 18.8.1 Newsletters may be digital or paper, however digital newsletters help the environment and reduce wastage.
- 18.8.2 Newsletters should provide the means to inform, promote, and educate. Decide on the balance of these three for each newsletter.
- 18.8.3 To get your intended audience to read your news, it's best to make it brief and to the point.
- 18.8.4 Ensure the newsletter provides the means to convey important messages about the school's vision, values, strategies, and plans.
- 18.8.5 Establish and stick to a regular publication timetable.
- 18.8.6 Quality is important. Establish the highest standards for accuracy of detail and grammar. Have a neutral proof-reader.

18.9 SUGGESTED ARRANGEMENTS FOR PARENT-TEACHER MEETINGS

- 18.9.1 A parent Teacher Meeting is an opportunity to connect with parents. The main objectives of this meeting are:
- to bring parents / guardians and school closer for the benefit of the child.
 - to exchange views and ideas regarding the child's performance, progress and behaviour in order to promote his/her wellbeing.
- 18.9.2 Two parent-teacher meetings are held in a year i.e.
- One at the beginning of the first term – to discuss the course and expectations from students during the year.
 - One in the middle of the First Term – to share progress and provide a report on First Term.
 - One in the middle of the Second Term – to share progress and provide the end of year report.
- 18.9.3 The teacher should always maintain confidentiality. The performance of a child should never be discussed in the presence of others.
- 18.9.4 Before the meeting:
- The teacher should allocate a time slot so that only one child's parents are there to attend the meeting.
 - The teachers should be well-prepared before the meeting, should make an outline and gather material (example of student's work etc.). The teacher should know the strengths and areas that need improvement.
 - The teacher should inform parents beforehand if the child is struggling in academics, or has any behaviour or social issues so that they come mentally prepared to discuss.



19. SCHOOL POWER OUTAGE POLICY (RECOMMENDED)

- 19.1 In case of a power outage, classrooms, and/or faculty offices that have sufficient natural light may not require evacuation and the class may continue as scheduled. The BH/Class Teacher will determine if there is sufficient light.
- 19.2 In other cases, although there may be adequate natural light, hot weather may make the students extremely uncomfortable to further attend any lesson. In this situation, the power outage policy may be followed.
- 19.3 Generators may be used in case of a power failure/in the event of a power outage. Non-essential electrical equipment e.g. computer equipment and appliances should be turned off or unplugged.
- 19.4 In case of a power failure, when the power returns to the building the Officer in-charge shall restore the power after ensuring the following:
- Turn essential equipment back on gradually.
 - Wait 10 to 15 minutes before reconnecting other equipment.
 - Ensure everything is operating correctly.
 - Restock the workplace emergency kit so it is ready if needed again.
 - Review the emergency plan, identify what worked, and where improvements can be made.
- 19.5 However, if the school experiences a complete power failure due to the breakdown of a generator, the following options are to be exercised:
- 19.5.1 For Students:
- If complete power failure lasts longer than 10 minutes, lessons should be suspended and children should be taken out of their classrooms.
 - If it appears that it will take more than 1 hour to fix the problem, an SMS should be sent to parents to collect their children early. The text of the SMS is as follows:
- “Dear Parent, There has been an unexpected power outage. Please arrange for your child to be collected as soon as possible.
Regards,
School Management.”
- 19.5.2 For Staff:
- The FM team shall only leave the school once all the students have been collected by the parents and a plan for the next day has been finalized.
 - The BH may allow a teacher to leave once all the children in his/her class have been collected by parents.
 - An SMS shall be sent to parents confirming that the school is functional after power restoration.
- 19.6 Generator repair / hiring
- 19.6.1 In case of generator malfunctioning, the BA shall contact to the contractor responsible for maintenance of generator.



- 19.6.2 The contractor shall be asked to provide the backup generator during the repair period, if required.
- 19.6.3 If the generator cannot be repaired in time for the next day, the school can arrange a rental generator.
- 19.6.4 In case of non-provision of backup generator upto the next day, the BA shall arrange the generator on rent. All the provisions, regarding hiring of services, as mentioned in this Manual shall be followed.
- 19.6.5 The rental generator must be installed and tested before the end of the day, for next day use.



SECTION 4:

ACADEMICS



20. INTRODUCTION - MANDATORY

At United Charter Schools, our students reach their full potential through the advanced curriculum, inspired teaching, personalised learning and the unwavering support of teachers and parents. We enhance the educational environment with INFINITY, our communication and information technology tool powered by Singapore-based Knowledge Platform. We believe in keeping up with the global digitalising world and providing students with state-of-the-art, competitive and experiential facilities to learn, excel and explore infinite possibilities. At each grade level, students are challenged to learn and grow academically and personally. Our faculty and staff guide students as they gain understanding and proficiency across all subjects.

20.1 OBJECTIVE

- 20.1.1 This Module aims to describe the policies and procedures (in conjunction with Academic Practices and Procedures Manual-APPM) with respect to the Education Department of United Charter Schools- A Project of Beaconhouse.
- 20.1.2 UCS Education Department is focused on achieving academic excellence and guiding the Campuses to achieve the best results in the Board and Cambridge Examinations.

21. GETTING STARTED TOOLKIT - MANDATORY

- 21.1 A supportive school environment has a meaningful influence on student achievement. Policies and protocols must be in place to ensure a smooth and healthy interaction between the administrators, the teachers and the students. This helps promote a sense of belongingness and explains the relationship between the school environment and student success.
- 21.2 Concerted effort focused on a safe learning environment can result in enhanced student behavioral and emotional functioning, and in turn, strengthen academic motivation and achievement. The readiness of the school is an effort that plays an important role in enriching the learning experience of the students and following are a few considerations that would help the school leadership to do so:

Operations

- Display of the UCS Vision and Mission Statement.

VISION

United Charter Schools enable rewarding and successful futures for young people through quality education, enabling them to make impactful contributions to the nation and the wider world.

MISSION STATEMENT

United Charter Schools strive to provide a positive and inspiring learning environment that nurtures creativity and critical thinking and empowers students to reach their full potential through a holistic curriculum.



- Display of United Charter Schools Core Value.
- Designing a School Improvement Plan (SIP) at the end of the first Academic Year.
- School Improvement Plan evaluated, prepared and shared with the staff by the BH.
- Activity Calendar with an Action Plan.
- Succession Management Plan.
- Staffing and timetabling.
- Orientation plans for Early Years especially and for transition classes.
- Preparations completed for open house.
- All repair and maintenance work to be completed at least two weeks before the teachers join for the new academic session.
- Proper parking allocation for BHs / teachers / visitors / admin staff.
- Duty registers prepared - distinct duties and members assigned for canteen discipline, home time, early morning etc.
- Day 1 plan for current students and new admissions - teachers/placards directing students to their classrooms etc.
- Parent complaint register.
- Photocopies of take-home letters completed.
- Parental consent obtained before uploading any picture or video of students online.
- Classroom supplies and materials.
- Simple, colourful backdrops to display student work.
- Bulletin boards prepared.
- Comfortable and well-functioning labs shall be ensured.
- The computers, software, and media technology available should also be looked after.
- Become familiar with the UCS FSOM school procedures for obtaining books and materials, disciplinary procedures, etc.

Academics

- Teachers' folders, student registers to be prepared before the academic session begins.
- Lesson plans and the relevant resources for the first two weeks of the upcoming academic session must be ready by the teachers before the first day of the school.
- Upcoming events' display board for parents at a prominent place to be updated every month.
- Orientation plans (especially for transition classes) or Open House.
- Orientation plan of new staff members.



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- New admission tests printed.
- The first letter to the parents introducing new academic head (if any), details of uniforms (regular and sports kit), attendance policy, discipline policy, grading and assessment pattern, expectations from parents / students, the official communication channel to be followed between the school and the parent, shared within the first week of the new academic session.
- Every year, a school faces the perennial challenge of safeguarding the heritage of its institution. Modern dynamics of an educational organisation render an ever changing environment constantly demanding to be addressed. Make it easy on yourself, the secret to a successful start of the new school year will always be in the details.



22. GUIDELINES FROM HEAD OFFICE – MANDATORY

22.1.1 The schematic approach to be followed is covered to provide guidance on the following matters:

Guidelines from Head Office

- Academic Calendar
- Timetabling
- Syllabus break-up/Schemes of Work
- Syllabus Coordination Meeting
- Daily Lesson Plans
- Formative/Summative Assessment & Examination System
- Date Sheet & Examination
- Online Classes
- Library Management
- Science Laboratories
- Teacher Assessment & Feedback
- Teacher Training
- Conducting Teachers Evaluation & Student Feedback Surveys for Quality Assurance
- Co-curricular Activities

22.2 ACADEMIC CALENDAR

The Academic Calendar is organized and shared by the Head Office Education Department at the beginning of the Academic Session, in August each year, with all proposed dates of curricular, co-curricular activities and examinations.

22.3 TIMETABLING

For the guidelines of timetabling refer to the Academic Practices and Procedures Manual (APPM).

22.4 SYLLABUS BREAK-UP/SCHEMES OF WORK

Term-wise Syllabus Break-ups and Schemes of Work (SOW) will be provided by the Head Office Education Department.

22.4.1 BH shall ensure that curricula for all subjects per class are completed in time according to the Schemes of Work and Academic Calendar shared by the Head Office.

22.4.2 Teaching shall be carried out strictly by the syllabus breakup and to enable the students to attempt the End of Year Examinations (EOYE) and Board/Cambridge Examination in a befitting manner.

22.4.3 The full syllabus shall be covered within the allocated time. We do not believe in selective studies. Moreover, the Board/Cambridge pattern should be followed in teaching.



- 22.4.4 Additional classes may be planned and arranged for the subjects where the pace of syllabus coverage was slow during the session.

22.5 SYLLABUS COORDINATION MEETING

- 22.5.1 It is recommended that syllabus coordination meetings are held bi-monthly with teachers, to ensure the syllabus coverage and quality of teaching by the Franchise Branch Head.
- 22.5.2 It is recommended that notebooks are maintained by every student to serve as evidence of timely completion of syllabus and quality of teaching.
- 22.5.3 It is important that the minutes of these coordination meetings are taken and records are maintained.

22.6 DAILY LESSON PLANS

BH will receive Daily Lesson Plans designed by the Head Office Education Department as per relevant syllabus/Schemes of Work for all classes in advance.

22.7 FORMATIVE/SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT & EXAMINATION SYSTEM

For Formative & Summative Assessment and Examination system refer to Assessment Policy & Student Evaluation System in Academic Practices and Procedures Manual (APPM).

22.8 DATE SHEETS AND EXAMINATION

- 22.8.1 Date sheets for Mid-Year and End of Year Examinations are provided by the Head Office at least fifteen (15) days prior to the first exam.
- 22.8.2 Send-ups/Mocks and Pre-Board Examinations are managed centrally by the Head Office

22.9 CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- 22.9.1 Co-curricular activities are an integral part of education. They help to mould the students' characters. They develop a sense of healthy competition and create high moral values. Co-curricular activities provide students with the chance to put studies into practice, as well as network with like-minded individuals. The co-curricular activities promote leadership qualities through formal and informal learning experiences. These activities promote student success and enhance teaching and learning beyond the classroom.
- 22.9.2 FO Campuses are encouraged to provide their students with co-curricular activities as well.
- 22.9.3 Co-curricular activities will also benefit in the following ways:
- Higher Grades
 - Better attendance
 - Lower dropout rates
 - Fewer disciplinary referrals



- Affiliation with peers who are academically focused and increased concentration to hit the higher targets.

22.9.4 Franchise Branch Heads can consult the Academic Calendar that outlines the Co & Extra-curricular Activities.

23. ONLINE CLASSES - MANDATORY

23.1.1 Teachers shall conduct online classes using the school premises preferably.

23.1.2 In case the government does not allow teachers to conduct classes from school they shall be allowed to take classes from home.

23.1.3 **FOs must ensure that online classes are conducted through Google Classroom in case of school closure.**

23.2 CONDUCT OF CLASSES

23.2.1 Teachers shall conduct live classes using the Google Meet features present in Google classrooms. Class shall be conducted keeping in view the following:

- Recap previous knowledge/ lesson.
- Announce the new topic for the current class.
- Prepare a proper presentation.
- Discussions and question/ answer sessions to be conducted.
- Due date for submission of any assignment to be clearly announced.
- Students to be asked to turn on the microphones and cameras to ensure class visibility and audio clarity.
- Review the lesson before the end of the class and announce the topic of the next class.

23.3 TIME TABLE

For the timetable of online classes please follow instructions from the HO Education Department.

23.4 ATTENDANCE

23.4.1 Taking the attendance of the students shall be the responsibility of the teacher.

23.4.2 Attendance shall be uploaded on OMS each day.

23.5 RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE BH:

23.5.1 The BH shall be responsible for the following in case of Online Classes:

- Monitoring of the classes and ensuring maximum student participation.
- Contacting the absent students, pursuing rigorously for attending classes and clearing their outstanding dues (if any).
- Ensuring that the Lesson Plans are being followed.
- Ensure that the class is interactive, learner centered and the Teacher is receptive for question and answer sessions.



- Personally observe at least two (02) classes per day and have an overview all classes to ensure the proper conduct of the online classes.
- Motivate teachers with guidance and appreciation.
- Ensuring that weekly Syllabus Coverage is taking place.

23.6 RESPONSIBILITIES OF TEACHERS

23.6.1 Teachers involved in Online Classes should know that they are the face of UCS and are in the process of rapport building with students. They are expected to observe the following;

- They should be online at least ten (10) minutes before their prescribed class time.
- They must be well prepared with the resources required for the lesson.
- Good communication skills must be practiced.
- They are required to dress up in a neat, tidy and presentable way.
- They should avoid availing leaves during online classes except in an emergency.
- In case of emergency, timely approval for leave may be sought by the respective BH.
- They shall check assignments on a regular basis and discuss them with the students.

23.7 MONITORING BY HEAD OFFICE AND REGIONAL HEADS

23.7.1 Head Office Academics department/Regional Heads shall have overall monitoring of holding/ management of the online classes.

23.7.2 HO Academics Department/Regional Heads shall keep close contact with Campus teams in this regard.

23.7.3 HO may ask for a collated report on the conduction of online classes.

23.8 COMMUNICATION WITH PARENTS

23.8.1 Parents of Pre-Nursery to Class VIII students shall be informed that promotion to the next class is subject to verification of attendance and participation in quizzes, assignments, tests etc. in online classes.

23.8.2 For O Levels and Matric students, the enrolment with the Board and University shall be subjected to verification of attendance and participation in quizzes, assignments, tests etc. in online classes.

For details refer to UCS Academic Practices and Procedures Manual (APPM).



24. LIBRARY MANAGEMENT - RECOMMENDED

Libraries at the franchise campus, shall be managed by Franchise Branch Head and Franchise Owner independently.

25. SCIENCE LABORATORIES - RECOMMENDED

- 25.1.1 Science Laboratories must be well maintained as per Board and Cambridge requirements.
- 25.1.2 Inventory Registers must be properly maintained with a date wise issuance record of chemicals/ equipment.
- 25.1.3 Students must be provided with enough opportunities for hands-on experience to perform practical.
- 25.1.4 Safety Rules should be displayed at some prominent place in the Laboratory.
- 25.1.5 Laboratory Rules -Do's
 - 25.1.5.1 Always follow your teacher's instructions carefully.
 - 25.1.5.2 Keep your notebooks and paper away from heating equipment, glassware, chemicals and flames.
 - 25.1.5.3 Tell your teacher immediately if you cut or burn yourself.
 - 25.1.5.4 Tell your teacher immediately if you break any glassware or spill chemicals. Spillages, even of water, need to be cleaned up without delay.
 - 25.1.5.5 Wait until hot equipment has had time to cool before putting it away.
 - 25.1.5.6 Leave all benches and tables clean and dry after your experiments.
 - 25.1.5.7 Wash your hands after you have handled any substances in the laboratory.
 - 25.1.5.8 Point test tubes away from your eyes and your fellow students.
 - 25.1.5.9 Wear safety glasses while mixing or heating substances.
- 25.1.6 Laboratory Rules -Don'ts
 - 25.1.6.1 Enter the laboratory without your teacher's permission.
 - 25.1.6.2 Run, push or behave roughly in the laboratory.
 - 25.1.6.3 Eat or drink in the lab.
 - 25.1.6.4 Smell or taste substances unless instructed to by your teacher.
 - 25.1.6.5 Pour substances down the sink without the consent of your teacher.
 - 25.1.6.6 Mix chemicals unless instructed.
 - 25.1.6.7 Look directly at the top of a test tube, beaker or flask



26. TEACHER ASSESSMENT & FEEDBACK GENERAL - MANDATORY

- 26.1.1 In order to assess the quality of teaching and learning, it is recommended for BH to regularly observe teachers through classroom observations.
- 26.1.2 Aims of the assessment:
- Improving teaching and learning
 - Recognizing students' achievements
 - Improving teaching skills
 - Supporting career development
 - Identifying training needs
 - Providing guidance and training
 - Improving the academic standards
- 26.1.3 The outcome of the assessment may be used for taking decisions about any increments and promotions. The main areas for classroom observation are as follows:
- Class Management: Ability to organise and control the class.
 - Conducive learning environment
 - Subject Expertise: Sound knowledge of his/her subject and the ability to make it interesting.
 - Teaching Skills: Ability to explain the subject matter according to the students' needs.
 - Effective use of Resources
 - Correct implementation of the Lesson Plan
 - Time Management
 - Meaningful integration of technology.
- 26.1.4 Classroom Observation & Post Observation Feedback:
- Classroom observation for teacher assessment and student learning must be followed by the post observation feedback. The key aspect of post observation feedback is to share the areas for development with the teacher. This will aid the professional development of the teacher.
 - The annual assessment report should not be a surprise for the teacher. It should be an ongoing process. Following are the types of assessment techniques which will be conducted for the continuous guidance of the teachers.
 - Class room observation form is attached as **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-007)**



26.1.5 Lesson Observations

BH shall observe the teaching-learning process in the school closely to maintain the quality of teaching and class discipline. Following are some suggested types of lesson observations:

26.1.5.1 Formal Observations

BH shall inform the teacher in advance about the lesson observation and observe full-length lesson. In this way, they will have a clear idea of teachers' lesson delivery and his/her rapport with the students. The feedback of this observation must be shared with the teacher along with guidelines for improvement.

26.1.5.2 Informal Observation

A surprise observation on random basis should also be conducted to have a true picture of lesson delivery by a teacher.

26.1.5.3 Peer Observations

Teachers of the same subjects may be scheduled to observe each other. This will help in the following:

- Helping new teachers to learn class management techniques by observing the experienced ones.
- Quality of content delivery may be monitored more effectively by Peer Observations.



27. TEACHERS' TRAINING - MANDATORY

- 27.1 UCS acknowledges that its success and achievements fundamentally lie with the knowledge, skills, expertise and motivation of its human resources. UCS considers training as a job requirement and a means towards career path progression, succession planning and skill enhancement and so we encourage our FOs/BHs to follow the same philosophy.
- 27.2 UCS offers Teachers Training for all teachers including those in FO schools. Details of these training courses and their applicability on FO schools are mentioned in the UCS Training Catalogue.
- 27.3 BHs are encouraged to establish a positive learning environment for all employees of their schools and make online, classroom, courses, and on-the-job training available to them.
- 27.4 UCS believes in an ongoing professional development of teachers and BH. Various ongoing Teacher training workshops and courses shall be arranged by the Head Office. Some will be mandatory while others will be paid and need based.
- 27.5 Teacher Training shall be an ongoing process.
- 27.6 Each training session will have a feedback session in the end which will not only provide an assessment on that day's training but will also form the information about the future training needs.
- 27.7 In addition, Certification courses for teachers can also be planned (5 days course focused on teaching methodologies). This will be offered as the long-term target as it will involve a higher level of resources and finances. These can be paid training programs as well.
- 27.8 Campuses may contact the Head Office for their training needs.

These trainings will help teachers in identifying their own areas of development and develop their own Professional Development Plans (for details refer to the UCS Training Catalogue).

27.9 CONDUCTING TEACHERS EVALUATION AND STUDENT FEEDBACK SURVEYS FOR QUALITY ASSURANCE

- 27.9.1 The Education Department at the HO conducts surveys to evaluate students' satisfaction and teachers' performance every year. Findings of these surveys are shared with the relevant Franchise Branch Head and Franchise Owners are advised to keep these findings in view at the time of yearly appraisals.



28. ENHANCING ACADEMICS - MANDATORY

To meet the individual needs of the students, teachers must ensure:

28.1 PLANNING CHALLENGING TASKS FOR HIGH ACHIEVERS

Teachers must plan extension tasks for the High Achievers to challenge and nurture their abilities.

28.2 PAYING ATTENTION TO WEAK STUDENTS

28.2.1 Teachers must provide extra coaching to slow learners.

28.2.2 Slow Learners and the students who are not regular may be identified and dealt with personally by the relevant teacher and the BH regularly. They shall provide counselling to the students and call parents to discuss their progress.

28.3 PRESENTATION OF ANSWERS AND PAPER SOLVING TECHNIQUES FOR O LEVELS & MATRIC STUDENTS

28.3.1 For O Levels and Matric students, it is recommended that the paper presentation and solving techniques shall be continuously discussed during the Test Sessions as a Best Practice.

28.3.2 For attempting the question paper, time distribution is very important. Time management skills shall be taught and practiced during Test Sessions.

28.4 STUDENTS' COUNSELING FOR O LEVELS & MATRIC STUDENTS

At the time of admission/bifurcation, students may be provided guidance when choosing the right discipline of studies.

28.5 MOTIVATION FOR TEACHERS AND ACADEMIC STAFF

28.5.1 BH shall conduct meetings with teachers on a regular basis for discussing academics and co-curricular activities.

28.5.2 O Levels and Matric teachers producing competitive results shall be recognized by the FO/BH.

28.5.3 Student feedback and result shall be considered while preparing annual appraisals of Senior School teachers.

28.5.4 BH shall ensure the justified workload assigned to each staff member. Please refer to APPM for guidelines.

28.5.5 Teachers shall be assigned as in charge for different activities as per their interest and capabilities.

28.5.6 BH shall immediately share the information they get from the HO with teachers and staff.



29. QUALITY ASSURANCE DEPARTMENT - MANDATORY

29.1 INTRODUCTION

- 29.1.1 Quality is beyond the compliance of regulators' defined standards rather it is a culture in itself. Education occurs within a very complex and dynamic environment with several factors continuously challenging and affecting the quality. There is no single factor which affects quality of education, rather different determinants emerge and have lesser or greater impact on it. Focusing on only one of the aspects of educational ecosystem; be it infrastructural or teachers related, would not help in improving quality as a whole. There can be various key factors that may influence the quality in schools. Quality education is the foundation of sustainable holistic development and economic growth. It is a challenge to provide quality in academics to empower our young generation to look forward and become productive individuals in real workforce of the country.
- 29.1.2 For quality assurance, our schools need to develop and improve their internal evaluation processes in line with best academic standards and practices.

29.2 STRATEGIC QUALITY OBJECTIVES

Objective of Quality Assurance Department is to assist schools in implementation of UCS policies and procedures and strategies in the following areas:

- Ensure appropriate standards of quality education.
- Analysis of data and monitoring closely the progression and growth of the organization.
- Develop ethos to ensure quality education, good governance and transparency.

29.3 KEY RESPONSIBILITIES OF QUALITY ASSURANCE DEPARTMENT AND ITS FUNCTIONS

- 29.3.1 The focal persons for Quality Assurance Department will be liaising with the FO/BH for ensuring:
- quality assurance processes set by UCS are being followed.
 - UCS policies are being implemented in true spirit.
 - the campuses' quality assurance procedures are designed to fit the requirements of regulators and help to raise standard of quality education thus, promoting stake holders and public confidence.
 - assistance required by a campus to grow and flourish in terms of standard and attainment of goals is provided.
 - structural and academic review of UCS and for giving clear and explicit standards as points of reference for the reviews to be carried out. It is also responsible for the review of quality of teaching and learning at our schools.



29.4 DEFINING THE QUALITY ASSURANCE PROCESSES

Implicitly, the responsibility to maintain and improve the standards of quality of academic activities rests with the BH. Role of the Quality Assurance Department is in the management, facilitation, and conduct of the quality assurance activities and evaluation processes. It would help them develop plans for improvement; hence, maximizing the standards of quality.

Definition of Quality Assurance for clear understanding of the subject is,

“The means by which an institution can guarantee with confidence and certainty, that the standards and quality of its educational provision are being maintained and enhanced”

29.5 SELF-EVALUATION

Ideally at the end of each academic year, a campus will conduct a self-evaluation procedure related to quality of education, teaching and learning outcomes, working conditions and overall conditions of the institution.



30. SCHOOL TRIPS & EDUCATIONAL VISITS - RECOMMENDED

30.1 SCHOOL EVENTS

- 30.1.1 Make events as culturally reflective and responsible as possible.
- 30.1.2 Personally meet and greet as many parents and community members as possible.
- 30.1.3 Try not to speak for too long. Keep the focus on student achievement and your school's current goals. Make it clear what the school's core business is.
- 30.1.4 Ensure students feel included and rewarded for their effort and achievement.
- 30.1.5 Thank and acknowledge parents for their support in the learning of their children and for the school.
- 30.1.6 Refer to the co and extracurricular event guidelines.

30.2 GUIDELINES FOR EVENTS level 2

SOPs for large scale events is as under:

30.2.1 PLANNING

- 30.2.1.1 The BH is responsible for overseeing the planning and execution of a large scale event (especially those involving participation from other schools).
- 30.2.1.2 Letters for permissions from official authorities to be sent out at least 4 weeks in advance.
- 30.2.1.3 All external vendors (bouncers, etc.) have to be screened and shortlisted at least 1 week prior to the event and issued individual ID cards. These must be verified on the day of the event and only approved people should be allowed in the event.
- 30.2.1.4 A parking plan has to be in place where applicable.
- 30.2.1.5 If the number of people attending cannot be accommodated in the school premises, the event should be held at an external venue.

30.2.2 TICKETS/INVITES

- 30.2.2.1 Tickets / Invites can only be given to United Charter Schools students.
- 30.2.2.2 If the event includes students from other schools (delegates), tickets / invites can be given to the delegates only.
- 30.2.2.3 If the school wishes to invite additional guests (by selling tickets or giving passes), each guest must be approved by the head of the school individually and a record of their names, CNIC/School ID, the phone number must be maintained.
- 30.2.2.4 Given the campus's capacity, a cap should be kept on the number of tickets to be sold/invites given.
- 30.2.2.5 Everyone attending the event has to either buy a ticket or have a pass. No verbal invites allowed.



30.2.3 EVENT DAY

- 30.2.3.1 While checking attendees for the event, the ticket has to be checked, torn in half and given back to the attendee.
- 30.2.3.2 A medical kiosk providing first aid has to be set up at the event.
- 30.2.3.3 At large scale events, some identification (T-shirts, badges etc.) should be there to tell United Charter Schools student management apart from the general public.

30.3 **PROPOSED SECURITY MEASURES FOR SCHOOL TRIPS**

- 30.3.1 The trip must be well planned in detail keeping in view security/safety of the route and site itself.
- 30.3.2 Every staff member accompanying the students must be selected based on their higher sense of responsibility and must be given specific duties/responsibilities. The BH or the senior most faculty member should be made overall In-charge of security.
- 30.3.3 Arrangement of transport should be reliable so that there is no likelihood of breakdown. Transporter should be verified through reference. It is advised that transporters should submit a copy of the driver's driving license and bus fitness certificate.
- 30.3.4 At least two guards should be arranged preferably on each bus/coaster. These guards should be from a reliable company and should be well trained.
- 30.3.5 Route permit should be taken in advance from relevant authorities.
- 30.3.6 Parental permission in writing should be obtained well before the trip.
- 30.3.7 Accommodation arrangements at destination should be organized at a well-known and safe/secure hotel/motel, etc.
- 30.3.8 Prominent points along the travel route should be selected as checkpoints so that movement of students' transport can be monitored by institute admin through cell phone reports.
- 30.3.9 Unsafe locations should be avoided as excursion spots.
- 30.3.10 Staff should ensure discipline is maintained during travelling.
- 30.3.11 The trip should preferably not be made public by the staff or students.



31. THIRD PARTY ORGANISATIONS AND SCHOOL ACCESS MANDATORY

- 31.1.1 The importance of co-curricular activities in a student's holistic development cannot be undermined. While each school feels the need to maximise the participation of all students in external activities, ensuring the credibility and reputation of organisations that extend invitations is an uphill task.
- 31.1.2 Below is the criteria that must be adhered to when collaborating with an agency/organization:
- 31.1.2.1 The activity/competition has strong academic value and the learning outcomes can be measured.
 - 31.1.2.2 No third-party organization is allowed access to review or use the school's intellectual property and/or confidential data in any condition.
 - 31.1.2.3 Third party organizations are not permitted to conduct any promotional activities within the school premises.
 - 31.1.2.4 A student may be allowed to enroll in more than one programme, however, to reduce the burden of paid enrolment into programmes, care must be taken that the total cost of these programmes should not exceed PKR 3,000 per term for a child.
- 31.1.3 Please bear in mind that the purpose behind this exercise is not to restrict participation in competitions, but to uphold the integrity of the school and its students, and to preempt any unprecedented occurrences which could sabotage the school's reputation.



SECTION 5:

STUDENTS DISCIPLINE AND WELL BEING POLICIES



32. SCHOOL DISCIPLINE AND BEHAVIOUR MANAGEMENT - MANDATORY

32.1 MANAGEMENT APPROACH

In UCS, we believe in proactively managing behaviour by placing emphasis on teaching and reinforcing appropriate behaviour. A set of respectful strategies are used which aim to increase and maintain appropriate behaviour while addressing inappropriate behaviour. This approach considers behaviour management to be an opportunity for social and values-based learning as well as a means of maximizing the success of academic education programmes. It is grounded in the belief that being firm and consistent in managing behaviour does not necessarily require interventions that include threats, ambiguous statements or punishments directed at the person. The focus of intervention has to be directed on the action at all times, and the behaviour separated from the individual.

32.2 PRACTICAL IMPLICATION

The UCS Discipline Policy reflects a holistic approach to education. This approach is defined as a unified, collective and collaborative action by educators, administrators, parents and students that has been strategically constituted to improve student learning behaviour, well-being and the conditions that support these characteristics.

Student achievement begins with keeping students in a safe classroom and healthy environment conducive to learning and free from disruption; and is committed to closing the achievement gap by providing access to all students a vigorous education that ensures all students will graduate prepared and career ready.

32.3 PURPOSE

The policy aims to:

- Promote human dignity through the provision of a safe, secure, positive and caring school community that encourages learning, positive peer and teacher relationships, self-motivation, self- esteem and self-discipline.
- Encourage and develop in students a strong sense of personal responsibility and responsibility towards others and a clear understanding of the consequences of their decisions and actions.
- Encourage parents to help their children support and show respect towards the school's authority and others.
- Provision of clear guidelines of behaviour regarding roles and responsibilities of students to parents as well as students.



32.4 **OBJECTIVE**

Students are the primary focus of UCS, in partnership with parents and community. In this context, School Discipline and Behaviour Management Policy is developed to:

- 32.4.1 Provide a safe, positive and caring environment.
- 32.4.2 Foster a clear understanding within the school working towards:
 - Improving relationships between staff, children and parents
 - Appropriate school values and attitudes
 - Alleviating aggressive/anti-social attitudes
 - Developing awareness of students' and UCS Management's roles in discipline and behaviour management.
- 32.4.3 Create a clear philosophy and approach within the school towards discipline and behavioural issues.
- 32.4.4 Set out the Management's expectations and the parameters defining consequences of students' negative behaviour.
- 32.4.5 Establish a forum for counselling related to behavioural issues.

32.5 **SCOPE**

- 32.5.1 This policy shall be applicable to activities conducted by students enrolled in and attending any UCS at early years, primary, middle, secondary (inclusive of O Level and Matric):
 - While on school premises
 - While on school-owned and operated school buses or on chartered buses
 - During school-sponsored activities
 - While away from school grounds if such conduct would directly affect the reputation, management and efficiency of the school.
- 32.5.2 This shall also apply to concerned employees and parents of students in certain cases. For the purpose of this Policy, the term 'Parent' shall mean the parents and guardians of the students.

32.6 **CODE OF DISCIPLINE**

- 32.6.1 UCS has developed a policy for school discipline and behaviour, based on the values of courtesy, cooperation, consideration and the development of self-discipline in behaviour and work habits. Through this, we aim to foster independence, responsible behaviour and self-esteem. The maintenance of discipline in schools is seen as a partnership between students, parents and the staff.



- 32.6.2 The UCS code of discipline will be in effect:
- During school hours.
 - While walking to and from school.
 - While students are being transported on school/chartered buses.
 - During recess and pack up time, while on school property.
 - At events being held before and after school timings.
 - During field trips, athletic events, overnight excursions under the school's supervision.
- 32.6.3 UCS will ensure that each teacher is trained thoroughly in classroom management. They will learn and develop strategies to create a positive environment in which students know how to behave.
- 32.6.4 UCS expects that parents will share the responsibility with the school in helping students to develop attitudes and values that will remain with them throughout their lives, enabling them to be lifelong learners and productive citizens.

32.7 STUDENT RIGHTS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

A positive school climate promotes learning. UCS believes that each student has the right to have:

- The best possible education the school has to offer.
- A classroom environment in which effective teaching and learning can take place.
- Teachers who help them learn how to behave appropriately in school.
- A learning environment that is free from disruption and any discrimination on the basis of race, ethnicity, religion and sex etc.

32.8 STUDENTS ARE EXPECTED TO:

- 32.8.1 Dress and groom in accordance with the applicable UCS uniform instructions, so as to meet fair standards of safety, health and decency.
- 32.8.2 Attend school regularly and be on time for all classes and functions.
- 32.8.3 Submit a leave application in time.
- 32.8.4 Use respectful, decent gestures and language when in contact with teachers, students and other persons.
- 32.8.5 Protect and take care of the school's property/assets.
- 32.8.6 Develop human qualities of tolerance, sympathy, understanding, courtesy and act responsibly.
- 32.8.7 Listen carefully, acknowledge instructions and complete the given tasks.
- 32.8.8 Know that behaviour and comments of a racist, sexual or bullying nature are offensive.
- 32.8.9 Be aware of all rules and regulations for student behaviour and conduct themselves in accordance with them.



32.9 PARENT RESPONSIBILITIES

- 32.9.1 Parents must work together with school staff to maximize a student's success at school. UCS is committed to working with and supporting families and expects cooperation from parents as well.
- 32.9.2 Parents are responsible for:
- 32.9.2.1 Making sure that their child is punctual and arrives at school on time every day; ensuring that their child arrives at school not more than 30 minutes before the start of the school day and leaves within a reasonable time after the school day or activity.
 - 32.9.2.2 Teaching the child to follow the instructions for uniform applicable in the school.
 - 32.9.2.3 Contacting the school when the child is absent and giving the reasons for the absence.
 - 32.9.2.4 Being aware that only people who show Student ID cards may pick a student from school during the school day; making sure that due care is taken in handing over the Student ID card to the person performing these activities.
 - 32.9.2.5 Informing the School Management immediately in case of loss, theft or misplacement of the Student ID card.
 - 32.9.2.6 Notifying the school of any changes in contact information, especially the emergency contact number.
 - 32.9.2.7 Informing the school in case of any change in their marital status or custodianship of the children.
 - 32.9.2.8 Adhering to school-developed on-site traffic plans for vehicles when bringing students to school or picking them after school. If the children travel on foot, on bicycles or motorcycles etc., encouraging them to follow safety and traffic rules.
 - 32.9.2.9 Ensuring that their conduct contributes to a caring, respectful and safe environment.
 - 32.9.2.10 Respecting the professional judgment of Teachers, BHs, and other staff providing support and services in the school.
 - 32.9.2.11 Working with school staff members to solve any discipline related issues or other problems; letting the school know if something has happened at home which can impact the child's behaviour in school.
 - 32.9.2.12 Responding promptly and co-operatively when informed by school staff of any problem concerning their children.
 - 32.9.2.13 Reviewing, complying with and signing messages/circulars/progress reports from Teachers.
 - 32.9.2.14 Participating in parent-teacher meetings to discuss academic progress and areas for development of the student.
 - 32.9.2.15 Participating in school functions as often as possible.



- 32.9.2.16 Understanding the rules of the schools and talking to their children about them.
- 32.9.2.17 Becoming acquainted with School policies.

32.10 **INFRACTIONS**

The types of behaviour that fall into the category of misconduct or gross misconduct are described in this section. While not complete, the following list of infractions contains examples of the types of behaviour that are considered unacceptable and may result in initiation of disciplinary action detailed against each behaviour pattern. Please refer to **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-008)**.

32.10.1 Bunking/Truancy

Bunking means to run away or disappear from a class suddenly and secretly during class time. Truancy means absence from school or assigned classes or activity without reasonable excuse.

32.10.2 Academic Dishonesty/Cheating/ Plagiarism

Students are expected to maintain the highest level of ethical standards. Students are required to exhibit honesty in both verbal and written form. Academic dishonesty includes cheating, copying answers from fellow students and plagiarism during assignments, tests and exams. Plagiarism means the unauthorized use or close imitation of the language and thoughts of another author and the representation of those as one's own original work, by not crediting the author.

32.10.3 Forgery

Forgery means the crime of fabricating a document, picture or signature with the intent to deceive.

32.10.4 Failure to Comply with Instructions

This includes:

- 32.10.4.1 Refusal to comply with requests or directions of teachers, employees or management of the School acting within the scope of performing their duties.
- 32.10.4.2 Non-compliance with students' responsibilities such as instructions for uniform, school timings, submission of leave applications etc.

32.10.5 Smoking

This means smoking of any type of cigarette (including e-cigarettes) by students during the school day within school premises.

32.10.6 Inappropriate Use of Communication/Electronic Devices

Inappropriate use of communication/electronic devices includes:

- 32.10.6.1 Use of mobile phones by students.
- 32.10.6.2 Inappropriate photography, filming or messaging using cell phones, cameras or any other electronic device.



32.10.6.3 Pictures/videos made without consent or permission of Branch management on school property, school vehicles and at any school-sponsored activity.

32.10.7 Misuse of Computer, Internet and Technology

Misuse of computer, Internet and technology includes, but is not limited to, the following:

32.10.7.1 Unauthorized access to read, alter, transfer, delete or damage information belonging to the School, Teachers or other Students.

32.10.7.2 Installing software, shareware or freeware on school-owned computers without appropriate permission.

32.10.7.3 Use of internet/computer facilities to view or transmit inappropriate, obscene, threatening or abusive messages, pictures or videos.

32.10.7.4 Use of computer facilities to interfere with normal operations of the school (including, but not limited to hardware, software and networking equipment).

Note: Please refer to the IT Official for further guidance.

32.10.8 Offensive Language/Conduct

This includes socially and morally unacceptable speech, behaviour and gestures by students. It also includes vulgar, offensive and/or disruptive tattoos, language and physical gestures by a student to other students or staff members.

32.10.9 Gang Activity/Fighting Frays

32.10.9.1 A gang is a group of two or more individuals from within or outside the school who associate on a continued basis for the purpose that poses a threat to individual students or group(s) of students or disrupts the orderly school process.

32.10.9.2 Verbal or physical combat by two or more individuals that represents a safety issue and/or a disruptive incident is classified as fighting. Conflicts involving a group of individuals that become or threaten to become physical in nature are defined as frays. Fights and frays involving groups or individuals may, if there is evidence of group association, be considered as gang activity and will be dealt with accordingly.

32.10.10 Vandalism (Property Crimes)

Vandalism (Property Crimes) includes the following:

32.10.10.1 Damage, alteration, injury, defacing or destruction of any building, fixture, equipment or other property

32.10.10.2 Wilful writing or making marks on walls/furniture or any school equipment

32.10.10.3 Obtain or use any property belonging to the School without appropriate permission from the School Management.

32.10.10.4 Arson etc.



32.10.11 Threats and Harassment

This includes harassment, bullying, hazing, teasing or intimidation and wilful injury. Bullying, harassment or intimidation means intentional misconduct, including verbal, physical or written misconduct or through electronic communication.

32.10.12 Narcotics and Dangerous Substances

32.10.12.1 This includes possession, use and distribution of alcohol, narcotic drugs, prescription drugs and Substance Abuse.

32.10.12.2 UCS does not accept the possession, use or supply of alcohol, drugs or psychotropic substances in the school, or on outside school related activities by any member of the school community.

32.10.12.3 UCS does not accept the possession, use or supply of tobacco in the school, on school activities (e.g. field trips) or in non-school time by any student.

32.10.12.4 UCS does not accept the inhalation / misuse of solvent based substances (gases, glue, correction fluids and thinners, petroleum products and some aerosols) in the school, or on outside school related activities by any member of the school community.

32.10.12.5 The administration must be informed by parents/guardians, in writing, of their child's medical conditions.

32.10.12.6 Students may have prescribed or over-the-counter medicines for legitimate personal use only.

32.10.12.7 Students who have in their possession and take medical drugs in school must inform the school administration in writing.

32.10.12.8 A student or teacher may not give another student any prescription or over-the-counter medicine.

32.10.12.9 Only nominated personnel within the school (e.g. school staff or Official designated by BH) may administer specific prescription medicine after written consent by parents / guardians to that effect.
Please refer to UCS Medical Assistance Policy for further information

32.10.12.10 Chemicals in school laboratories will be held under lock and key. Students will handle and use such substances only under their teacher's supervision.

32.10.13 Harassment of Staff and Teachers

This includes abusive language, threats and/or physical harassment to teachers. In case any of the teachers or other staff of the school is harassed by any students/parents, it shall be viewed as serious misconduct.

32.10.14 Sex Offences and Sexual Harassment

32.10.14.1 This includes sexual advances, requests for sexual favours, and other inappropriate verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature when made by any student/parent to another student or to a staff member, whether conducted with or without consent of both parties.

32.10.14.2 Any misconduct of a sexual nature shall be viewed as a serious offence.



32.10.15 Weapons

32.10.15.1 The Management prohibits students from possessing weapons (object that is used to inflict injury) of any kind, whether for offensive use, self-protection or any other reason. Weapons include guns and pistols, any kind of knife, fire crackers, pellet guns, razors, chemical and biological weapons (acid etc.).

32.10.15.2 The Management views the possession and/or use of a weapon as serious misconduct.

32.10.16 Parent Misbehaviour / Trespassing

This includes:

32.10.16.1 Instances when parents use offensive language or misbehave/harass or fight with teachers or other school staff.

32.10.16.2 Entering the school property for the purpose, or with the effect, of unduly interfering with the proper functioning of the School.

32.10.16.3 Wrongfully using, removing, altering or damaging school property.

32.10.16.4 Placing on, or removing from, school property any printed, drawn or animated material without permission of the school management.

32.10.17 Parent Misbehaviour with other Parents

This includes instances where parents are involved in fighting, misbehaving or harassing other parents within school premises or vicinity.

32.11 CONSEQUENCES

32.11.1 Consequences are defined as appropriate strategies to remediate behaviours that are not in line with this Policy. These will depend on the type of infraction, age, class and frequency of occurrence. This will be left to the discretion of the Management of each individual United Charter School.

32.11.2 In situations where the school rules e.g. regarding alcohol, drugs and substance abuse are broken, sanctions will be imposed depending on the nature of the offence (low, medium or high). It is at the discretion of the BH to categorize incidents / repeat incidents in one of three levels.

32.11.3 Consequences for all the above mentioned infractions by students/parents are described in [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-008\)](#).

32.11.4 If any student or parent is involved in serious offences or crimes covered under Pakistan Penal Code (Act XLV of 1860), the Management reserves the right to take appropriate legal action against such students/parents.

32.11.5 In the event of an infraction, the sanctions, punishments, inquiries and consequences for all employees of the system have been outlined in detail in the "Code of Conduct" section of this Manual.

32.11.6 The Management expects teachers to try and examine the internal causes of misbehaviour and develop ways or strategies to help the child construct new initiatives and new behaviour.



32.11.7 For Primary Level Students

In primary schools, the objective of introducing this Policy is to develop self-discipline as the students move into secondary school. They need to develop routines, build strong relationships with their teachers that reflect their learning, behaviour and actions. They need to know expectations and consequences. Whilst positive and assertive discipline is encouraged, it is important that primary level students know the consequences of inappropriate behaviour. In case of primary level students, disciplinary action shall be a maximum of Level 3 as prescribed in [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-008\)](#) of this Manual. However, if any kind of misbehaviour is shown by parents of primary level students, the Management reserves the right to take serious disciplinary action against them.

32.12 DISCIPLINARY ACTION AND RELATED PROCESS

32.12.1 Actions at School Level

- 32.12.1.1 Any student, parent or Branch employee may report any infraction observed by them. These infractions shall be immediately reported to the class teacher or Branch management. (HM, Coordinator, SM).
- 32.12.1.2 There shall be immediate involvement of the concerned class teacher/staff member who is supervising the student. The class teacher/staff member shall conduct a preliminary investigation of the matter and shall have discussions with concerned students, staff members.
- 32.12.1.3 In case of minor infractions, the concerned class teacher/staff member shall provide/arrange counselling for the student. The class teacher may also verbally reprimand the student and issue strict verbal instructions besides informing the BH.
- 32.12.1.4 In case of repeated/serious infractions by students or their parents, the class teacher or any other concerned school staff member shall refer the matter by letter to the BH immediately (within a maximum of 3 days) for appropriate action(s). The following shall be reported in the said letter:
 - Infractions occurred
 - Number of infractions
 - Findings of preliminary investigation
 - Recommended remedial actions in accordance with this Policy
- 32.12.1.5 The BH shall review the letter and decide the appropriate remedial action.
- 32.12.1.6 To determine the intensity of the infractions, the concerned class teacher and BH shall exercise judgment keeping in view the facts found and the past attitude/behaviour of the student.
- 32.12.1.7 If appropriate, the BH shall form a committee consisting of two senior Branch employees to investigate the matter further. This committee shall submit its findings to the BH within 3 days. This committee shall also recommend actions to be taken against the students found guilty.



- 32.12.1.8 The decision of the BH shall be communicated to the concerned teacher and student for compliance, with a copy of the decision to the parents, if applicable.
- 32.12.1.9 In the following cases, the BH shall refer the matter to the UCS Management with recommendations for cancelling the admission of the student found guilty:
- Possession/use of guns/pistols within school premises/vicinity
 - Sexual harassment/offences
 - Abusive language/physical harassment to teachers
- 32.12.1.10 Further, if the BH is of the opinion that any other infraction is of a level/serious nature that requires cancellation of admission of the student, he/she will write a letter/memo to the FO, containing all details of the matter.
- 32.12.1.11 The student, who has been referred for cancellation of his/her admission, shall not be allowed to come to school or participate in any school-related activities until a decision is made by the Disciplinary Committee.
- 32.12.1.12 All students concerned in a breach of this Policy, whether they directly committed the act constituting the breach of discipline or aided in its commission, shall be subject to this Policy as much as those directly involved

32.12.2 Cancellation of admission cases forwarded to UCS Management shall be dealt in accordance with the UCS policy. For detail please refer to **Clause 11.3.1** of this Manual.

32.13 APPEALS/REINSTATEMENT OF STUDENT

32.13.1 Concerned students/parents have the right to appeal against the decision of suspension/cancellation of admission as follows:

Decision Making Authority	Appellate Authority
Branch Head	Franchise Owner (FO)

- 32.13.2 Within seven (7) working days after receipt of notice of cancellation of admission or other disciplinary action, the student or parents/guardians may appeal against the decision to the concerned authority.
- 32.13.3 All the facts and reasons shall be mentioned in the appeal.
- 32.13.4 The concerned authority shall consult all relevant stakeholders and take the decision, which shall be forwarded to the concerned Office/Branch and parents within 15 days of filing the appeal.
- 32.13.5 In such exceptional circumstances where a student is reinstated by the Appellate Authority, s/he will have to pay all fees/dues for the period between cancellation of admission and reinstatement. The said student will also have to submit an undertaking duly signed by his/her parent giving assurance of a good conduct.



32.14 DISCIPLINARY ACTIONS ASSOCIATED WITH INFRACTIONS

Disciplinary actions have been tabulated in [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-008\)](#).

32.15 RECORD KEEPING

Proper and up-to-date records of all infractions and disciplinary actions taken shall be maintained by the designated officer at each respective Branch and Office. A copy of these documents shall also be placed in the student's personal file.



33. ANTI BULLYING POLICY - MANDATORY

33.1 AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

- 33.1.1 All staff and students should have an understanding of what is socially acceptable and what is not. Bullying is not acceptable and will not be tolerated. Members of staff need to discuss suspected bullying/friendship problems in whole staff and year group meetings.
- 33.1.2 Bullying is wrong and damages individual students, either physically or psychologically, and could even result in suicide. Schools need to do all they can to prevent it, by developing a school ethos in which bullying is regarded as unacceptable. UCS aims to produce a safe and secure environment where all can learn without anxiety. This policy aims to produce a consistent school response to any bullying incidents that may occur. This includes a procedure to follow: who to tell; how to record bullying to enable patterns to be identified.
- 33.1.3 This policy aims to make all those connected with the school aware of UCS's opposition to bullying, and make clear each person's responsibilities with regard to the eradication of bullying in schools by raising awareness of staff through training, taking action to reduce the risk of bullying at times and in places where it is most likely and by using educational elements such as personal, social and health education (PSHE), assemblies, circle time, projects, drama, stories, literature, historical events, current affairs and so on. Regular training shall help staff in dealing with bullying issues. Adequate supervision at break-times, in areas such as the playgrounds and changing rooms, is important in preventing bullying.
- 33.1.4 Students should be comfortable with the procedures and confident in using them. Staff will be encouraged to pursue strategies to encourage positive behaviour.

33.2 PRACTICE AND PROCEDURE

UCS aims are achieved by providing clear guidelines to students, staff and parents. Whenever possible relevant cross-curricular opportunities should be taken to highlight, enhance and reinforce anti-bullying issues. Appropriate support should be offered to the victim and the bully. Parents should be informed of the School's policy through the relevant home/school communication tools such as newsletters, workshops, meetings etc.

33.3 STUDENTS AWARENESS

- 33.3.1 Students should be made aware of the issues surrounding bullying and know the importance of reporting any bullying incident to a member of staff, parent or a friend.
- 33.3.2 Students at UCS should be given a clear understanding of school expectations on behaviour through assemblies, PSHE and wellbeing sessions and through the school curriculum.



- 33.3.3 Students should be made aware of the harm that bullying causes and of the range of sanctions that the School is obliged to use, including the involvement of outside agencies.
- 33.3.4 Students should be given a clear understanding of the definition, impact and seriousness of bullying through the curriculum (year group projects, drama, stories, literature, historical events, and current affairs).
- 33.3.5 Students should know what to do and who to turn to if they are being bullied.
- 33.3.6 Students should know what to do if they witness others being bullied.
- 33.3.7 Students have a duty to report bullying whether it is happening to themselves or others. Student representatives (School Council, Student Forum, and Heads of House) have a duty to report problems of bullying, individual or group, and to be involved in fashioning solutions with the School.
- 33.3.8 Students should receive further support as necessary.

33.4 STAFF AWARENESS

- 33.4.1 Staff awareness of bullying takes place through training, meetings and discussions. Staff should look out for signs which may be indicators of bullying, such as:
- 33.4.1.1 Unexplainable injuries.
 - 33.4.1.2 Lost or destroyed clothing, books, electronics, or jewelry.
 - 33.4.1.3 Frequent headaches or stomach aches, feeling sick or faking illness.
 - 33.4.1.4 Changes in eating habits, like suddenly skipping meals or binge eating.
 - 33.4.1.5 Low grades, loss of interest in schoolwork, or not wanting to go to school.
 - 33.4.1.6 Sudden loss of friends or avoidance of social situations.
 - 33.4.1.7 Feelings of helplessness or decreased self-esteem.
 - 33.4.1.8 Self-destructive behaviours such as running away from school, harming themselves, or talking about suicide.
- 33.4.2 Teachers should use educational opportunities such as PSHE, other subject lessons and assemblies to support good behaviour and to educate students about bullying.
- 33.4.3 Teachers and Leadership Teams are required to ensure that all students in UCS know who they would turn to if they have a concern or worry or believe that they are being bullied. It is the responsibility of all staff to be mindful of potential patterns of bullying and victim behaviour.

33.5 RESPONSIBILITIES OF BRANCH HEAD

- 33.5.1 It is the responsibility of the BH of the school to implement the school Anti-Bullying Policy and to ensure that all staff (both teaching and non-teaching) are aware of the school policy and know how to deal with incidents of bullying. The BH sets the school climate of mutual support and praise for success, so making bullying less likely. When students feel they are important and belong to a friendly and welcoming school, bullying is far less likely to be part of their behaviour. The BH



ensures that all staff receive sufficient training to be equipped to deal with all incidents of bullying.

- 33.5.2 The BH, sets clear expectations of behaviour and kindness to endeavour to make bullying less likely. When students feel they are valued and belong to a friendly and welcoming school, bullying is far less likely to be part of their behaviour.

33.6 THE ROLE OF PARENTS

Parents who are concerned that their child might be being bullied, or who suspect that their child may be the perpetrator of bullying, should contact their child's class teacher immediately. Parents will always be contacted, after initial investigations have been carried out, if their child is found to have been involved in an instance of bullying. Parents have a responsibility to support the school's anti-bullying policy and to actively encourage their child to be a positive member of the school. Parents may be asked to tender an undertaking of future good behaviour of their child(ren). Where cyberbullying occurs, UCS will provide guidance and support. When this happens outside the jurisdiction of the school, UCS will communicate and co-operate with parents as necessary. Parent of child subject to bully may be followed up for a certain period and record their feedback as well.

33.7 PARENTAL LIABILITIES FOR FAILURE TO CONTROL THEIR CHILDREN

- 33.7.1 Parental responsibility for the delinquent acts of their children has long been recognized in the United States. Parents may be held civilly or criminally liable for their children's acts of juvenile delinquency. Such envisaged crimes perpetrated by children include the causing of physical or psychological harm such as damage to property, bullying, assault, sexual assault, the infringement of dignity and privacy, cybercrimes, gun-related offences, defamation, and even murder.
- 33.7.2 Pakistan has not yet enacted special laws relating to criminal parental liability but they cannot be absolved from their parental responsibilities and obligations towards such acts or omissions of the parent's child. An example can be drawn from the Kite Flying Act which holds a parent criminally liable if his minor is found to be flying kite.

33.8 CYBER BULLYING

The rapid development of, and widespread access to, technology has provided a new medium for 'virtual' bullying, which can occur in or outside school. Cyber-bullying is a different form of bullying and can happen at all times of the day, with a potentially bigger audience, and more accessories as people forward any content at a click. 'Cyber bullying' refers to inappropriate text messaging or emailing and inappropriate use of social network sites (like Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, SnapChat, YouTube, etc.) as well as sending offensive images by phone, internet or email. For further information please refer to the UCS Anti-Cyber Bullying Policy (**Section 34** of this Manual).



33.9 SANCTIONS

Sanctions for bullying should be in line with the School's Behaviour policy. Sanctions, may begin with a private and confidential warning letter. Stronger sanctions such as suspension and exclusions, may be necessary and imposed in cases of severe and persistent bullying.

33.10 ASSESSMENT AND RECORD KEEPING

Class teachers should keep appropriate logs and records of individual cases, for both perpetrator and victim. Once referred to the BH, further records of individual cases need to be kept in file in confidential student folders. Record keeping allows opportunities to retrieve and analyze incident reports chronologically and by student/s, which can be of particular value in identifying patterns of victim and/or bullying behaviour. If copies of reports, cannot be provided to the parents concerned, they should be effectively informed and be given an access to read the file in school if so desired.

33.11 RESPONSE BY BRANCH MANAGEMENT

33.11.1 The Role of the Class Teachers

33.11.1.1 If teachers become aware that bullying is taking place between members of a class, they should deal with the issue immediately.

33.11.1.2 This may involve counselling and support for the victim of the bullying. Abuse by one or more students against another student should result in immediate referral to the HM/BH, if necessary.

33.11.1.3 Teachers will attempt to support all students in their class and to establish a climate of trust and respect for all. By praising, rewarding and celebrating the success of all students, UCS aims to prevent incidents of bullying.

33.11.1.4 Teachers in UCS should take all forms of bullying seriously and intervene to prevent incidents from taking place. They shall refer bullying incidents immediately to the appropriate person as identified above.

33.11.1.5 Class teachers should log all incidents of bullying for future reference and monitoring.

33.11.2 If incidents of bullying reoccur then the student may face detention and the parents will be issued with a formal letter outlining the nature of the bullying and informing them that if any future incident occurs, the matter will be referred to the BH, who will inform them of the next stage as deemed appropriate.

33.11.3 Following the notification of a behavioural incident (including those which may include bullying), the BH will usually ask the Class Teacher to help in the investigations. Class Teachers and another Senior Teacher may be involved in further pastoral work with the victim and bully, after action points have been agreed by the BH.



- 33.11.4 Class Teachers are often best suited to identify potential patterns of bullying through time. They are expected to be vigilant and notify the BH should they suspect a pattern of behaviour linked to either bullying or being a victim.
- 33.11.5 Class Teachers draw students' attention to the UCS's stance on bullying at suitable moments. If an incident occurs, the BH may decide to use an assembly or meeting as a forum to discuss with other students why this behaviour was wrong. The Class Teachers will also use the PSHE programme as a vehicle for ensuring that the school ethos of anti- bullying is laid out and reinforced.
- 33.11.6 BH may take appropriate action in accordance with School Discipline and Behavior Management Policy.
- 33.11.7 Template for Recording Bullying Behaviour is attached as [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-009\)](#).



34. ANTI-CYBER BULLYING POLICY - MANDATORY

UCS embraces the advantages of modern technology in terms of the educational benefits it brings. UCS recognizes that technology plays an important and positive role in everyone's lives, both educationally and socially. However UCS is also mindful of the potential for bullying to occur. UCS is committed to help all members of the school community to understand both the benefits and the risks, and to equip students with the knowledge and skills to be able to use technology safely and responsibly. UCS recognizes that it must take note of bullying perpetrated outside any of the UCS, which spills over into the schools. The UCS anti-cyberbullying policy is operational in conjunction with the E-Safety Policy and the UCS Anti-bullying policy.

34.1 AIMS

34.1.1 The aims of this policy are to ensure that:

- 34.1.1.1 schools and the parents together safeguard the students in the real and virtual world
- 34.1.1.2 staff, students and parents are educated to understand what cyberbullying is and what are the consequences of it
- 34.1.1.3 knowledge, policies and procedures are in place to prevent incidents of cyberbullying in schools or with school communities
- 34.1.1.4 students, parents and staff are aware of effective measures to deal with cases of cyberbullying
- 34.1.1.5 parents and student are aware that cyber crime is a punishable offense under the "Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act (PECA) 2016" and there is 'National Response Centre for Cyber Crime (NR3C) – FIA', a law enforcement agency dedicated to fight cyber-crime.

34.2 WHAT IS CYBERBULLYING?

34.2.1 According to the NR3C and the PECA, Cyberbullying is:

"Cyber stalking (also called cyber harassment) is when someone uses the Internet to threaten or make unwanted advances towards someone else. This sort of harassment can cause physical, emotional, and psychological damage to the victim. Children are particularly vulnerable because of their trusting nature and give away their personal information."

34.2.2 Mr. Bill Belsey, the creator of the website: <http://www.cyberbullying.org/> defined this unpleasant and particularly intrusive phenomenon in following words:

"Cyberbullying involves the use of information and communication technologies to support deliberate, repeated, and hostile behavior by an individual or group that is intended to harm others."



34.3 WHY AND HOW DOES CYBERBULLYING TAKE PLACE?

- 34.3.1 A lot of innocent teasing happens on social networking websites, applications and text messages. So when does a good joke go bad? When someone repeatedly harasses, mistreats, or makes fun of another person.
- 34.3.2 It is important to remember that not all 'nasty' messages posted online are defined as bullying. Sometimes, they are a one-off. But when there is a prolonged campaign that appears to target one individual, then it becomes cyberbullying.
- 34.3.3 Not all nasty messages constitute cyberbullying. A lot of cyber bullying occurs when children lose sight of the consequences. Some don't think sending messages which they see as 'just kidding' or 'joking' is bullying, and don't understand how it can hurt someone.
- 34.3.4 One of the most common reasons for cyberbullying is an attitude among bullies that they won't get caught. Internet anonymity empowers bullies and leaves them feeling like they cannot be traced. As well as this, students at times lose sight of the fact that posting online is a form of publishing; they see internet as 'not the real world'. This feeling leads to children believing that they cannot be reprimanded for what they do online.

Examples of cyberbullying include:

- 34.3.4.1 via social networking sites e.g. posting a malicious message on somebody's profile, or the creation of a fake profile, or conversation on a public page.
- 34.3.4.2 filming, texting or sharing inappropriate materials and comments on mobile phones and passing an inappropriate material or joining in with these behaviours.
- 34.3.5 Cyberbullying can involve emails, SMS and mobile phone cameras along with social networking sites. In addition it can be used to carry out all the different types of bullying; an extension of face-to-face bullying. It can invade home/personal space and involves a greater number of people.
- 34.3.6 It can be an illegal act.

34.4 THE EFFECTS OF CYBERBULLYING

Many children on the receiving end of a barrage of nasty messages suffer drops in school grades, low self-esteem, changes in interests, and depression. But, cyberbullying can also have more serious effects on a child's wellbeing. Because of how and where it occurs – on the Internet – children are subjected to cyberbullying at all times when they are online, including in their home. Other than making it difficult to combat as a school, this means that bullies can reach others in the one place they expect to be safe and can also lead a victim to feel that the bullying is inescapable. In just a few clicks, an embarrassing photo or nasty post can be shared all over a website for a whole school to see. In the most extreme of cases, cyberbullying can contribute to feelings of suicide and self-harm.



34.5 PREVENTING CYBERBULLYING

Prevention of cyberbullying is a difficult task as it happens on the Internet therefore is difficult to police. However, the best way to prevent it is to treat it as a whole school community issue with coordination and cooperation between home and school.

- 34.5.1 Parents and the schools are to ensure that all the students know that, no matter what its form, all bullying is wrong and will not be tolerated. Students need to be taught about their online rights and responsibilities and should be aware of that the Internet is not a private place.
- 34.5.2 Parents and the schools need to promote the positive use of technology, discuss and inform the students about good 'netiquette' and personal safety issues.
- 34.5.3 Teachers are encouraged to use role plays and examples to open up discussion about cyberbullying.
- 34.5.4 Students need to be educated about cyberbullying through variety of means: assemblies, workshops, seminars, anti-bullying week, projects (ICT, PSHE in English and Urdu curriculum).
- 34.5.5 Parents need to be provided with information and advice on cyberbullying via literature.
- 34.5.6 Schools need to ensure that all staff and children understand the importance of password security and the need to log out of accounts.
- 34.5.7 The policies and procedures need to be regularly evaluated and updated.

34.6 RESPONDING TO CYBERBULLYING

UCS already deals with bullying through anti-bullying policies and procedures, but cyberbullying, as outlined, presents new challenges. Most cases of cyberbullying will be dealt with through the school's existing Anti-bullying policy and the Discipline policy. However, some features of cyberbullying differ from other forms of bullying and may prompt a particular response.

- 34.6.1 The key differences are:
 - 34.6.1.1 **impact:** the scale and scope of cyberbullying can be greater than other forms of bullying
 - 34.6.1.2 **targets** and perpetrators: the people involved may have a different profile to traditional bullies and their targets
 - 34.6.1.3 **location:** the 24/7 and anywhere nature of cyberbullying
 - 34.6.1.4 **anonymity:** the person being bullied will not always know who is bullying them
 - 34.6.1.5 **intent:** some students may not be aware that what they are doing is bullying
 - 34.6.1.6 **evidence:** unlike other forms of bullying, the target of the cyberbullying will have evidence of its occurrence.



- 34.6.2 It is possible that a member of staff may be a victim and these responses apply to them too.
- 34.6.3 The safeguarding of the child is paramount and staff should investigate in accordance with the UCS Student Protection policy.
- 34.6.4 As a System, there are things that will be done in the battle against online bullying. These measures require cooperation and joint effort of both the parents/guardians and the school staff.
- 34.6.4.1 **Support:** Provide the student being bullied with support and reassurance. Staff, and parents need to tell them that they did the right thing by telling. It is important to encourage the child to get help from parents, BH or teachers. Parents and staff need to ensure students know that there is support there for them.
 - 34.6.4.2 **Evidence:** Parents and staff need to help the child keep relevant evidence for investigations. This can be done by taking screenshots or printing web pages. Do not allow the deletion of phone messages.
 - 34.6.4.3 **Inform:** Give the child advice for making sure it does not happen again. This can include changing passwords, contact details, blocking profiles on social networking sites or reporting abuse online.
 - 34.6.4.4 **No Retaliation:** Ensure that the child does not retaliate or reply to the messages.
 - 34.6.4.5 **Privacy:** Encourage the child to keep personal information private on the internet.
 - 34.6.4.6 **Investigation:** The cyberbullying claim needs to be investigated fully. If the perpetrator is known, ask them to remove offending remarks or posts. All records should be kept as part of the investigation.
 - 34.6.4.7 **Report:** Abuse on social networking sites or through text messaging needs to be reported to the websites and mobile phone service providers; in case of serious offense, it needs to be reported to the FIA's National Response Centre for Cyber Crime (NR3C).
 - 34.6.4.8 **Guidelines:** UCS has a number of policy documents which parents and staff can refer to. These include the E-safety policy, Anti-bullying policy and Discipline Policy.

34.7 REPORTING OF CYBERBULLYING INCIDENTS

- 34.7.1 Students are encouraged to contact senior leadership team of the school when they are concerned about bullying issue.
- 34.7.2 Schools will publicize and promote the message that asking for help is the right thing to do and shows strength and good judgment.
- 34.7.3 Schools will provide information for all students including reassurance about 'whistleblowing' and the appropriate way of informing concerned staff or parents about incidents they have witnessed.



- 34.7.4 Parents and students will be provided information on external reporting routes e.g. NR3C helpline 1991.
- 34.7.5 UCS shall not indulge in reporting to external agency but would more focus on passing on the information promptly after internal investigation and will opt for the implementation of anti-cyberbullying policy at the school's end.

34.8 RECORD KEEPING

- 34.8.1 All the reported incidents will be recorded and stored safely. Annual review of the reported incidents will guide the policy review and development of anti-cyberbullying programme and structures in the school.
- 34.8.2 Parent of the child subject to bully may be followed after a certain period and their feedback shall be recorded.

34.9 EVALUATING THE EFFECTIVENESS OF ANTI CYBERBULLYING MEASURES

- 34.9.1 BH shall conduct student survey at least once in a year. The survey will provide crucial information on the experiences of the students to identify key issues and consult and involve them in ways forward. The results will contribute to the system wide results to help inform future strategy and policy evaluation.
- 34.9.2 Along with this an annual evaluation will be conducted, including a review of recorded cyberbullying cases.

34.10 LEGAL PROVISIONS AND PUNISHMENT

- 34.10.1 The UCS have a duty to protect all its members (both staff and students) and provide a safe, healthy environment.
- 34.10.2 The school staff may request a student to reveal a message or other phone content and may confiscate all or any devices appeared to be used for the cyber bullying, till such time as may deem appropriate. However, the parents shall be intimated immediately to contact the school.
- 34.10.3 If a student is involved in cyberbullying of a fellow student or staff member, the UCS will exercise their power to administer punishment ranging from suspension to possible expulsion. Some cyberbullying activities could be criminal offences under law and therefore punishable.
- 34.10.4 Details are available in the PECA 2016, accessible via the following link:
<http://www.lawsofpakistan.com/wp-content/uploads/2016/07/the-prevention-of-electronic-crime-act-2016.pdf>

34.11 ADVICE FOR PARENTS AND GUARDIANS ON CYBERBULLYING

This advice is for parents and guardians about cyberbullying. It provides advice and information about how they can protect their child from cyberbullying and how to tackle it if it happens.



34.11.1 Overview

Cyberbullying is bullying that takes place using technology. Whether on social media sites, through a mobile phone, or gaming sites, the effects can be devastating for the young person involved. There are ways to help prevent a child from being cyberbullied and to help them cope and stop the bullying if it does happen. Parents and guardians need to be aware that most children have been involved in cyberbullying in some way, either as a victim, perpetrator, or bystander. By its very nature, cyberbullying tends to involve a number of online bystanders and can quickly spiral out of control. Children and young people who bully others online do not need to be physically stronger and their methods can often be hidden and subtle. Cyberbullying can also involve adults; even though technology has provided wonderful opportunities for both teaching and learning, it has led to some teachers becoming the victims of internet messaging that undermines or ridicules them. It is important that parents make clear that this is not acceptable behaviour and lead by example. What was once a conversation at the school gate between small groups of parents and guardians can now become a conversation with perhaps hundreds of 'friends' on social networking sites, permanent, with a large audience, and easily shared. Whilst parents and guardians have the right to raise concerns and be critical of decisions made by schools, or individual members of staff, they should raise concerns in an appropriate way. Open conversations on social networking sites are not private and can easily be reported to school staff, even if it was not the intention to share their views directly.

34.12 SOME HELPFUL STRATEGIES

- 34.12.1 Supervise children's Internet access and set boundaries about what they can and cannot do online. Parents can create an agreement with them and if the child breaks the rules, their Internet access can be restricted for an agreed period of time.
- 34.12.2 Ensure you use the privacy settings, parental controls and built in internet safety features.
- 34.12.3 Social networks have a minimum age restriction, usually age thirteen. Parents should talk to their children about the reasons behind the age restriction as they are there for a reason. Accessing such sites too early can expose children to unnecessary bullying.
- 34.12.4 It is important to ensure that the child is comfortable in sharing their feelings with parents. Talking to children will help parents the ways in which the children are using the Internet, social media, and their mobile phones.

34.13 SOME HELPFUL WEBSITES FOR PARENTS

Following links to websites can provide guidelines on cyberbullying and how to talk to children to develop a trusting environment:

- <http://www.internetmatters.org/issues/cyberbullying.html%23learn>



- <http://www.nspcc.org.uk/preventing-abuse/child-abuse-and-neglect/bullying-and-cyberbullying/what-is-bullying-cyberbullying/>
- <https://www.saferinternet.org.uk/advice-centre/parents-and-carers/parental-controls-offered-your-home-internet-provider>
- <https://www.childnet.com/parents-and-carers/what-do-i-need-to-know>
- <http://www.antibullyingpro.com/parentsguardians>

34.14 ADVICE FOR CHILDREN

34.14.1 The following are some things that parents may wish to consider teaching their children about using the internet safely:

- 34.14.1.1 Make sure you use the privacy settings.
- 34.14.1.2 Always respect others – be careful what you say online.
- 34.14.1.3 Be careful what pictures or videos you upload. Once a picture is shared online it cannot be taken back.
- 34.14.1.4 Only add people you know and trust to friends/followers lists online. When talking to strangers, keep your personal information safe and location hidden.
- 34.14.1.5 Treat your password like your toothbrush – keep it to yourself and change it regularly.
- 34.14.1.6 Block the bully – learn how to block or report someone who is behaving badly.
- 34.14.1.7 Do not retaliate or reply to offending e-mails, text messages or online conversations.
- 34.14.1.8 Save the evidence. Always keep a copy of offending e-mails, text messages or a screen grab of online conversations and pass to a parent, a guardian or a teacher.
- 34.14.1.9 Make sure you tell an adult you trust, for example, a parent, a teacher.
- 34.14.1.10 Most social media services and other sites have a button you can click on to report bullying. Doing this can prevent a bully from targeting you and others in the future. Many services take bullying seriously and will either warn the individual or eliminate his or her account.
- 34.14.1.11 While you are on your mobile phone make sure you also pay attention to your surroundings.

34.15 POSSIBLE SIGNS OF CYBERBULLYING

It is not always easy to spot the signs of cyberbullying as it can happen all the time, which is a feature that makes it different from other forms of bullying.

Be alert to a change in your child's behaviour, for example:

- Being upset after using the internet or their mobile phone;
- Unwilling to talk or secretive about their online activities and mobile phone use.
- Spending much more or much less time texting, gaming or using social media.



- Many new phone numbers, texts or e-mail addresses show up on their mobile phone, laptop or tablet.
- After texting or being online they may seem withdrawn, upset or outraged.
- Not wanting to go to school and/or avoiding meeting friends and school mates.
- Avoiding formerly enjoyable social situations.
- Difficulty in sleeping.
- Low self-esteem.

34.16 SOCIAL NETWORKING

- 34.16.1 Children and adults alike routinely access social media and much of their social lives are online. This can create a false sense of security as online interactions feel different from face to face interactions; it is easier to say and reveal things as well as easier to be cruel or aggressive. It is important for everyone to remember that there are offline consequences to online behavior.
- 34.16.2 Comments intended to be funny can often be misinterpreted online whereas if said face to face they could be acceptable as facial expressions, body language, tone of voice and context all help to ensure that comments are taken the right way. This is not the case online. We also know that increasingly younger children are signing up to social network sites and may not have the maturity to handle their online identity in a safe and responsible way. Social networking can increase social pressures and reinforce sense of isolation; for instance by people purposefully not liking a young person's status update or photo so they seem unpopular, or by excluding them from group chats. Online bullying often involves a large audience and this increases the pressure. Parents need to understand the way young people communicate with others, and the potential risks. Asking their child simply not to use technology is not a realistic way to prevent or react to cyberbullying. They need to know what their children are doing online and also help them to do it in a safe way. With technology changing on a day-to-day basis, the best way to stay informed is for parents to be involved.

34.17 SECURITY PROTOCOLS FOR COMMON SOCIAL NETWORKING SITES

- 34.17.1 Facebook:
- Read Facebook's rules
 - Report to Facebook
 - Facebook Safety Centre
- 34.17.2 Instagram:
- Read Instagram's rules
 - Report to Instagram
 - Instagram Safety Centre
- 34.17.3 Snapchat:
- Read Snapchat rules



- Report to Snapchat
- Read Snapchat's safety tips for parents

34.17.4 Tumblr:

- Read Tumblr's rules
- Report to Tumblr by email
- If you email Tumblr take a screen shot as evidence and attach it to your email

34.17.5 Twitter:

- Read Twitter's rules
- Report to Twitter

34.17.6 YouTube:

- Read YouTube's rules
- Report to YouTube
- YouTube Safety Centre

34.18 ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR EXTERNAL REPORTING

SOCIAL NETWORK PROVIDERS

All the social network websites and apps and video-hosting websites have guidelines and security settings. For example:

- 34.18.1 Facebook: reports can be made by clicking on a 'Report Abuse'. There is an option to block profile of the person who is harassing.
- 34.18.2 Twitter: go to the help centre then follow the guidance under Safety and Security
- 34.18.3 MySpace: reports can be made via the 'Ask MySpace' link: <https://www.askmyspace.com/t5/Privacy-Abuse/bg-p/privacyandprotection>
- 34.18.4 Yahoo mail: there is a 'Help' link available to users when logged in, which contains a reporting form
- 34.18.5 YouTube: it is possible to report content to the site provider. In order to do so, you will need to create an account (this is free) and log in, and then you
- 34.18.6 will have the option to 'flag content as inappropriate'. The option to flag the content is under the video content itself.

NATIONAL RESPONSE CENTRE FOR CYBER CRIME (NR3C) – FIA

- 34.18.7 There is a Law enforcement agency, 'National Response Centre for Cyber Crime (NR3C) – FIA'. It is dedicated to fight cyber-crime and to identify and curb the phenomenon of technological abuse in society.
- 34.18.8 Online complaints can be filed on the link : <http://complaint.fia.gov.pk>



- 34.18.9 NR3C has a 24/7 cybercrime helpline 9911. It is dedicated for the general public to address their grievances and provide assistance regarding the cybercrime related issues. Complaints can be registered on this helpline.
- 34.18.10 The contact information for NR3C is given below:
- NR3C HEADQUARTERS
ADDRESS 2nd Floor, National Police Foundation Building, Mauve Area, Sector G-10/4, Islamabad, Pakistan.
PHONE +92 51 9106384
FAX +92 51 9106383
EMAIL helpdesk@nr3c.gov.pk
 - NR3C LAHORE
ADDRESS 4th Floor, FIA Building, 1st Temple Road, Lahore, Punjab. PHONE +92 42 99203047 – 48
FAX +92 42 37323041
 - NR3C KARACHI
ADDRESS 1st Floor ,FIA Building (Near Darul Sehat Hospital),Block 14,Gulistan-e-Johar Karachi. PHONE +92 21-99333950-51
FAX +92 21-99249651
 - NR3C PESHAWAR
ADDRESS Opposite RMI Hospital, Phase-5,Hayatabad, Peshawar, KPK. PHONE +92 91 9217109
 - NR3C RAWALPINDI
ADDRESS Al-Zahir Plaza, New Iqbal Town, Express Way, Islamabad. PHONE +92 51 2612280
 - NR3C QUETTA
ADDRESS NR3C/FIA, Banglaw No. 410/180 near City School Opposite Crescent Public School, City School Road Jinnah Town Quetta
PHONE +92 81 2870057



35. ALCOHOL, DRUG AND SUBSTANCE ABUSE POLICY - MANDATORY

35.1 INTRODUCTION

- 35.1.1 UCS is committed to address the needs of various stakeholders in relation to the abuse/misuse of alcohol, drugs and psychotropic substances. This policy outlines the identification, education, sanctions, record keeping and confidentiality issues involving usage of any substance which changes the way the body functions, mentally, physically or emotionally. Therefore, the policy describes the protocols around the possession, consumption, or distribution of alcohol, drugs, as well as a myriad of substances (including but not limited to smoking) by students of the system.
- 35.1.2 It is necessary that all stakeholders (leadership, teachers, parents, students and the community) involved work together to implement this policy to ensure student health and well-being across our schools. UCS acknowledges that as part of a community, it has an important role in terms of education, prevention, support and the handling of drug related incidents.

35.2 THE SCHOOL ETHOS

As stated in the UCS mission and vision, we are committed to provide a positive and inspiring learning environment that nurtures creativity and critical thinking. UCS enable rewarding and successful futures for young people through quality education, enabling them to make impactful contributions bringing benefits to our students, the community and wider world. We endeavour to ensure that students are equipped with the ability to make mature and well-informed judgments based on a clear understanding of essential principles, concepts and moral values. This commitment entails a development of personal responsibility. Therefore, in keeping with the school's commitment to students and parents, the following system-wide rules and regulations are recommended:

35.3 EDUCATIONAL AIMS

- 35.3.1 UCS is committed to provide a comprehensive Alcohol, Drug and Substance Education Programme (ADSEP) for all students.
- 35.3.2 The aims of ADSEP are:
- 35.3.2.1 To increase the self-esteem and confidence of our students.
 - 35.3.2.2 To equip our students with personal and social skills.
 - 35.3.2.3 To enable our students to make informed, healthy and responsible decisions.
 - 35.3.2.4 To provide clear, accurate and age appropriate information on drugs.
 - 35.3.2.5 To enable young people to identify sources of appropriate personal support.
 - 35.3.2.6 To minimize the harm caused by alcohol, drug and substance abuse by offering supportive interventions.



35.4 COMPONENTS OF ADSEP

- 35.4.1 Teachers, Leadership and Parents will play an integral part in creating awareness about alcohol, drug and substance abuse among students.
- 35.4.2 Parents/Guardians will be consulted on the need and nature of educational programmes for students and will be informed of the progress in the school. ADSEP will focus primarily on students in classes 7-11.
- 35.4.3 However, it is the responsibility of teachers and BHs to identify other at risk students (through a survey) that may benefit from targeted prevention (one-to-one sessions, counseling).
- 35.4.4 Along with the target audience the ADSEP is intended for individuals (of any age within the school community) that may fit any of the following descriptors:
- 35.4.4.1 Students whose knowledge about drugs is low.
 - 35.4.4.2 Students who feel under pressure to use drugs.
 - 35.4.4.3 Students who fall into an identified vulnerable group or are experiencing one or a number of risk factors.
 - 35.4.4.4 Students whose (or someone else's) drug use is impacting on their behaviour and/or emotional health.
 - 35.4.4.5 Students who live in a household where their parent/caregiver or other household member misuses drugs.
 - 35.4.4.6 Students whose (or someone else's) drug use is causing problems such as conflict at home.

35.5 IMPLEMENTATION

- 35.5.1 It is expected that a wide variety of teaching approaches will be used to deliver ADSEP. These approaches will be consistent with the aims of the PSHE programme and will ensure an initiative that enhances knowledge, skills, attitudes and awareness regarding alcohol, drug and substance abuse in schools, homes and the community.
- 35.5.2 Franchise Management shall discuss this policy with students, teachers and parents
- 35.5.3 Student alcohol, drugs, and substance abuse education may be achieved through:
- PSHE Programme
 - Science Curriculum
 - First Aid Courses
 - Outside speakers/drugs advisers where appropriate
 - Leveraging social media
 - The school website and Facebook page



35.6 CONSEQUENCES

Behaviour that are considered unacceptable have been described in **Section 32.10.12** of this Manual. Violation may results in disciplinary action detailed in **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-008)** or Code of Conduct (**Section 40**), as the case may be.



36. MEDICAL ASSISTANCE AND FIRST AID POLICY - MANDATORY

36.1 INTRODUCTION

UCS is committed to provide a safe and secure environment for all its students. Care of people and concern for their welfare are integral to the ethos of UCS. UCS is committed to ensure the health, safety and welfare of all employees, students and others who are legally present on our premises and in our workplace. In keeping with this commitment, priority is given to the provision of adequate first aid treatment for all persons at the school.

36.2 POLICY STATEMENT

36.2.1 From time to time any child may become ill and potentially require some time out of school to recover. In general, where a child requires medication (or treatment) for a condition which is temporary, they should be kept at home until the course of treatment is complete.

36.2.2 There are, however, a few exceptions for example:

36.2.2.1 when a child has almost fully recovered and simply needs to complete a course of medication (e.g. antibiotics) for a day or so and is not infectious/contagious.

36.2.2.2 where a child suffers from asthma (or any other occasional ailment) and may need to use an inhaler. Where equipment such as an inhaler is necessary, we strongly encourage children to take personal responsibility for these items. They may request a spare to be kept in the medical room in case of an emergency; the spare will be provided by the parents and it is parental responsibility to ensure it is replaced before expiration. Written instructions and details will be provided by the parents to the school office.

36.3 LEGAL ASPECTS

36.3.1 There is no legal duty on the school staff to administer medicines or to supervise a child taking it. This is purely a voluntary role. However the school acknowledges that circumstances may arise where such administration is desirable and in such cases staff should be cautious agreeing to administer medicines where:

- the timing is crucial to the health of the child
- where there are potentially serious consequences if medication or treatment is missed
- or where a degree of technical or medical knowledge is needed

36.3.2 Teachers' conditions of employment do not include giving first aid, although any member of staff may volunteer to undertake the task.

36.3.3 Staff volunteering to administer medicines should not agree to do so without first receiving appropriate information and/or training specific to the child's medical needs. The school will arrange adequate and appropriate training and guidance for the volunteering staff member so that they are enough trained to assess and treat minor wounds.



- 36.3.4 The main duty of the volunteering staff is to give immediate help to casualties with common injuries or illness and those arising from specific hazards at school. Under no circumstances any medication, even non-prescription drugs such as Paracetamol, be administered without parental approval.

36.4 ADMINISTRATION OF MEDICINE

There are several occasions when the school has to provide medical facility / medicines to the students. However, the schools must maintain a record of all students reported to have:

36.4.1 Drug allergies:

Any specific medical history, medical prescription and instructions for handling the situation (e.g., seizures, severe allergies, diabetes).

36.4.2 Emergency cases/ Students without a medical history:

- No medicine should be given to a child without the permission of the parents.
- In case of minor cuts and bruises, immediate first aid should be given and the parents need to be informed.
- In case the student asks for a particular medicine, parents' permission needs to be taken before providing the medicine.
- Urgent medications may, at times, be required for children who experience sudden pain (headaches, toothaches, stomach ache etc.) or fever.
- It is important that parents are informed and permission is sought prior to giving any medicine. Parents need to be informed and suggested to consult a medical expert for their child, especially if the situation is recurrent. There must be a small stock of painkillers (Panadol, ibuprofen etc.), and antihistamine in the school at all times, to be able to attend to such cases.

36.4.3 Students with a specific medical history/chronic health condition:

- A record of the medical history of students should be maintained by the class teacher.
- The class teacher should hold sessions with parents whose child requires medication in school.
- A consent form should be filled to avoid allegations/complaints by parents in future.
- The medicine provided to the student should be documented.
- Parents should be informed.
- There will be cases where the student is well aware of the medicine requirement.

36.4.4 Asthma:

The teacher has to monitor the student carefully and occasionally check if the inhaler is available with the student; especially, during the changing season.



36.4.5 Allergies/allergic reaction:

The teacher must inform the parent and ask for appropriate medication till the parent is available to pick the student up from school.

36.4.6 Diabetes:

Students with diabetes are usually aware of the immediate medication / food requirement. Therefore, the student should be facilitated and parents need to be informed in case of any untoward happening.

36.4.7 Epilepsy:

Epilepsy can be triggered by eatables like white bread, biscuits, high-sugar drinks and foods, fruit juices, chips etc. Therefore, parents of students who are reported to have epilepsy must be consulted and seizures can be controlled by drugs. Below is the first aid quick guide for epilepsy:

- The staff should stay calm.
- There is no need to move the student around if he/she is at a comfortable place.
- The time the seizure starts and ends needs to be noted down.
- A staff member needs to stay with the student.
- In case there is food or fluid in the mouth at the time of seizure, the student needs to be rolled over to the side so that the food/fluid slips out of the mouth and does not choke the windpipe.
- The student's head needs to be supported with a cushion or pillow if he/she has collapsed to the ground.
- There is no need to hold the student's back.
- There should be no attempt to administer any medicine or eatable in the student's mouth at the time of seizure.
- The student should be rolled over to the side after the jerking has stopped.

36.5 ARRANGEMENTS FOR FIRST AID

36.5.1 The School will provide materials and equipment and facilities to provide First Aid. The First Aid Kits should be available in the school office.

36.5.2 The school's senior leadership team is responsible for the provision of material, equipment and facilities to provide first aid.

36.5.3 A standard First Aid Kit will contain the following items:

- Leaflet giving general advice on First Aid
- **20** individually wrapped sterile adhesive dressings assorted sizes
- **4** triangular bandages
- **2** sterile eye pads
- **6** safety pins
- **6** minor wounds' dressings **1** pair of disposable gloves **1** bottle of Dettol



- 36.5.4 The contents of the Kits will be checked on a regular basis by the school office before undertaking any off site activities the level of first aid provision will be assessed by the BH and at least one First Aid Kit will be taken along.

36.6 INFORMATION ON FIRST AID ARRANGEMENTS

- 36.6.1 The BH will inform all employees at the school of the following:
- The arrangements for reporting and recording of accidents;
 - The arrangements for First Aid;
 - The location of the First Aid Kits.
- 36.6.2 All members of staff will be made aware of the School's First Aid policy. The BH must inform all staff of the first aid arrangements.
- 36.6.3 The simple method of keeping staff and students informed is by displaying first-aid notices in the staff rooms. The information should be clear and easily understood.
- 36.6.4 All the new members of the staff must be given first aid information during the induction programme. Notices must be displayed on a prominent place.
- 36.6.5 No member of staff should attempt to give First Aid unless he/she has prior training for it nor can they administer without supervision. Appointed person will be provided instructions to deal with minor cuts and bruises only.

36.7 ACCIDENT BOOKS

- 36.7.1 All the injuries, accidents and illness reported in the school will be duly recorded in the 'accident book'.
- 36.7.2 The playgrounds and swimming pool will have separate books for accidents that happen at playtimes, swimming lessons and lunchtimes.
- 36.7.3 The school office has its own book for accidents that happen at any other time. Accident book will be kept safely and accessibly under the custody of the appointed senior leadership team member.
- 36.7.4 All serious accidents must be recorded in the office book, on the same day, and then placed on the desk of the BH.
- 36.7.5 Schools must keep a record of any first aid treatment given at school. This should include:
- The date, time and place of incident.
 - The name and class of the injured or ill student.
 - Details of the injury/illness and what first aid was given.
 - What happened to the student immediately afterwards (for example went home, went back to class, went to hospital).
 - Name and signature of the staff member dealing with the provision of first aid and dealing with the incident.



36.8 ACCIDENTS INVOLVING BUMPS TO A STUDENT'S HEAD

- 36.8.1 Children often fall and bang themselves, the consequence of an injury from an accident involving a bump or blow to a student's head is not always evident immediately and the effects may only become noticeable after a period of time.
- 36.8.2 Parents/guardians must be contacted if the child has a visible or grazed bump on the head.
- 36.8.3 All head bumps must be recorded in the accident book. Where emergency treatment is not required a 'Head Bump' letter will be sent home to the parent/guardian.

36.9 TRANSPORT TO HOSPITAL OR HOME

- 36.9.1 The BH will determine the appropriate action to be taken in each case. Where the injury requires urgent medical attention an ambulance will be called and the student's parent or guardian will be notified. If hospital treatment is required, then the student's parent/guardian will be called for them to take over responsibility.
- 36.9.2 If no contact can be made with parent/guardian or other designated emergency contacts then the BH may decide to transport the student to the hospital.
- 36.9.3 Where the BH makes arrangements for transporting a child then the following points will be adhered to:
- No individual member of staff will be alone with the student in a vehicle;
 - A second member of staff will be present to provide supervision of the injured student.

36.10 PARENTAL RESPONSIBILITY

- 36.10.1 Parents are required to fill out following forms at the time of admission, and then subsequently every year at the beginning of the first term. In case the forms had not been present at the time of registration, please ask school office to provide them.
- 36.10.1.1 Medical history form - [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-010\)](#).
- 36.10.1.2 Child's immunization record.
- 36.10.1.3 Parental permission (consent) for medication administration - [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-011\)](#).
- 36.10.1.4 Parental permission (consent) for administration of off-the-counter medicines - [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-012\)](#).
- 36.10.1.5 Parental Permission (consent) for medical treatment and emergency transportation - [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-013\)](#).
- 36.10.2 These forms shall contain the following information:
- Name and date of birth of the child
 - Name of parents/guardian, contact address and telephone number
 - Name, address and telephone number of General Practitioner.
 - Name of medicines.



- Details of prescribed dosage.
- Date and time of last dosage given.
- Consent given by the parents/guardian for staff to administer these medicines.
- Expiry dates of the medicines.
- Storage details for the medicine.

36.10.3 The Parent Consent forms and medical history records will be copied and retained in a Student file as a record for future reference.



37. HEALTH & SAFETY - MANDATORY

A sensible approach to health and safety in schools means focusing on how the real risks are managed. This guidance will help those responsible for managing health and safety in schools to strike the right balance so that the real risks are managed and learning opportunities are experienced to the full. Following are covered in these guidelines:

37.1 ACCIDENTS

37.1.1 Reporting:

- Accident & Incident Reporting shall be done with extreme care.
- Every incident / accident must be in the notice of the BH.
- The place of the first aid box should be known to all staff members to reduce the injury response time. It should be ensured that it is placed at an easily accessible place.
- The authorized Teacher/Official should administer first aid to the student.
- Parents must be informed immediately. It is the BH's discretion to ask parents to take the child home. The BH must not insist on keeping the child in school if the parents want to pick him/her before home time.
- In case the student is absent after the accident, follow up calls need to be made by the Section Head / teacher.

37.1.2 Recording:

- Record of the accident / incident must be made by the authorized Teacher/Official.
- Record must contain the student's name, class & section, injury caused, first aid provided at school, person informed at home, initial reaction of and instructions by parents (if any).
- The first aid form must be signed by parents / guardian and filed in the student's personal file.
- Further Investigation of Accidents and Incidents for details is the BH's discretion.

37.1.3 List of documents needed in case of a legal claim:

- Statement of witnesses.
- Incident record.
- Any legal/medical document provided by the parent/guardian.
- Any other relevant document.

37.1.4 Student Accident Record:

- Class teachers should maintain a list of medical issues/concerns/allergies of their students.
- A centralized computerized list has to be maintained also in the school office.



37.2 **EMERGENCY CONTACTS**

School should maintain emergency information on each child and school personnel at the time of registration. A separate record must be maintained for children with special health care needs and/or chronic medical conditions, as follows:

- Name of parent/guardian and/or another responsible person, address, personal telephone number and emergency contact number.
- Name and contact information of another person in case the parent/guardian cannot be reached.
- Name and phone number of the family physician.
- Drug allergies (if any).
- Any specific medical history and instructions for handling the situation (e.g., seizures, severe allergies, diabetes).

37.3 **INJURIES**

The formulation of this policy enables our school to effectively;

- Provide for the immediate requirements of students who have sustained either a serious or a minor injury.
- Ensure that adequate resources and arrangements are in place to deal with injuries/accidents as they arise.
- Ensure that lines of communication with parents/guardians are in place if required.
- Activate a clear plan of action familiar to all staff members.

37.3.1 **Aims/Objectives**

- To ensure the physical safety and wellbeing of all staff and students.
- To develop a framework of procedures whereby all injuries are dealt with an informed approach.
- To provide training to the school staff in being able to handle injuries and engaging external expertise when and where required, so that children could be provided proper medical assistance.
- To comply with all legislation relating to safety and welfare at work.

37.3.2 **Minor Accident/Injury**

The injured party is initially looked after by the teacher on duty. If deemed necessary, the child will be taken to the 'sick room'. No medicines should be administered but cuts have to be cleaned with antiseptic wipes and bandages/plasters need to be applied where deemed appropriate. The use of plastic gloves by the attending staff member is advised. Parents have to be notified as per the policy.

37.3.3 **More Serious Accidents/Injuries**

If considered safe to do so, the injured party is taken to the sick room. Parents/guardians are immediately informed, particularly if there is a suspicion of



broken bones / head or eye injuries. The child shall be kept under intense observation until parents /guardians arrive, with the emphasis on making the child as comfortable and as settled as possible. It is advised not to attempt to physically handle the injury yourself and wait till the child could be taken to the hospital for an X- ray in the presence of the parents.

37.3.4 Very Serious Injuries

37.3.4.1 In the event of a very serious injury, parents/guardians are to be immediately contacted. If the opinion of the staff is that immediate professional help is required, an ambulance is called or the student is taken to the nearest hospital immediately. On rare occasions, the staff may agree that taking the student to Accident & Emergency in a private car is a more prudent option, particularly in the case of rapid blood loss. In such a case, parents need to be kept informed of the developing situation.

37.3.4.2 Schools are just as prone to accidents and injuries as other public or private properties. Schools are exposed to the potential for injuries that range from parking lot accidents, during trips, physical violence and bullying. Although claims against schools are more complex than typical personal injury, it is possible for a student or parents of a minor student to create problems / complications. The four most common accident and injury claims involving schools are detailed in the next section.

37.4 TYPES OF INJURIES

37.4.1 Playground Accidents:

37.4.1.1 Playground injuries may range from minor cuts and bruises to serious harm, such as brain injuries, broken bones, and amputations. Based on accident statistics, the most dangerous pieces of equipment are monkey bars, climbing equipment, and swings. Fatal accidents stem most often from strangulation and falls on playground surfaces. Strangulation can occur from swings, jump ropes etc.

37.4.1.2 Playground injury claims often take the form of negligence torts. The BH may be responsible for playground injuries depending on the nature of the incident. Defective or faulty equipment leading to injury takes the form of a product liability claim. It shall be the responsibility of school to provide adequate supervision, proper employee training and well maintained playground.

37.4.2 Sports-Related Accidents

Sports and recreational activities are the leading causes of musculo-skeletal injuries in students. School sports can lead to ligament sprains, muscle strains, growth plate injuries, repetitive motion injuries, broken bones, spinal cord fractures, concussions, dehydration, and heat stroke. A school may be liable for sports-related injuries if they result from negligent coaching, hazardous premises, or inadequate supervision. It is the PE teacher's responsibility to know how to train and oversee sports practices and games to avoid preventable accidents. For



example, the PE teacher may be liable for a brain injury if he or she forces a player back on the field too soon after a previous head injury.

37.4.3 Hazardous Premises Accidents

Premises liability refers to property owners – BHs – to maintain a reasonably safe premises for students and employees. This involves repairing known hazards, searching for unknown dangers, and posting adequate warnings of known but unrepaired hazards. Failure to obey these duties can result in harmful slips, trips, and falls; elevator/escalator accidents; parking lot accidents; swimming pool accidents; fires; and toxic chemical exposure. Slips, trips, and falls have a high incidence in schools.

37.4.4 School Violence

37.4.4.1 Many personal injuries stem from violence and intentional harm on school grounds. School violence encompasses bullying (both student-student and teacher-student), pushing, fights, gang violence, and assaults. School violence can lead to both physical and emotional harm. Incidents at school can result in injuries such as cuts, bruises, broken bones and head trauma to name a few common types of physical injuries.

37.4.4.2 School-related injuries are not always visible. Bullying can lead to severe emotional distress, negative behavioral outcomes, alcohol and drug use, and even suicide. Students may experience depression, severe social anxiety, fear, and post-traumatic stress disorder from exposure to violence at school.

37.4.5 Others

37.4.5.1 There are certain medical issues which do not come under the category of injury; yet, they affect students' health. Few of them are allergic reactions, such as asthma, breathing difficulty, choking, bites and stings, burns, diabetes etc. Students may come with these issues from home; yet, proper care at school in the wake of an attack/reaction is the responsibility of the BH.

37.4.5.2 Vigilance is the key to safe and healthy environment.

37.5 **HAZARDOUS SUBSTANCES**

37.5.1 Schools, where children spend about one third of their day, are expected to be a safe environment. Yet, there are many hazardous substances in schools that can be inadvertently or intentionally released and harm the health of students and teachers alike.

37.5.2 One of the responsibilities for safe and healthy environment as BH is to protect all at your school from being harmed from hazardous substances.

37.5.3 Substances in School

There are some hazardous substances that are commonly found on school sites. These include:



- Chemicals in the laboratories
- Aerosols, e.g. paints, air fresheners and fly sprays
- Diesel/petrol for generators
- Flammable paint and solvents
- Pesticides/agri-chemicals with gardeners
- Swimming pool chemicals etc.

37.5.4 Effects

Hazardous substances effects may include the following and others:

- Poisoning through ingestion, inhalation or skin absorption, for instance, losing consciousness or death as a result of being overcome by toxic fumes.
- Eye irritation or loss of sight from eye contact.
- Skin irritation or dermatitis from skin contact.
- Asthma as a result of developing an allergy to substances used at school.
- Infection from bacteria and other micro-organisms.

37.5.5 Laboratory Instructions for Staff

- 37.5.5.1 All substances must be stored under lock & key and records of use must be kept. Their use must be subject to risk assessment.
- 37.5.5.2 All bottles of chemicals must be clearly and correctly labelled, and only those chemicals in use or likely to be required in the near future should be kept in the laboratories.
- 37.5.5.3 Over-labelling of original manufacturers labels is forbidden.
- 37.5.5.4 Labelling must not be liable to facile removal e.g. on spillage of contents or splashing with solvent / water.
- 37.5.5.5 Before carrying out a procedure with hazardous materials (including micro-organisms) any risk must be identified and assessed. It is the responsibility of the Supervisor and the laboratory worker to jointly assess the hazards associated with their work.
- 37.5.5.6 Rapidly toxic/poisonous materials may only be handled in the presence of at least one other experienced person in the laboratory.
- 37.5.5.7 A cyanide antidote kit must be present in the laboratories. Only the required amount for the risk - assessed reaction is obtainable and residues must be destroyed immediately after use.
- 37.5.5.8 Students working with insects / micro-organism are at risk of developing allergic reactions. These reactions can be skin rashes, itchy eyes, and runny nose but if severe may lead to more serious conditions such as asthma. Suitable precautions must be taken to reduce these risks e.g. the use of face mask, gloves, visors etc.
- 37.5.5.9 When working with micro-organisms, a laboratory coat with side fastenings is recommended. This coat must be kept separate from other lab coats and outside clothing.



37.5.5.10 Gases which assist fire, e.g. oxygen, should be stored separately to flammable gases.

37.5.5.11 The door to the laboratory should be labelled with the gases in use to inform fire fighters in the event of a fire.

37.5.6 Solvents

37.5.6.1 Laboratory workers must be aware of the hazard associated with solvents; many are highly flammable and toxic.

37.5.6.2 Most solvents are very volatile and so may easily be inhaled and will often cause drowsiness even if they are not toxic. Some can cause irritation or dermatitis if spilt on the skin.

37.5.6.3 Solvents should be stored in flameproof cabinets containing metal trays capable of retaining at least 110 per cent of the contents of the largest container stored. Large quantities must not be stored in the open laboratory.

37.5.6.4 Flammable and non-flammable solvents should not be stored together.

37.5.6.5 Flammable solvents should not be stored in refrigerators or freezers unless these have been spark-proofed.

37.5.6.6 Never put solvents for disposal down the sink.

37.5.6.7 As there is a real possibility of explosion of waste acetone and chloroform in the presence of alkali, ACETONE should only be added to the blue labelled waste bottles; if for some reason it is contaminated, then it should be sent for disposal in a separate container clearly labelled. **Do not mix with other waste solvent.** Waste solvent should be separated into bottles of: Acetone Halogenated waste solvent (Chloroform, dichloromethane etc.) and Non-halogenated waste solvent (ethanol, ether etc.)

37.5.6.8 In general, waste solvent which contains a high concentration of acid or base should not be indiscriminately added to general waste solvent containers but disposed off separately.

37.5.6.9 Decompose reactive materials before placing in waste solvent bottles.

37.6 IMMUNISATION – POLIO AND MEASLES

Instructions for Schools/Guidelines for Immunization:

37.6.1 The handout on vaccination along with the vaccination form must be sent out to the parents / guardian through post / by hand as the case may be suitable.

37.6.2 The consent form must be duly signed by parents prior to vaccination.

37.6.3 A copy of the child's immunization records must be required and attached with the consent form.

37.6.4 The immunization records sent with the consent form by the parents must be updated.



- 37.6.5 It is mandatory for the parents/guardian to accompany the child at the time of vaccination or provide their consent in writing.
- 37.6.6 The consent form must be fully completed, signed, and presented by the parents at the time of vaccination in the school.
- 37.6.7 One receipt, per vaccination received must be provided by the public health worker to the school authorities.
- 37.6.8 Following the completion of the process, the consent form and the receipt of the vaccination received must be maintained in the students' personal school files for record (a copy may be provided to the parents or vice versa).
- 37.6.9 The school must be prepared to cope with events of emergency if needed.
- 37.6.10 Children should not be vaccinated without parents' approval. The school may; however, share the name and the contact details of such children with the approved authorities for further correspondence.

37.7 FIRE

Follow SOP for evacuation, keeping in mind the direction of fire/wind:

- 37.7.1 Fire Safety:
- 37.7.1.1 Correct anticipation of threat and evaluation of own reactions will lead to taking more appropriate measure to overcome the crisis.
 - 37.7.1.2 Fire breakout information to be loudly shouted/sounded. It should be followed by active fire alarm.
 - 37.7.1.3 The main power/gas supply needs to be switched off if the magnitude of fire requires so.
 - 37.7.1.4 Students and staff need to be evacuated from the building using the exit in the opposite direction of the fire.
 - 37.7.1.5 Firefighting equipment should be at an accessible place to control fire until the arrival of fire brigade/other civic services help.
 - 37.7.1.6 Fire should be contained with local firefighting equipment, e.g., fire hoses and extinguishers. Firefighting team should be involved for speedy action.
 - 37.7.1.7 Firefighting equipment should be regularly checked for expiry date/serviceability.
- 37.7.2 Injury:
- 37.7.2.1 In case of any injury to a student, no matter how slight, parents need to be informed.
 - 37.7.2.2 Injury must be recorded in the incidence register (refer to accidents for recording details) by each school.
 - 37.7.2.3 Cleaning or removing of burnt items must only be done after approval/clearance from BH. Gas masks, gum boots, safety gloves and safety helmet should be used when entering the affected area.



37.8 UNDOCUMENTED MEDICAL IMPEDIMENT

- 37.8.1 We, as parents, live in denial about the existence of a medical impediment with our child. We want to believe that our child is healthy and there isn't anything out of the ordinary to worry about. By not admitting could be a problem, you allow your child to suffer with a condition that in some cases can be dealt with through behavioral therapies, professional support and supportive environment.
- 37.8.2 For parents of young children with disabilities, their child's behavior often poses challenges, results in negative interaction with school. Addressing the barriers that parents face in engaging with school, and the ways that teachers will positively respond to overcome those barriers, places a heavy responsibility on the BH.
- 37.8.3 Usually parents complain having negative impressions of teachers in the school and generally discussed unfriendly and hostile interactions with teachers. Some of these parents report instances where teachers are disrespectful to or inappropriately communicated with their child, holding teacher responsible of child's academic decline. School in turn has to be extremely careful in handling such parents and students.
- 37.8.4 **Perceptible Impediment**
- Cases where impediment is noticeable, the BH must ask for the medical report of the child. In case of denial from parents, hold a special meeting with the parent and ask for the medical history of the child.
- Once the medical report is received, carefully study the report.
 - Share the report with the class teacher/teachers.
 - Make necessary arrangements to facilitate the child e.g. location of classroom, provision of tasks in classroom, special arrangement during break time etc.
 - Devise a plan to support the child academically.
 - Share the plan with the parents.
 - BH must follow up with the teachers to ensure proper care.
- 37.8.5 **Imperceptible Impediment**
- There are certain mental health and behaviour health issues which are difficult to identify at early age. There are fully functioning individuals with OCD (obsessive compulsive disorder), ADD/ADHD, Bi-Polar Disorder, Depression and many more conditions.
- If patterns are identified by the teacher, discuss it with the BH.
 - BH to further keep the child under observation.
 - BH to talk to the parents with evidence to support the claim.
 - Convince parent to seek medical help. In case the parent is in denial, give time to parent and hold another meeting.
 - Once the parent agree for medical help, ask the parents to share the medical report with the school.



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- Make necessary arrangements to facilitate the child e.g. location of classroom, provision of tasks in classroom, special arrangement during break time etc.
- Prepare an action plan for the child with the class teacher(s) in light of the suggestions for school in medical report.
- Share the action plan with SEN consultant, and after approval, with parents
- Follow up from BH is extremely important.



38. TELECOMMUNICATION DEVICES POLICY - MANDATORY

38.1 GENERAL

- 38.1.1 Carrying a cell phone/telecommunication device in the school building is not allowed.
- 38.1.2 The following terms have been elaborated for ease of understanding of this policy:
- **Telecommunications Device**
Any device that can transmit signs, signals, messages, words, writings, images and sounds or information of any nature by wire, radio, optical or other electromagnetic system.
Cell phones, smart watch, pager, ipad or bluetooth devices etc. are all telecommunications devices.
 - **Academic Hours**
The total instructional time students are expected to spend in the school/class to meet the subject requirement. It also includes any additional scheduled time during school hours where student engages with the teacher/academic adviser, to discuss the subject content and/or other academic concerns.

38.2 CONSEQUENCES FOR VIOLATING THE POLICY

- 38.2.1 If a student is found using a cell phone/device for making or receiving a call, sending a message/picture during the lesson or is causing distraction through emitting signals (including vibrations), staff member(s) have the right to confiscate the device immediately. Student whose cell phone/device is confiscated will only be allowed to notify their parents at home-time.
- 38.2.2 Whenever a staff member directs a student to surrender a cell phone / telecommunication device, the student shall do so immediately without resistance. ALL components, including the battery and SIM card shall be surrendered as well. Erasing messages and/or setting security codes is prohibited.
- 38.2.3 Failure to surrender a cell phone/device immediately is an act of defiance and will result in the loss of the cell phone/device privileges for the remainder period of the school year.
- 38.2.4 On each offense the parents/guardians shall be telephoned and informed of the policy infringement by the student. Consequences of violations have been tabulated in [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-014\)](#).
- 38.2.5 UCS nor the School Administration are responsible for any fees/charges/billing associated with any phone or device that is being held due to violations of this Policy.
- 38.2.6 All confiscated telecommunication devices must be immediately deposited to the BH's office and kept in safe custody until returned to the student/parent.
- 38.2.7 Phones/devices not picked up within six (6) weeks of the date of the end of a confiscation period are forfeited to the school and may be donated to a non-profit organization.



39. STUDENT PROTECTION POLICY - MANDATORY

39.1 INTRODUCTION

- 39.1.1 UCS is committed to provide a safe and secure environment for all students enrolled at UCS. As a responsible organization we actively seek to promote the welfare of all students in our charge and ensure that they are protected from harm. UCS believes that every member of the organization has a role to play and endeavours to provide an environment where all members of the school community i.e. students, parents, teachers, administrators and support staff are confident in sharing concerns either about their own safety or the safety and wellbeing of others.
- 39.1.2 This Policy has been developed in accordance with the principles established by the 'Child Protection System Bill, 2014' passed by the Pakistan National Assembly. UCS Student Protection Policy is in line with the following:
- Child Protection laws in Pakistan
 - Convention on the Rights of Children' (United Nations Human Rights Office of the High Commissioner)
- 39.1.3 UCS recognizes its moral and statutory responsibility to safeguard and promote welfare of all its students. Every employee, member of school faculty and staff, volunteers and visitors at school are under a general legal duty:
- To protect students from abuse.
 - To be able to identify welfare concerns among students and to identify students who need additional support.
 - To be aware of the UCS student protection procedures, to know how to access them and to follow them.
 - To keep a record of any significant event, complaint or conversation.
 - To report any matters of concern to designated Students protection coordinators.
- 39.1.4 Everyone at UCS should always maintain an attitude of 'it could happen here' where student protection and safeguarding are concerned. When dealing with the welfare of a student, schools must always act in the best interest of the student. All school faculty and staff must understand their responsibility to safeguard students and must appropriately share any concerns that they may have about a student.
- 39.1.5 On suspicion that a student's physical, sexual or emotional wellbeing is being compromised or that a student is being neglected schools must take action to safeguard the student's welfare.
- 39.1.6 All employees and members of UCS shall respect and ensure that children/students rights as set in 'Child Protection System Bill, 2014' (Pakistan National Assembly), 'Zainab Alert, Response and Recovery Act, 2019 and other applicable laws, are protected without discrimination of any kind irrespective of the student.



39.2 **PURPOSE**

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Provide all Branch staff with the necessary information to enable them to meet their statutory responsibilities to promote and safeguard the wellbeing of students.
- Ensure consistent good practice across the schools.
- Demonstrate UCS' commitment with regards to safeguard the students.

39.3 **MONITORING, EVALUATION AND REVIEW**

Monitoring of practice against this policy will be done by the BH at least once a term. This policy will be reviewed, and where necessary, revised by UCS Management.

39.4 **TERMINOLOGY**

39.4.1 Safeguarding and promoting the welfare of students.

The process of protecting students from abuse or neglect, preventing the impairment of their health or development, ensuring that students grow up in circumstances consistent with the provision of safe and effective and nurturing care and undertaking that role so as to enable those students to have optimum life chances and to enter adulthood successfully.

39.4.2 Student protection

The processes are undertaken to meet statutory obligations laid out in the Child Protection System Bill 2014 and associated guidance (Convention on Children Rights by United Nations Human Rights Office of High Commissioner) in respect of those children(students) who have been identified as suffering, or being at risk of suffering harm.

39.4.3 Staff: All those working for or on behalf of the school, full time or part time, in either a paid or voluntary capacity.

39.4.4 Student: All young people (including students) who have not yet reached their 18th birthday.

39.5 **THE LEGAL PROVISIONS**

39.5.1 As all other schools and educational institutions in Pakistan, UCS works within a legislative framework that seeks to safeguard and promote the welfare of all students. The UCS Student Protection Policy has been developed in accordance with the principles established in the constitution of Pakistan, specifically in 'Child Protection System Bill, 2014'. In addition to this, there are a number of Federal and Provincial laws relating to the protection of students such as child sexual abuse, pornography, corporal punishment, online safety, neglect etc.; for example:

- The Islamabad Capital Territory Child Protection Act, 2018 in ICT
- The Punjab Destitute and Neglected Children Act, 2004 in Punjab
- Sindh Child Protection Authority Act, 2011 in Sindh
- The Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Child Protection and Welfare Act, 2010 in KPK
- The Balochistan Child Protection Act, 2016 in Baluchistan.



- 39.5.2 According to the Pakistan National Assembly Child Protection Act, ‘Corporal’ punishment means, “ any punishment in which physical force is used and intended to cause some degree of pain or discomfort, however light it may be, which may involve hitting (smacking, slapping, spanking) a student, with the hand or an implement (a whip, stick, belt, shoe, wooden spoon, etc.) including kicking, shaking or throwing a student, scratching, pinching, biting, pulling hair or boxing ears, forcing a student to stay in uncomfortable positions, burning, scolding or forced ingestion (for example, washing a student’s mouth out with soap or forcing him/her to swallow hot spices)” (National Assembly, 2014).
- 39.5.3 UCS has a Zero Tolerance policy for corporal punishment. By Zero Tolerance it is meant that the staff member will immediately be asked to leave employment at UCS, regardless of the nature or importance of his/her role. BHs need to convey this to their teachers and staff (please refer to the Code of Conduct – **Section 40** of this Manual).
- 39.5.4 Article 14(1) of the Constitution of Pakistan states that “the dignity of man and, subject to law, the privacy of home, shall be inviolable.”
- 39.5.5 The Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC) was ratified by Pakistan in November 1990. Article 16 of the CRC states that no child/student shall be subjected to arbitrary or unlawful interference with his or her privacy, family, home or correspondence, nor to unlawful attacks on his or her honour and reputation. This policy should be read in conjunction with the following UCS policies:
- Anti-bullying Policy
 - Anti Cyberbullying Policy
 - E-Safety Policy
 - School Discipline and Behaviour Management Policy
 - Talent Acquisition Policy
 - Code of Conduct
 - School Operations Manual
 - Safety and Security Manual

39.6 POLICY DETAILS

- 39.6.1 A Listening School
- UCS takes a student-centered approach and tries to ensure that students have a voice and are able to express any concerns that they may have. UCS staff members are reminded that it could happen here. UCS staff must always take the concerns of students seriously. Safeguarding takes precedent over everything else – schools and staff must without fail make time to listen to any student who shows signs of distress or wishes to confide.
- 39.6.2 Types of Abuse
- 39.6.2.1** Abuse, in the context of this policy, includes all forms of physical, emotional, sexual abuse or neglect. It is important to understand that a



person may be guilty of abuse by either inflicting harm on themselves or on others. The word 'harm' is used when referring to ill treatment or when the health or development of an individual is affected.

39.6.2.2 Somebody may abuse or neglect a student by inflicting harm or by failing to act to prevent harm. Students may be abused in a family or in an institutional or community setting by those known to them or, more rarely, by others. Abuse can happen online. They may be abused by an adult or adults or by another student or students. The failure of a UCS staff member to put a stop to abuse that they have observed is negligence. Abuse can take four main forms:

- Physical abuse
- Emotional abuse
- Sexual abuse
- Neglect

39.6.3 All signs or symptoms of abuse should be approached with caution. It could be that the causes will be straightforward and may not be related to abuse. Irrespective, it is essential that the staff members share their concerns with the 'Students protection coordinator'.

39.6.4 Physical abuse

This is the deliberate infliction of physical harm or the failure to prevent physical harm to a student. Some examples of physical abuse are: hitting, shaking, throwing, poisoning (including inappropriate use of drugs or alcohol), biting, burning or scalding, drowning or suffocating. Please note force feeding or using excessive force when changing nappies is also considered as physical abuse. Physical harm may also be caused when a parent or carer fabricates the symptoms of, or deliberately induces, illness in a student.

39.6.5 Emotional abuse

Emotional abuse is the unrelenting emotional ill treatment of a student that negatively affects the student's emotional development. Such abuse occurs when those around the student convey the message that the student is of little worth, unloved, inadequate, or only needed to meet the needs of another person. The intention may be to frighten, put in danger or expect developmentally inappropriate actions. It may include not giving the student opportunities to express his/her views, deliberately silencing him/her or 'making fun' of what he/she say or how he/she communicates. It may feature age or developmentally inappropriate expectations being imposed on students. These may include interactions that are beyond a student's developmental capability as well as overprotection and limitation of exploration and learning, or preventing the student participating in normal social interaction. Emotional abuse also includes:

- Witnessing violence
- Witnessing the ill treatment of another person
- Bullying or cyber-bullying



- Deliberately not allowing a student the opportunity to speak
- Ridiculing students

Where this form of abuse is suspected, guidance from an expert in child or adolescent mental health should be sought.

39.6.6 Sexual abuse

- This is defined as the sexual exploitation of students (under 18 years old) and involves forcing students or misleading students into engaging in sexual activities.
- Students may be led to engage in such activities knowingly or unknowingly.
- It is to be noted that not only the adult males commit sexual abuse. Women and students can also commit sexual abuse.

39.6.7 Neglect

Neglect is the failure to meet a child or student's basic physical and/or psychological needs. Abuse through neglect results in the serious impairment of the student's health and development. Neglect includes the failure to provide protection from physical harm or danger, suitable medical care/treatment. Evidence of neglect is built up over time and can cover a range of parenting tasks. Neglect may include:

- Failure to protect from physical or emotional harm.
- Failing to provide appropriate and sufficient supervision.
- Failing to ensure access to appropriate medical care.

39.7 THE SIX 'Rs'-WHAT TO DO WHEN SOMEONE MAKES A DISCLOSURE

39.7.1 Ready

Someone may want to talk to a member of the staff at any point. If this involves safeguarding that staff member must be prepared to listen immediately.

39.7.2 Receive

The student has chosen that staff member. He/she is in a position of trust therefore must listen carefully to what he/she says. The staff member must not show shock or disbelief. The student must be taken seriously

39.7.3 Reassure

- 39.7.3.1 The student must be told that he/she has done the right thing in talking.
- 39.7.3.2 Promises should not be made especially ones that cannot be kept (e.g. 'it will be alright now').
- 39.7.3.3 Staff member that has been approached should not promise confidentiality as the staff member has a duty to refer.
- 39.7.3.4 Reassurance must be given to the student that information will only be shared with those who need to know.
- 39.7.3.5 Staff members must alleviate guilt – the student is not to blame.



39.7.4 Respond

Listen to the student to establish whether you need to refer the matter, but do not interrogate him. Do ask open questions i.e. 'is there anything else you want to tell me?' Do not ask leading questions i.e. 'did he/ she do X to you?' Do not criticize the alleged perpetrator. Do not ask the student to repeat the matter to another member of staff. Explain that you will need to talk to the BH.

39.7.5 Record

Staff member that has been approached must make brief notes if possible and write down the full report as soon as possible. Staff members must record the date, time, place and the actual words used by the students/other persons. Statements and actions must be recorded instead of own interpretations.

39.7.6 Report

Staff members must immediately contact BH.

39.8 THE ROLE OF THE SCHOOL AND STAFF

39.8.1 All members of staff must play an active role in safeguarding students.

39.8.2 All members of staff (including support staff) must receive training to understand how students may be at risk of harm.

39.8.3 All members of staff must safeguard and protect the welfare of students while they are in school against all bullying and in particular where this is accentuated by sexual or racial factors, disability or special education needs or digital technologies.

39.8.4 All members of staff must be aware of the student protection and safeguarding procedures. They must know the procedures for reporting concerns and adhere to them. All staff members should be given a copy of the UCS Student Protection Policy and procedures as part of their induction into the school.

39.8.5 The selection and recruitment of staff must include a thorough background check to make sure that candidates are suitable to work with students in schools.

39.8.6 Immediate action and appropriate steps must be taken when an accusation is made against a member of staff for committing an offence against a student, harmed a student, or behaved in a manner that brings into question their suitability for working with students.

39.8.7 All members of staff in the school (including support staff) must develop their understanding of the signs and indicators of abuse.

39.8.8 All members of staff (including support staff) must know how to respond to a student who discloses abuse.

39.9 SCHOOL BASED STUDENTS PROTECTION

39.9.1 All necessary steps are taken to safeguard and protect students (whilst they are in the charge of school).



- 39.9.2 This policy is implemented and the procedures followed.
- 39.9.3 Information to parents and students regarding the measures the school takes to protect and safeguard students is disseminated effectively and regularly.
- 39.9.4 Records of all cases of abuse are maintained in the Student Protection Folder.

39.10 RESPONSIBILITIES OF FRANCHISE FOR STUDENTS' PROTECTION

The BH is responsible for implementing the Students Protection and Safeguarding Policy and Procedures as set out in this document.

- 39.10.1.1 Leading the implementation of the UCS Student Protection and Safeguarding policy and procedures at the school.
- 39.10.1.2 Communicating the Students protection policy to all members of staff.
- 39.10.1.3 Holding termly monitoring meetings with the Staff members on an agreed focus.
- 39.10.1.4 Ensuring that action is taken in line with this policy where safeguarding concerns are raised about a particular member of staff.
- 39.10.1.5 Reviewing safeguarding practices in their schools on a regular basis (at least annually) to ensure that it is meeting the expectations laid out by the UCS.
- 39.10.1.6 Ensuring that only persons suitable (cleared stringent background check) to work in schools are employed, or engaged to work on a voluntary basis.
- 39.10.1.7 Ensuring that at least one person in the school is trained to administer first aid, should the need arise.
- 39.10.1.8 Ensuring that student protection and safeguarding are on the agenda at each annual staff meeting.
- 39.10.1.9 Ensuring that the school's annual internal review includes the review of student protection procedures and the implementation of this policy.
- 39.10.1.10 Ensuring that areas for development identified through the internal review are included in the school improvement plan.
- 39.10.1.11 Upholding the right of every member of the school community to feel safe and secure from all forms of abuse i.e. physical abuse, emotional abuse, sexual abuse and negligence.
- 39.10.1.12 Supporting students, staff, and volunteers in keeping themselves and others safe and secure, and away from harm.
- 39.10.1.13 Coordinating action within the school to safeguard and protect students from harm.
- 39.10.1.14 Cascade training on Student Protection Policy for their Staff.
- 39.10.1.15 Adhering to the UCS procedures when and if there are concerns about possible abuse.
- 39.10.1.16 Maintaining a written record of concerns raised even if no steps need to be taken.
- 39.10.1.17 Maintaining a written record of all meetings, actions taken.



- 39.10.1.18 Ensuring all records maintained are kept confidential and separate from all other student records.
- 39.10.1.19 Ensuring that all teachers, support staff, administrative staff and volunteers are aware of this policy and have access to it.
- 39.10.1.20 Attending training on how to identify abuse and know when and what action to take.
- 39.10.1.21 Attending refresher courses and ensure that new or key messages are passed onto all teachers, support staff, administrative staff, etc.
- 39.10.1.22 Ensuring that all members of the school community know the role performed by them i.e. the Students protection coordinator.
- 39.10.1.23 Ensuring that all visitors sign in and out, clear the security check and are not left unsupervised with students.
- 39.10.1.24 Ensuring a safe system for sending students home at the end of the day.
- 39.10.1.25 Ensuring that the school premises are safe and secure in terms of the physical environment i.e.
 - The closed circuit monitoring system is in working order and is being monitored.
 - That all corridors, passages, corners are well lit during the day.
 - Spaces such as staircases, stores, washrooms that are not in use are locked or cordoned off so that they cannot be accessed by students or by staff.
- 39.10.1.26 Smoking is banned in classrooms as well as outside areas where students are present or will be present. Under relevant Education Regulatory Laws, selling, purchasing, smoking and/or use of drugs is completely banned/prohibited inside the school premises and around the school building.
- 39.10.1.27 CCTV is installed to monitor blind spots.
- 39.10.1.28 Windows are kept clean and clear so as not to obscure view either into or out of the classroom.
- 39.10.1.29 Keep buildings clean and maintained.
- 39.10.1.30 Locate playground equipment where it can be easily monitored and observed.
- 39.10.1.31 Trim trees, bushes etc. so that they cannot hide people or weapons.
- 39.10.1.32 Keep playgrounds free of loose pebbles, gravel etc. to prevent tripping and falling accidents.
- 39.10.1.33 Washrooms are supervised and kept clean.

39.11 STAFF TRAINING

- 39.11.1 UCS Management shall design and conduct training for Student Protection at the time of induction of BH.
- 39.11.2 All newly hired members of staff receive induction training, which gives them an overview of the organization and ensure they know its purpose, values, services and structure, as well as the UCS Student Protection Policy.



- 39.11.3 All new staff at UCS are given the Student Protection Policy before beginning work at school.
- 39.11.4 All staff members shall attend training on safeguarding students enabling them to fulfil their responsibilities in terms of Student Protection effectively.
- 39.11.5 All UCS staff is required to pay attention to safeguard and Student Protection issues in all areas of school life. They are given guidance to ensure that their behaviour and actions do not place students or themselves, at risk of harm or of allegations of harm to a student.
- 39.11.6 All UCS staff members should be particularly careful in situations where they are alone with students providing one-to-one support or assistance. This guidance is conveyed through Student Protection training.
- 39.11.7 Any concerns about behaviour of a staff member towards a student(s) will be dealt with strictly, having particular regard to expert advice on Student Protection issues involving staff and the legal obligation to report any possible offences.

39.12 CONFIDENTIALITY

- 39.12.1 UCS recognize that all matters relating to Student Protection are confidential.
- 39.12.2 BHs, Students protection coordinators, Teachers, and Members of Students Protection Committees within the UCS will disclose information about a student or a student's family on a need to know basis only.
- 39.12.3 All staff must be aware that they cannot promise a student to keep secrets.
- 39.12.4 Irrespective of the duty towards confidentiality, if any member of staff has reason to believe that a student could be suffering harm, or be at risk of harm, their duty is to inform the BH.

39.13 SUPPORTING STUDENTS

- 39.13.1 UCS recognizes that a child who is abused, who witnesses violence or who lives in a violent environment may feel helpless and humiliated, may blame him/herself, and find it difficult to develop and maintain a sense of self-worth.
- 39.13.2 UCS accepts that research shows that the behaviour of a student in these circumstances may range from that which is perceived to be normal to aggressive or withdrawn.
- 39.13.3 UCS will support all students and young people by:
- 39.13.3.1 Encouraging the development of self-esteem and resilience in every aspect of life.
 - 39.13.3.2 Promoting a caring, safe and positive environment.
 - 39.13.3.3 Liaising and working together with all other support services and those agencies involved in the safeguarding of students.
 - 39.13.3.4 Notifying the parents and relevant authorities as soon as there is a significant concern.



- 39.13.3.5 Providing continuing support to a student (about whom there have been concerns) who leaves the school by ensuring that such concerns and school medical records are forwarded under confidential cover to the designated Official of the student's new school, immediately.

39.14 SUPPORTING STAFF

39.14.1 Supporting staff

- 39.14.1.1 UCS recognizes that staff working in the school that have become involved with a student who has suffered harm, or appears to be likely to suffer harm may find the situation stressful and upsetting.
- 39.14.1.2 FM will support such staff by providing an opportunity to talk through their anxieties with the BH/FO and to seek further support as appropriate.

39.14.2 Disclosures against staff

- 39.14.2.1 UCS recognizes that students cannot be expected to raise concerns in an environment where staff fail to do so.
- 39.14.2.2 All staff should be aware of their duty to communicate any concerns they may have to the BH/FO.
- 39.14.2.3 If a disclosure against any member of staff is made in terms of harming a student or putting a student in harm's way, or behaving in a manner that is inappropriate and raises questions about their suitability to work with students. The disclosure will be managed in line with UCS policy and procedures.
- 39.14.2.4 The BH will manage all disclosures against staff unless the disclosure is against the BH.
- 39.14.2.5 The BH will collect information about the disclosure, and share this with the FO, who will advise and guide on the steps that need to be taken.
- 39.14.2.6 Where the disclosure is against the BH the FO will collect information about the disclosure and take appropriate steps.

39.15 WHISTLEBLOWING

- 39.15.1 UCS recognizes that students cannot be expected to raise concerns in an environment where staff fail to do so.
- 39.15.2 All staff should be aware of their duty to raise concerns about the attitude or actions of colleagues and appropriate advice will be sought from the BH where necessary.

39.16 CONDUCT OF STAFF

- 39.16.1 BH shall be responsible for ensuring that high standards of professional behaviour is being maintained between staff and students, and that all members of staff have a clear understanding of what constitutes appropriate behaviour and professional limitations.
- 39.16.2 Members of staff are at all times required to demonstrate professional behaviour and understanding of the dangers involved when:
- 39.16.2.1 Are alone with a student.



- 39.16.2.2 Interacting physically (through bodily contact).
- 39.16.2.3 Handling sensitive information.
- 39.16.2.4 Contacting students through private telephones (including texting), e-mail, whatsapp, or social networking platforms.
- 39.16.2.5 Disclosing personal details inappropriately.
- 39.16.2.6 Meeting students outside the school or after school hours or beyond duties.
- 39.16.2.7 If a member of staff has reasonable suspicion that a student is suffering harm and that staff member fails to act in accordance with this policy and with the UCS code of conduct, the BH will view this as misconduct and take appropriate action.
- 39.16.2.8 The code of conduct in relation to safeguarding has to be signed by all members of staff and a signed copy retained in the employee's personal file. Any member of staff who does not adhere to the policy will be subject to disciplinary procedures as given in the Code of Conduct.

39.17 BEFORE AND AFTER SCHOOL ACTIVITIES AND CONTRACTED SERVICES

In case of transfer of control of school premises to external organizations (after approval from UCS Management-Deputy Director) such as a 'Football Association', the BH will ensure that these bodies have appropriate safeguarding and Student Protection procedures in place.

39.18 PROVISION TO HELP STUDENTS STAY SAFE

39.18.1 Provisions for student safety

- 39.18.1.1 UCS recognizes that the school plays a significant part in the prevention of harm to students by providing students with good lines of communication with trusted adults, supportive friends and an ethos of protection.
- 39.18.1.2 Schools must ensure that all students know there is an adult in the school whom they can approach if they are worried or in difficulty.
- 39.18.1.3 Schools must ensure Personal, Social, Health and Citizenship Education permeates the whole school curriculum.
- 39.18.1.4 The school ensures that student safety and welfare are addressed and students are equipped with the skills needed to stay safe from harm.
- 39.18.1.5 The school behaviour policy supports students most at risk.

39.18.2 Physical intervention

In case of unavoidable circumstances, the UCS staff may only use physical intervention as a last resort, and at all times it must be the minimal force necessary to prevent injury to another person.

39.18.3 Bullying

The policy on bullying is set out separately in the UCS FSOM and acknowledges that to allow or condone bullying may lead to disciplinary action as outlined in the Manual.



39.18.4 Health and Safety

The Health & Safety guidelines, set out in this Manual, outlines the consideration we give to the protection of our students.

39.19 COMMUNICATION WITH PARENTS/CARERS

39.19.1 Communicating with parents:

39.19.1.1 The parents should always be informed when the school has concerns about their student.

39.19.1.2 The BH will agree the means and methods of communication with parents/carers and others. When there are concerns and action is required, the BH in discussion with parents should:

- Explain the school's responsibilities in simple language.
- Explain the school's policy on recording action in response to concerns.

39.19.2 Maintaining records

Each school must maintain a record of all concerns of abuse raised at the school.

39.20 PROVEN DELIBERATE FALSEHOOD / MALIGNED INTENT

39.20.1 Investigations into allegations against members of staff may result in one of the following possible outcomes:

39.20.1.1 Substantiated – The event was found to have occurred.

39.20.1.2 Unsubstantiated – The event could not be evidenced to have occurred.

39.20.1.3 Unfounded – Event proven or acknowledged to have occurred but was misunderstood or misinterpreted or the allegation is proven not to be true, but there is no malign intent on the part of the student.

39.20.1.4 Malicious – A proven deliberate falsehood or malign intent.

39.20.2 Where it is found that a person did not commit the alleged act or that there are no grounds for concern and they were not guilty, the person should be notified in writing of the decision and no further action should be taken with a copy placed on the persons personnel file.

39.20.3 Where it is found that a person did not commit the alleged act although he/she was an accomplice, the person should be notified in writing of the decision and consideration given to the degree of involvement.

39.20.4 Where it is felt that a person's actions were irresponsible or negligent, disciplinary action should be considered. In less serious situations an action plan should be devised to address the issues raised. Where it is found that the allegations were of a malicious nature, the BH should take disciplinary action in accordance with the UCS policies and applicable laws.

39.20.5 Appropriate counselling and support should be offered to the student or students who made the allegations and, where appropriate, their parents, by the time the member of staff returns to school. In particular, this should take into account the student's particular needs.



39.21 **PROCEDURE TO BE FOLLOWED BY BH FOR ALL SPC COMPLAINTS**

- 39.21.1 Investigation to be completed / formal case closure to be carried out within 7-10 working days of the incident being reported to FM.
- 39.21.2 BH shall advise / suggest a way forward on case to case basis.
- 39.21.3 BH shall ensure that all stakeholders including the FO are on board with the final findings and decision.
- 39.21.4 Necessary documentation to be recorded by the school.

39.22 **GLOSSARY**

Safeguarding	Safeguarding means proactively seeking to involve the whole community in keeping students safe and promoting their welfare, for example-road safety and anti-bullying work.	
Student Protection	Student protection is the central part of safeguarding and promoting welfare. It is the process of protecting individual students identified as either suffering or at risk of suffering significant harm as a result of abuse or neglect, for example physical abuse. Student protection is the central part of safeguarding and promoting welfare. It is the process of protecting individual students identified as either suffering or at risk of suffering significant harm as a result of abuse or neglect, for example physical abuse.	
Support Staff	Accountants, Peons and Janitorial Staff.	
School Management Team	Branch Head and Franchise Owner	
Teachers	All teachers who are responsible for delivering the curriculum. This includes librarians, PE, Art and Music teachers.	
Students	A person or student enrolled to study at the UCS.	
Staff	This refers to all adults employed at the school.	
School Community	This refers to all persons in the school as well as those who interacts with schools on a regular basis e.g. parents and families, regular volunteers etc.	
Disclosure	“ <u>Disclosure</u> ” occurs when a <u>student or youth</u> tells you or lets you know in some other way that she or he has been, or is being abused. Disclosure can be <u>direct, indirect</u> , or a <u>third-party</u> disclosure. You need to <u>report</u> all disclosures of abuse, no matter where and when they happened.	http://www.safekidsbc.ca/disclosure.htm#top
Disclosure	A disclosure occurs when someone/member of staff is accused of misconduct.	



SECTION 6:

HR POLICIES AND PROCEDURES



40. CODE OF CONDUCT - MANDATORY

40.1 PURPOSE

This document defines the Code of Conduct for employees and outlines the procedures to be followed in case the Code is violated.

40.2 SCOPE

The Code would be applicable to all employees of the Franchise network. The term “Employee” includes and refers to all probationers, permanent, contractual and project-based employees.

40.3 CODE OF CONDUCT

40.3.1 All employees should be aware of and adhere to the laws of the country and are expected to display civility, professionalism & social responsibility.

40.3.2 Employees found indulging in unlawful acts or bringing disrepute to the organisation in any way through conduct or misrepresentation or causing unrest and restlessness among fellow employees through any action, gesture and/or miscommunication will be deemed to be in breach of the Code of Conduct. In such circumstances and should sufficient proof of breach be available, the nature of violation whether intentional or unintentional will be determined as per the stated procedure.

40.3.3 An employee may be considered to be in breach of the Code of Conduct should (s)he partake in any of the activities or practices mentioned below:

40.3.3.1 Use of corporal punishment¹ for students or child abuse² is strictly prohibited. UCS/Branch maintains a “Zero Tolerance Policy” in respect of corporal punishment/ child abuse which means if proven with reasonable certainty, such an act would result in immediate termination of the concerned staff member.

40.3.3.2 Collection of any money within the Branch premises for any purpose not specifically sanctioned.

40.3.3.3 Use of abusive/objectionable language and/or obscene remarks at the workplace.

40.3.3.4 Sexual/Physical harassment/abuse.

40.3.3.5 The organisation discourages employees from forming relationships of a non-platonic (romantic or sexual) nature at the workplace. In particular, a non-platonic relationship between employees who are in a direct or indirect reporting relationship is considered highly inappropriate.

¹ ‘Corporal’ punishment means, “ any punishment in which physical force is used and intended to cause some degree of pain or discomfort, however light it may be, which may involve hitting (smacking, slapping, spanking) a child, with the hand or an implement (a whip, stick, belt, shoe, wooden spoon, etc.) including kicking, shaking or throwing a child, scratching, pinching, biting, pulling hair or boxing ears, forcing a child to stay in uncomfortable positions, burning, scalding or forced ingestion (for example, washing a child’s mouth out with soap or forcing him/her to swallow hot spices)” - NA Child Protection Act

² Abuse, in the context of this Policy, includes all forms of physical, emotional, sexual abuse and/or neglect. (BSS Child Protection Policy 2019).



- 40.3.3.6 Accepting or giving bribes and/or inducing to accept or give bribe for any purpose whatsoever.
- 40.3.3.7 Vandalism and misuse of Branch resources like vehicles, computers, mobile phones, ID badges, access cards etc.
- 40.3.3.8 Use of UCS/Branch's resources to conduct personal business or work for gain.
- 40.3.3.9 Misuse of authority and compromising on meritocracy by indulging in favouritism/nepotism/racism.
- 40.3.3.10 Bringing and/or displaying any weapon or firearms to the workplace (even if the firearm is licensed and issued by the Government of Pakistan on the condition that the licensee may carry the same in a hidden manner). This restriction does not apply to the security staff having licensed arms as part of their duty. Display of any weapon by any person except the security staff shall be construed as gross misconduct and may also be reported to the police.
- 40.3.3.11 Consumption, possession, transportation or being under the influence of alcoholic beverages or illegal drugs on company property, in the office or company vehicles.
- 40.3.3.12 Dissemination or spamming of any objectionable material, printed or soft, that may cause unease amongst fellow employees. Spoofing/cyber spoofing, stalking/cyber stalking and/or making/recording any audio, video or pictures at the workplace or in or outside the Branch stealthily and/or without permission
- 40.3.3.13 Any behaviour or correspondence that discriminates against employees by any protected classification including race, gender, nationality, religion, sexual orientation and so forth except the constitutional exemptions guaranteed to the women and children
- 40.3.3.14 Irresponsible, malicious or scandalous communication with media and other external audience on behalf of or about UCS/Branch, without permission and authority to do so from Senior Management.
- 40.3.3.15 The violation of the Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) is misconduct. Even otherwise, any confidential or classified information which may come to the knowledge of an employee by reasons of his employment in the organisation has to be treated by the employee as such, and shall not communicate or divulge to any other unauthorised person within or outside the UCS/Branch.
- 40.3.3.16 In case of staff members as parents of branch student(s), forming pressure groups with other parents, disturbing the branch peace and harmony, misbehaving at PTMs/school functions or by any means exercising undue influence to get favours.
- 40.3.3.17 Deliberate abuse of any concessions or benefits granted by UCS/branch.
- 40.3.3.18 Breach of any applicable UCS Policy or any term or condition of employment Agreement.



- 40.3.3.19 Smoking or use of any sort of drugs in any part of the branch premises at any time.
- 40.3.3.20 Smoking in offices except for designated “smoking areas”.
- 40.3.3.21 Absenteeism and habitual late coming to the workplace.
- 40.3.3.22 Any other action or behaviour that may be deemed as inappropriate, malpractice, moral or ethical corruption and in violation of law of the land.

40.4 **RULES**

- 40.4.1 If any employee is reported for violating the Code of Conduct, whether through an act, in writing or verbally at any of the branch premises, an inquiry will be conducted to determine that a violation has in fact taken place. The BH in case of Branch (In case of corporal punishment or child abuse, the case shall be handled and escalated as defined in Child Protection Policy 2019). If an incident of breach of the Code of Conduct is reported, an informal inquiry will be initiated. The inquiry will take place where the incident had occurred and was reported e.g., Branch. Inquiry committee consists of Franchise Owner, Branch Head and senior teacher. On completion of the proceedings, if it is established, with reasonable certainty, that the employee is guilty of breaching the Code of Conduct, (s)he will be treated as per the recommendations of the committee conducting the inquiry or the UCS management as applicable
- 40.4.2 Possible forms of action during the above-referred inquiries are listed below. However, there may be other permutations as the case may be.
- Immediate termination of the employee.
 - Suspension for a certain period of time.
 - Suspension of access and some of the benefits given to the employee
 - Withholding of salary increment/ promotion for a specific period.
 - The employee may be required to submit a written apology or be allowed to resign subject to an unconditional written apology.
 - Demotion/Warning/Censure Letter may be issued to the employee.
- 40.4.3 In cases, reports or complaints relating to the allegations of harassment at the workplace, the same shall immediately be sent to the Inquiry Committee duly constituted for this purpose.



Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received a copy of the “**Code of Conduct**” for branch employees (including its Annexures) which has been read by/over to me. That I understand the contents of said document and all that is implied herein. I further understand that I may contact the BH if I have questions about any provisions of the Code. I acknowledge and agree to abide by the terms of the Code as a condition of my appointment or re-appointment at franchise branch of UCS.

Name of Employee: _____

Employee ID : _____

Department / Branch: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____



41. CODE OF CONDUCT FOR PROTECTION AGAINST HARASSMENT AT WORKPLACE & SCHOOL - MANDATORY

41.1 GENERAL

- 41.1.1 “**Harassment**” means any unwelcome sexual advance, request for sexual favours or other verbal or written communication or physical conduct of a sexual nature, or sexually demeaning attitudes, causing interference with work performance or creating an intimidating, hostile or offensive work environment, or the attempt to punish the complainant for refusal to comply to such a request or is made a condition for employment.
- 41.1.2 “**Harassment**” also includes invasion of personal space, blackmailing, humiliation in public, making sexually explicit material visible to others, excessive monitoring and blaming or contributing to vicious gossip.
- 41.1.3 The above is unacceptable behaviour in the organization and at the workplace, including in any interaction or situation that is linked to official work or official activity outside the office. Similarly, a student deserves protection from sexual harassment by any staff member or any other person in and outside the branch premises during the course of their studies while attending sports and other educational activities.

41.2 EXPLANATION

There are three significant manifestations of harassment in the work environment:

- 41.2.1 Abuse of authority
- A demand by a person in authority, such as a supervisor, for sexual or other undue favours in order for the complainant to keep or obtain certain job benefits, be it a salary increase, a promotion, training opportunity, a transfer or the job itself.
- 41.2.2 Creating a hostile environment
- 41.2.2.1 Any unwelcome sexual advance, request for sexual favours or other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature or other undue favours, which interferes with an individual’s work performance or creates an intimidating, hostile, abusive or offensive work environment.
- 41.2.2.2 The typical “hostile environment” claim, in general, requires finding of a pattern of offensive conduct, however, in cases where the harassment is particularly severe, such as in cases involving physical contact, a single offensive incident shall constitute a violation.
- 41.2.3 Retaliation
- 41.2.3.1 The refusal to grant a sexual favour or other undue favours, can result in retaliation, which may include limiting the employee’s options for future promotions or training, distorting the evaluation reports, generating gossip against the employee or other ways of limiting access to his/her rights. Such behaviour is also a part of the harassment.



41.2.3.2 Harassment can involve one or more incidents and actions constituting harassment may be physical, verbal and non-verbal. Examples of conduct or behaviour which constitute sexual harassment include, but are not limited to:

Physical conduct

- Unwelcome physical contact including patting, pinching, stroking, hugging, fondling, or any other form of inappropriate touching
- Physical violence, including sexual assault
- The use of job-related threats or rewards to solicit sexual favours

Verbal conduct

- Unwelcome comments on an employee's appearance, age, private life, etc.
- Sexual comments, stories and jokes
- Sexual advances
- Repeated and unwanted social invitations for dates or physical intimacy
- Insults based on the sex of the employee
- Condescending or paternalistic remarks
- Sending sexually explicit messages (by phone / email / WhatsApp / any other medium)

Non-verbal conduct

- Display of sexually explicit or suggestive material
- Sexually-suggestive gestures
- Whistling
- Leering

41.3 PURPOSE

The purpose to implement the Code of Conduct at Branch is to provide protection and safety to all genders and children at Branch against harassment. It provides a guideline for behaviour of all employees, including management to ensure a work and school environment free of harassment and intimidation.

41.4 SCOPE

41.4.1 This Policy would be applicable across the Franchise network and covers all employees of Branch. The term "Employee" includes and refers to all probationers, permanent, contractual, interneers and project-based employees. This Policy shall also be applicable to students, casual workers, contractors and/or visitors that are found involved the act of harassment.

41.4.2 Any employee, student or other person found guilty in act of Harassment shall be reprimanded in accordance with this Code of Conduct or other legal course of action(s) available, as recommended by the FO/UCS management.

41.5 POLICY

41.5.1 UCS considers Harassment is a violation of professional ethics and national laws and is committed to provide a safe environment for all its employees free from discrimination on any ground and from harassment at work including sexual harassment. Students at Franchise network need to feel safe at Branch as well. UCS ensures that the Branches are free from all forms of harassment, therefore it



operates a zero-tolerance policy for any form of harassment at Branch, workplace or anywhere whether it takes place within Branch premises or outside, including at social events, business trips, training sessions or sponsored conferences, treats all such incidents seriously and promptly investigate all allegations of harassment.

- 41.5.2 Any person including employees of the Branch, students, casual workers, contractors or visitors found to have harassed another, shall face disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal from employment.
- 41.5.3 All complaints of harassment shall be taken seriously and treated with standard norms by maintaining confidentiality. UCS believes that no one shall be jeopardized for making a genuine complaint.
- 41.5.4 UCS shall do its best to temporarily make adjustments so that the accused and the complainant do not have to interact for official purposes during the investigation period. This would include temporarily changing the office, in case both sit in one office, send the accused on leave or in appropriate cases put him/her under suspension during the Inquiry proceedings.

41.6 HARASSMENT INQUIRY COMMITTEE AT BRANCH

A team comprising of the following members shall function as the Inquiry Committee duly constituted under the law:

- Franchise Owners
- Branch Head
- Senior teacher

One member of Inquiry Committee must be a female.

41.7 BEHAVIOUR EXPECTATIONS

- 41.7.1 During the discharge of official duties in the Office, all functionaries are expected to behave in proper manner and according to the official decorum.
- 41.7.2 The language shall be civilized and simple. Words and sentences with sexual innuendo shall be strictly avoided.
- 41.7.3 The dress shall be proper as per office norms. Casual dress or sexually explicit dress shall not be worn.
- 41.7.4 Unnecessary stay and unnecessary visits to women's workplace and near women washrooms are strictly prohibited.
- 41.7.5 Ogling and Staring is a menace in our society and should be avoided.
- 41.7.6 Duties after office hours and duties on holidays for women must be approved from the concerned Branch Head.
- 41.7.7 Any other action which is tantamount to harassment of employees shall be considered a serious offence and disciplinary action shall be taken under the Code of Conduct against the accused.



41.8 COMPLAINT PROCEDURE

41.8.1 Informal Channel

- 41.8.1.1** The Complainant shall, if possible, convey to the accused that the conduct is unwanted and unwelcome either by him/herself or through any of his/her representative. If the Complainant cannot or does not want to approach an accused directly, he/she may make a complaint either orally or in writing to his/her Line Manager and in case the complaint is against the Line Manager then to the Line Manager of his/her Line Manager. In case of complaint against or involving FO/Branch Head, it shall be addressed to and reviewed by the UCS management (HR) who shall refer the matter to the duly constituted “**Inquiry Committee**” for formal inquiry. UCS management (HR) shall be competent authority for taking all decisions in such matters.
- 41.8.1.2** The Complainant may report an incident of harassment informally to his/her Line Manager (the “**Designated Officer**”), or a member of the Inquiry Committee, in which case the Designated Officer or the Committee member may address the issue at the discretion of the Complainant in the spirit of this Code. The request may be made orally or in writing.
- 41.8.1.3** When the Designated Officer which could be a Line Manager receives a written or verbal complaint of harassment, he/she may adopt informal approach to resolve such complaint of harassment through mediation between the parties involved and by providing advice and counselling.
- 41.8.1.4** At the same time, that Designated Officer shall immediately record the dates, times and facts of the incident, ascertain the views of the Complainant as to what outcome he/she wants, ensure that the Complainant and accused understand UCS’s procedures for dealing with such complaints. The accused shall be approached with the intention of resolving the matter in a confidential manner. In case, the matter is resolved at the informal level, the Designated Officer shall submit the incident report to the FO or designee in a confidential manner.
- 41.8.1.5** The designated Official shall discuss the matter, process and possible consequences with the complainant. Upon having consent from the complainant, designated Official shall move to the next step on the understanding that choosing to resolve the matter informally does not preclude the complainant from pursuing a formal complaint if he/she chooses so.
- 41.8.1.6** In all honesty, the Designated Officer shall keep the things dignified and confidential as far as possible. However, the Designated Officer shall ensure that the matter is resolved within three working days. Else the Designated Officer is bound to report the whole incident along with the written Complaint if any to the Inquiry Committee with no further delay.
- 41.8.1.7** Anyone who is subject to harassment at workplace does not necessarily have to take a complaint of harassment through the informal channel.



He/she can launch a formal complaint directly to the Inquiry Committee at any time.

41.8.2 Formal Complaints Mechanism

- 41.8.2.1 If the victim wants to make a formal complaint or if the incident or the case reported does constitute harassment and the Designated Officer reviewing the case feels that it needs to be pursued formally for a disciplinary action, with the consent of the complainant, the case shall be forwarded to Inquiry Committee as a formal complaint for further proceedings as per law.
- 41.8.2.2 Procedure in case of victim is minor or student & branch' Responsibility
- Since any neglect or oversight by Official entrusted responsibility whether explicit or implied and includes teachers in sexual harassment incidents against children is punishable under penal laws.
 - Whenever a child suffers sexual abuse in the confines of branch or during online classes, he/she has no choice but to (after immediately intimating and consulting their parents through Franchise school head) file a complaint promptly and directly against the accused and the parent/guardian may simultaneously move a criminal complaint under intimation to the Franchise school administration to take appropriate action at its own end.
 - Since the students are a group vulnerable and they merit special protection so, the cases of alleged harassment with the students shall be directly investigated by the Franchise School Head or by the Inquiry Committee which shall conclude such complaints in shortest possible time.

41.9 PROCEEDINGS OF THE COMMITTEE

The Inquiry Committee, within three days of receipt of a written complaint either directly from the Complainant or the Designated Officer, shall initiate the inquiry and follow the below process;

- 41.9.1 Communicate to the accused the charges and statement of allegations levelled against the accused.
- 41.9.2 Require the accused within seven days from the day the charge is communicated to submit a written defense and on failure to do so without reasonable cause, the Committee shall proceed ex-parte; and
- 41.9.3 Enquire into the charge and may examine such oral or documentary evidence in support of the charge or in defense of the accused as the Committee may consider necessary and each party shall be entitled to cross-examine the witnesses against the accused.
- 41.9.4 The statements and other evidence acquired in the inquiry process shall be considered as confidential. The proceedings of the Inquiry Committee can be recorded if so required at the sole discretion of the Committee subject to intimation to the parties.
- 41.9.5 In very exceptional cases, the evidence of witnesses, may be heard 'in camera' or online (i.e. without the employee being present). The accused shall however be



provided with anonymous statements. IC shall review that whether anonymous witness statements are reasonable in the circumstances and the witnesses had good reason to wish to remain anonymous. In cases where witnesses are unwilling to provide statements or refuse to attend the hearing then their evidence could be discounted.

- 41.9.6 The designated person, if considered necessary, may be nominated to provide advice and assistance to each party. Assistance in the inquiry procedure can also be sought from any employee of branch who should be contacted to assist in such a case.
- 41.9.7 Both parties, the complainant and the accused, shall have the right to be represented or accompanied by a colleague.
- 41.9.8 The Inquiry Committee shall ensure that the employer or accused shall in no case create any hostile environment for the complainant so as to pressurize her/him from freely pursuing their complaint.
- 41.9.9 The accused may be put under suspension by BH at the recommendation of the Inquiry Committee during the Inquiry.
- 41.9.10 If the Inquiry Committee finds the accused to be guilty it shall impose penalty which may amount to termination with fine.
- 41.9.11 BH communicate the same to the employee concerned.
- 41.9.12 The Inquiry Committee shall give its findings in writing by recording reasons thereof.
- 41.9.13 The decision and action of FM over the findings and recommendations of the Inquiry Committee shall be communicated to the Complainant as well as the accused along with the inquiry report as soon as possible.
- 41.9.14 The Harassment Act 2010 goes a long way in shielding victims from the mental turmoil of providing detailed proof by shifting the evidentiary burden of ascertaining the facts upon the Inquiry Committee and the accused instead of the victim.
- 41.9.15 In the exceptional cases of alleged harassment with the students, the accused shall immediately be suspended from work, the formal Inquiry proceedings shall commence with the consent of the parent/guardian of the student victim and inquiry shall be convened on behalf of the victim by any of his/her representative/parent/guardian/teacher/Franchise School Head as the case may be.
- 41.9.16 The Inquiry Committee shall preferably forward its findings and recommendations to the UCS management within thirty days of the initiation of the inquiry.

41.10 POWERS OF THE INQUIRY COMMITTEE

- 41.10.1 The Inquiry Committee shall have power to summon and enforce attendance of any person and examine employee on oath; to require the discovery and production of any document; to receive evidence on affidavits; and to record evidence.
- 41.10.2 The Inquiry Committee may recommend to the Ombudsperson for appropriate action against the complainant if allegations levelled against the accused are found



to be false and made with mala fide intentions and can instruct to treat the proceedings confidential.

41.11 PROTECTION AGAINST HARASSMENT AT THE WORKPLACE ACT 2010

To protect women against such harassment at their workplace, Government of Pakistan has implemented “Protection against Harassment at the Workplace Act, 2010” in all organizations. Every organization has an internal committee to work in this regard and to undertake the following measures for implementation of this act:

- Adaptation of code of conduct prescribed by law.
- The committee shall immediately address the complaints of sexual harassment as per law, as and when received.
- Ensuring the justice is done swiftly and retaliation against the complaints is curbed.
- Informing and educating the employees to make them more aware of the provisions of the act and to encourage a professional and dignified work environment for the women in public and private sectors.

41.12 EXCEPTIONS

UCS management may approve exemptions from this policy as the situation may warrant.



42. TALENT ACQUISITION - RECOMMENDED

42.1 PURPOSE

The purpose of this document is to enable selection of the best person for the job, provide a structured approach to the recruitment process and to devise an appropriate system and related procedures for fair, efficient, consistent and transparent recruitment practices. The aim is to make United Charter Schools an employer of choice.

42.2 SCOPE

- 42.2.1 This Policy shall be applicable to all franchise based positions of all cadres within UCS franchising model.
- 42.2.2 UCS management (HR) will facilitate and provide recruitment advice to all NWAs with regard to the recruitment of their senior staff members, which includes BHs.

42.3 HIRING CRITERIA

- 42.3.1 Competence-based recruitment & selection would be the criteria to appoint employees at various positions within the NWAs.
- 42.3.2 All applicants have an equal opportunity of employment irrespective of their age, sex, marital status, family status, disability, race, nationality or religion provided that these do not impede the abilities of the prospective appointees to carry out normal job duties or affect the health & safety of fellow employees.

42.4 LIMITATIONS

42.4.1 Employment of Minors

The minimum age limit for employment within NWAs is 18 years. Applicants must furnish a valid CNIC, without which any kind of employment offer cannot be made.

42.4.2 Employing Relatives

- 42.4.2.1 No blood relations and related family members (including but not limiting to husband, wife, parents, children, siblings, grandparents, grandchildren and in-laws) shall be hired in the same office; any exception shall be provided by UCS Management (HR). However, in no circumstances, one shall be allowed to be in a supervisory capacity of the other or at a position giving rise to a situation resulting in a conflict of interest.
- 42.4.2.2 If one employee marries another, both may retain their positions provided none is in the same department or supervisory/influential capacity to the other.
- 42.4.2.3 It is also the responsibility of each employee of NWAs to avoid such hiring and if management finds of any such hiring, then it shall be non-compliance of franchise manual and management can take further action which may lead to termination.



42.5 REHIRING OF EMPLOYEES

- 42.5.1 Rehiring of resigned employees for any position other than the Executive cadre staff and School Head shall be done with the approval of FO. However, a joint approval of BH and FO would be needed for the rehiring of staff in the Executive cadre and for School Heads.
- 42.5.2 Employees terminated from UCS shall not be rehired under any circumstances. BH or designated staff in School will always perform check on termination.

42.6 GENERAL GUIDELINES

- 42.6.1 Recruitment shall be made only against annual approved headcount, on the basis of required skill-set and competencies defined by the FO/BH.
- 42.6.2 Employment shall be offered only to the best-qualified applicants based on their abilities to meet the requirements of relevant Job Description (JD), irrespective of the fact that they are internal candidates, referrals or direct applicants. Preference shall, however, be given to the internal candidate in case of a tie.
- 42.6.3 All new positions, other than those arising as a result of expansion in schools, shall be approved by FO.
- 42.6.4 Any hiring which is linked to expansion in student numbers should be within the parameters of pre decided guidelines from the FO.
- 42.6.5 Long vacation (Summer/Winter Zone) salary of unconfirmed teaching staff shall be paid in two equal monthly instalments upon their re-joining after academic break e.g. if summer vacation starts before 15th of June then salary for the months of June and July shall be paid with the salaries of the months of August and September respectively.
- 42.6.6 BH or designee shall obtain job-related reference information for existing employees who are shortlisted for a vacant position. It shall include a review of an official personal file, performance appraisals and discussion of candidates' performance with his/her current line manager.
- 42.6.7 Reference check shall be conducted by the BH or designee at the final stage of the selection process with the prior permission of the selected candidate or shall be conducted immediately after the candidate has accepted NWAs' offer of employment, whichever is practicable. If a candidate is found to have provided false information or have misrepresented any information or have not disclosed any material facts in his or her application, it shall be deemed sufficient grounds for NWAs to withdraw the offer or terminate his or her service summarily

42.7 TALENT ACQUISITION AUTHORITY MATRIX

- 42.7.1 For hiring of Branch Head, Franchise management or designee will be approving authority from sourcing to the final selection of the candidate.
- 42.7.2 For hiring of Franchise teacher, branch accountant and other office staff, BH will be the recommending authority and Franchise Owner will approve those positions.



42.8 HIRING PROCESS FOR SCHOOL-BASED POSITIONS

42.8.1 Recruitment Channels

The Branch or designee shall initiate the recruitment process and utilise appropriate sources for generating a pool of applicants. These sources would generally be one or more of the following:

- Existing employees
- Branch internal applicant database
- Executive search firms
- Internal employee referrals
- University placement offices
- Advertisement/Announcement - All advertisements must be placed through the NWA, except where alternative arrangements have been formally agreed in advance.

42.8.2 Applications

Application shall be received through Talent Portal, email, courier or hand-delivered to the NWAs.

42.8.3 Screening

- 42.8.3.1 BH or designee at NWA shall screen the job applications/candidates and shortlist them.
- 42.8.3.2 Applications which meet the minimum criteria in the job description shall be considered for further processing.
- 42.8.3.3 The criteria applied for initial screening of candidates should reflect a preference for the applicant's quality of education and training, years of relevant work experience, overall employment history, attitude, motivation and interest.
- 42.8.3.4 After initial screening, profiles of shortlisted candidates recommended for interviews shall be shared with respective Line Manager.

42.8.4 Interview

- 42.8.4.1 Officials at NWAs shall schedule interviews of the short-listed candidates with appropriate interviewing body.
- 42.8.4.2 Interviews shall take place at NWA's premises and shall be scheduled at a time and date mutually convenient for both parties.
- 42.8.4.3 Interview questions and structure should be consistently applied to all candidates according to the Interview Evaluation Form (IEF), as applicable.
- 42.8.4.4 The IEF is to be completed (feedback and scoring) by each interviewer. The completed IEF must be returned to the concerned authority within 2 working days, to be filed in Employee records.
- 42.8.4.5 The IEF must clearly indicate the interviewer's recommendations as to whether the candidate should be considered for the next stage of the selection process or not.



42.8.4.6 Discussion of salary, compensation and other benefits related matters shall be discussed by the concerned authority.

42.8.5 Recommendation for Hiring

42.8.5.1 It shall be ensured that all hiring are done in line with the best practices as judged by hiring level, salary range, internal equity and prevailing market conditions.

42.8.5.2 The approving authority shall make a decision based on merit, eligibility of the candidates, qualifications and relevant experience along with interview evaluation results;

42.8.5.3 A remuneration package shall be formulated by the NWAs for all positions of NWAs.

42.8.5.4 In case of candidates who were not selected, the concerned Official shall communicate the decision and issue regret letters/emails after the selected candidate has joined NWA.

42.8.5.5 In case of rejection of the offer by the first preferred candidate, line of action may be decided in consultation with the concerned Line Manager.

42.9 HIRING PROCESS FOR OFFICE AND TECHNICAL & SUPPORT (T&S) CADRES

42.9.1 Designated Officer at NWA shall screen the job applications/candidates and shortlist them in accordance with the required skillset and competencies.

42.9.2 Interviews shall be conducted according to the authority matrix and assessment of candidates along-with recommendation shall be recorded on the CV or any other relevant document. It is not mandatory to use Interview Evaluation Form.

42.9.3 Designated Officer at NWA shall fill the Hiring Requisition form at the time of initiation of hiring process. If required, online (Google Form) submission of Hiring Requisition form may also apply for the NWA based positions.

42.9.4 Branch Accountant or a designee of a School Head shall maintain a personnel file of the hired individual with the following documents

42.9.4.1 Resume

42.9.4.2 Photographs (two)

42.9.4.3 Attested copy of CNIC

42.9.4.4 Copy of Experience Letters

42.9.4.5 Photocopies of:

- Degree
- Certificates
- Mark Sheets

42.9.4.6 Attested copies of testimonials. (Original documents shall be reviewed/checked at the time of receipt of copies)

42.9.4.7 Bank Letter

42.9.4.8 Last Salary Slip



- 42.9.4.9 Security Reference Check Form [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-018\)](#)
- 42.9.4.10 Personal Information Form, to be filled by the candidate [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-019\)](#)
- 42.9.4.11 Joining Report, filled & signed by the selected candidate and his/her Line Manager [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-020\)](#)
- 42.9.4.12 Employee Reference Check Form [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-017\)](#)
- 42.9.4.13 Signed copy of Code of Conduct
- 42.9.4.14 Copy of Offer Letter Signed by Employee & Employer
- 42.9.4.15 Appointment Letter Signed by Employee & Employer
- 42.9.4.16

42.10 HIRING PROCESS OF TEACHING STAFF, TEACHERS' AIDES & LIBRARY STAFF

- 42.10.1 Designated Officer at School according to authority matrix shall screen the job applications/candidates and shortlist them in accordance with the required skillset and competencies.
- 42.10.2 Interviews shall be conducted according to the authority matrix and assessment of candidates along-with recommendation shall be recorded on Interview Evaluation Form.
- 42.10.3 Designated Officer at NWA shall fill the Hiring Requisition form and submit it to HR department at the time of initiation of hiring process. If required, online (Google Form) submission of hiring requisition may also apply for the NWA based positions.
- 42.10.4 Branch Accountant at School shall maintain a personnel file of the hired individual with the following documents:
 - 42.10.4.1 Resume
 - 42.10.4.2 Photographs (two)
 - 42.10.4.3 Attested copy of CNIC
 - 42.10.4.4 Copy of Experience Letters
 - 42.10.4.5 Photocopies of:
 - Degree
 - Certificates
 - Mark Sheets
 - 42.10.4.6 Attested copies of testimonials. (Original documents shall be reviewed/checked at the time of receipt of copies)
 - 42.10.4.7 Bank Letter
 - 42.10.4.8 Last Salary Slip
 - 42.10.4.9 Attested copies of testimonials. (Original documents shall be reviewed/checked at the time of receipt of copies)
 - 42.10.4.10 Personal Information Form, to be filled by the candidate [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-019\)](#),



- 42.10.4.11 Relevant Interview Evaluation Forms **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-015) / Annexure (UCS-FSOM-016)**, to be filled by the Interviewer,
- 42.10.4.12 Joining Report **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-020)**, filled & signed by the candidate and his/her LM
- 42.10.4.13 Employee Reference Check Form **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-017)**
- 42.10.4.14 Signed copy of Code of Conduct
- 42.10.4.15 Copy of Offer Letter Signed by Employee & Employer
- 42.10.4.16 Appointment Letter Signed by Employee & Employer
- 42.10.5 HR representative may perform a reference check of the selected candidate (if needed).

42.11 HIRING PROCESS OF ACCOUNTANTS & OTHER STAFF OF ADMIN CADRE

- 42.11.1 Designated Officer at NWA according to authority matrix shall gather resumes along with screening and shortlisting candidates according to the required skillset and competencies.
- 42.11.2 Interviews shall be conducted according to the authority matrix and assessment of candidates along-with recommendation shall be recorded on Interview Evaluation Form. Shortlisted candidates shall be forwarded to NWA for further processing.
- 42.11.3 Designated Officer at NWA shall fill the Hiring Requisition form and submit it to NWA representative. If required, online (Google Form) submission of hiring requisition may also apply.
- 42.11.4 Assessment of candidates and recommendation of interviewers shall be sent to NWA.
- 42.11.5 NWA representative shall review the recommendation and may perform reference check for the selected candidate (if needed).
- 42.11.6 Branch Accountant at NWA shall maintain a personnel file of the hired individual with the following documents
 - 42.11.6.1 Resume
 - 42.11.6.2 Photographs (two)
 - 42.11.6.3 Attested copy of CNIC
 - 42.11.6.4 Copy of Experience Letters
 - 42.11.6.5 Photocopies of:
 - Degree
 - Certificates
 - Mark Sheets
 - 42.11.6.6 Attested copies of testimonials. (Original documents shall be reviewed/checked at the time of receipt of copies)
 - 42.11.6.7 Bank Letter



- 42.11.6.8 Last Salary Slip
- 42.11.6.9 Attested copies of testimonials. (Original documents shall be reviewed/checked at the time of receipt of copies)
- 42.11.6.10 Personal Information Form, to be filled by the candidate **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-019)**
- 42.11.6.11 Interview Evaluation Form **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-015)** to be filled by the Interviewer.
- 42.11.6.12 Joining Report **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-020)**, filled & signed by the candidate and his/her LM
- 42.11.6.13 Employee Reference Check Form **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-017)**
- 42.11.6.14 Signed copy of Code of Conduct
- 42.11.6.15 Copy of Offer Letter Signed by Employee & Employer
- 42.11.6.16 Appointment Letter Signed by Employee & Employer

42.12 HIRING PROCESS OF SCHOOL HEAD

- 42.12.1 NWA may generate CV pool using the Recruitment channels as mentioned in the Franchise Manual.
- 42.12.2 Screening, shortlisting of applications and interviews shall be done according to the Authority Matrix in accordance with the required skillset and competencies.
- 42.12.3 Assessment of candidates and recommendation of interviewers shall be documented on Interview Evaluation form.
- 42.12.4 NWA representative shall review & check the documents and shall perform reference check for the selected candidate (if needed).
- 42.12.5 NWA shall complete the following documents:
 - 42.12.5.1 Resume
 - 42.12.5.2 Photographs (two)
 - 42.12.5.3 Attested copy of CNIC
 - 42.12.5.4 Copy of Experience Letters
 - 42.12.5.5 Photocopies of:
 - Degree
 - Certificates
 - Mark Sheets
 - 42.12.5.6 Attested copies of testimonials. (Original documents shall be reviewed/checked at the time of receipt of copies)
 - 42.12.5.7 Bank Letter
 - 42.12.5.8 Last Salary Slip
 - 42.12.5.9 Attested copies of testimonials. (Original documents shall be reviewed/checked at the time of receipt of copies)



- 42.12.5.10 Personal Information Form, to be filled by the candidate **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-019)**
- 42.12.5.11 Interview Evaluation Form **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-015)** to be filled by the Interviewer.
- 42.12.5.12 Joining Report **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-020)**, filled & signed by the candidate and his/her LM
- 42.12.5.13 Employee Reference Check Form **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-017)**
- 42.12.5.14 Signed copy of Code of Conduct
- 42.12.5.15 Copy of Offer Letter Signed by Employee & Employer
- 42.12.5.16 Appointment Letter Signed by Employee & Employer
- 42.12.6 UCS Management (HR) department with NWA shall approve all new/additional school leadership positions.
- 42.12.7 In case of rejection as a result of 2nd interview, NWA shall decide to go for the candidate(s) next in line or ask for re-initiation of the whole process.
- 42.12.8 Hiring of Ad-hoc Teachers
- 42.12.9 Ad-hoc teachers required for more than 15 days shall be selected through a normal process of hiring.
- 42.12.10 Salary of such teacher shall not be more than the salary of a teacher on leave/training. NWA can, however, review and give exceptions when needed.

42.13 APPROVAL OF APPOINTMENT & PAYROLL PROCESSING

- 42.13.1 Monthly hiring of schools shall be reviewed and approved by NWA. Whereas, NWA representative shall prepare a Salary Reconciliation sheets, the same shall be approved by NWA and forwarded to the Payroll section of Finance Department at NWA for further processing.

UCS Management (HR) Department shall also perform a quarterly review of such appointments.
- 42.13.2 NWA representative shall forward a set of documents, for new appointments, comprising the Appointment Letter, Personal Information Form, Joining Report and Copy of CNIC to concerned payroll staff for further processing.
- 42.13.3 Issuance of Appointment Letters for School Positions
 - 42.13.3.1 Appointments letters shall be in prescribed format and prepared in accordance with the approved terms and conditions.
 - 42.13.3.2 Appointment letters for all school-based position shall be signed by the NWA's management.
 - 42.13.3.3 Appointments shall become effective from the date of joining as specified in the relevant Appointment Letter and shall be governed by terms and conditions as set out therein.



42.14 NEW JOINER ORIENTATION

- 42.14.1 Branch Accountant or a designated Officer at School shall prepare a formal orientation plan according to the Authority Matrix.
- 42.14.2 On the first day of joining, the employee shall report to School Head for a detailed induction and orientation.
- 42.14.3 All new employees shall be required to complete documentation on the day of joining and submit the same to Branch Accountant or a designated Officer at School.
- 42.14.4 All new employees shall be provided with a copy of "Code of Conduct". The employee shall be required to carefully read, understand and give a compliance undertaking at the time of joining.
- 42.14.5 It shall be the responsibility of the immediate LM to educate each employee regarding their job responsibilities, individual work standards, department policies and procedures, and to train new employees as necessary

42.15 EXIT INTERVIEW

All leaving employees (except termination) shall be required to fill out an Exit Interview Form [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-021\)](#). School Head may choose to conduct an exit interview where appropriate.

42.16 EXCEPTIONS

The UCS Management (HR) department may consider exemptions from this policy as the situation may warrant.



43. EMPLOYEES' FILES - RECOMMENDED

- 43.1 Files of all Franchise network employees shall be maintained and updated properly.
- 43.2 Personal files of BH, HM, SM and Branch Accounts Staff will be maintained at their respective Branch.
- 43.3 Files of other employees shall also be kept at Branch and be maintained by the BA or any Officer authorized by the BH, in this regard.
- 43.4 A printed file with UCS monogram shall be used for this purpose. Following information should also be mentioned on the cover page of this file.
- Branch Name
 - Designation,
 - Employee name,
 - Employee Branch ID,
 - Date of Joining,
 - Date of Confirmation
 - Date of Leaving
- 43.5 Following documents, as applicable, shall be filed in the personnel files of employees at the time of his/her hiring:
- Detailed CV
 - Photographs (two)
 - Attested copy of CNIC
 - Hand-written Cover Letter - for positions other than T&S staff
 - Documents relating to hiring.
- 43.6 From time to time, following documents shall also be filed in employees' files:
- Letter of confirmation
 - Nomination Form
 - All policy related correspondence/circulars
 - Incremental order
 - Office orders
 - Necessary documents at the time of handing over/taking over of the employee
 - Any other document/information relevant to the employee
- 43.7 A list of documents shall be prepared and pasted in the inner side of the file. Branch Head shall ensure that all the required documents are filed in personal files of employees.
- 43.8 Branch Accountant shall close the file of outgoing employees after filling all relevant documents.
- 43.9 All closed files shall be retained and kept in safe custody in accordance with the Company's record retention policy.



44. STAFF UNIFORM (LIVERY ITEMS) POLICY - MANDATORY

44.1 GENERAL

- 44.1.1 Uniforms and other livery items are provided to certain categories of employees for the purpose of uniformity and support.
- 44.1.2 The purpose of this Policy is to lay down the procedure relating to the requirements, purchase, issuance and maintenance of uniform items.

44.2 ENTITLEMENT

- 44.2.1 UCS Management shall determine the categories of Technical & support staff such as drivers, housekeeping attendants etc. or other categories entitled to “livery Items” and circulate it to all Branches from time to time.
- 44.2.2 The type of uniform to be worn and the material to be used shall be as specified from time to time by the UCS Management. Any variation in this regard shall be subject to prior approval of UCS Management.

44.3 EXCEPTIONS TO THE POLICY

- 44.3.1 In special circumstances, UCS management (RH/DD) may approve exceptions to this Policy as the situation may warrant, keeping in view the practical considerations.



45. PROBATION - RECOMMENDED

45.1 DEFINITION

All regular employees are required to complete an initial probationary period of six working months or a shorter period as per discretion of FO. This probationary period allows time for adjustment on a job and an opportunity to determine whether the employment relationship shall be mutually beneficial for both employee and the employer.

45.2 PROCEDURE

- 45.2.1 An intimation email shall be sent to the designated line manager, of the probationer, one month or shorter period before the end of the probation period. The line manager shall be required to complete Probation Evaluation Form [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-022\)](#) and forward the same to the BH (where applicable). Upon approval, the BH shall process the confirmation letter.
- 45.2.2 BH or designee shall run a quarterly check to ensure that all intimation emails in respect of probationers have been issued on time.
- 45.2.3 Line manager shall be responsible to ensure that completed PEF is returned to the BH or designee at least one week before the end of probation period.
- 45.2.4 The PEF shall clearly recommend one of the following:
 - 45.2.4.1 Confirmation of regular employment; or
 - 45.2.4.2 Extension of the probationary period along with justification of the same.
- 45.2.5 Once the Probation Evaluation Form [Annexure \(UCS-HRM-022\)](#) is submitted and all requirements are fulfilled, a confirmation letter shall be issued by the BH or designee.
- 45.2.6 While completing the PEF for probationers that do not merit confirmation, the line manager shall document opportunities available for improvement in performance.
- 45.2.7 In case of extension in probation, BH or designee, through the System or manually (as applicable) shall issue a probation extension memo.
- 45.2.8 In case the PEF or the extension of probation along with initiation of PIP online or manually (as applicable) is not intimated to HR within one month of the end of probation, it shall be deemed that the LM/BH has no objections regarding confirmation of employment. A confirmation letter shall be issued by the BH or designee.
- 45.2.9 Probation evaluation report shall be shared with probationers by the line manager.

45.3 GENERAL GUIDELINES

- 45.3.1 The probation period for employees at all levels could be six working months extendable for a period of three working months or a shorter/extendable period as per discretion of FO on grounds of performance issues supported by documented reasons/conditions. In this situation, a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) shall be initiated.



- 45.3.2 Upon completion of extension period and the PIP, the concerned Line Manager in coordination with BH shall decide upon whether to recommend the employee for confirmation or conclude the employment as applicable.
- 45.3.3 Proper documentation must be placed in the personnel file, both, in case of confirmation and extension/conclusion of probation.
- 45.3.4 Long vacation (Summer/Winter Zone) salary of unconfirmed teaching staff shall be paid in two equal monthly instalments upon their re-joining after academic break e.g. if summer vacation starts before 15th of June then salary for the months of June and July shall be paid with the salaries of the months of August and September respectively.
- 45.3.5 Employees exhibiting signs such as poor attendance, improper behaviour or giving no indication of being able to achieve satisfactory performance even if given more time should not be recommended for extension or the PIP.
- 45.3.6 In certain cases, contractual employees are required to be made permanent, on account of business needs, during the period of their contract. Such employees shall need to have served a minimum of six months before they can be made permanent.
- 45.3.7 If a confirmed employee is re-hired, before the completion of six months the appointing authority may employ him/her as a confirmed employee after approval of FO or designee. Terms and conditions of the Talent Acquisition Policy shall apply.



46. PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL & PROMOTION - RECOMMENDED

46.1 DEFINITION

- 46.1.1 Performance appraisals shall be conducted periodically across the franchise network to ensure both the appraiser and the appraisee are aware of the goals, underlying objectives and performance targets for the succeeding period.
- 46.1.2 This process shall support the improvement of employee performance by identifying gaps in expected and actual performance, in order to strengthen/enhance their capabilities. Performance appraisal system shall also cater to employee developmental needs by identifying areas of improvement.
- 46.1.3 Performance Appraisal Process shall be System based. Objective setting, acknowledgement, performance review and result compilation shall be performed within the System. A System or manual based (as applicable) "Self-Appraisal Performance Form" (SAPF) shall be completed by the respective employee. Upon submission, the same shall be forwarded to Line Manager/ designated appraiser for review/finalization.
- 46.1.4 Promotion is the change of an employee to a different job level with greater responsibility and may also involve a change in salary with a change in position title. The promotion shall be based on merit and business need along with employee capability, maturity and readiness to assume greater responsibility, supported by sustained excellent performance over a period of time. The promotion shall depend upon the availability of a suitable position.

46.2 PERFORMANCE APPRAISING AUTHORITY

Appraising authorities shall be as follows:

Appraiser	Appraisee (s)
FO	BH
BH	Branch staff directly reporting to a BH

Note: A designee may have the right to appraise the performance of the assigned employees.

46.3 PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL REVIEWING AUTHORITY

- 46.3.1 The FO shall review the performance appraisal of employees in Branch with the relevant BHs. Whereas, final review of Branch-based employees' performance appraisal shall be done by the FO.
- 46.3.2 The FO shall review the performance appraisal of BH at Branch and all employees across franchise network with the FO.
- 46.3.3 Performance appraisal shall be an annual exercise and appraisers shall be required to appraise their direct reports each year from November through December.
- 46.3.4 A mid-year review of the set objectives/goals shall take place in May-August each year.



- 46.3.5 A uniform evaluation tool has been made available across the board for all levels of the organisational hierarchy.

46.4 PROMOTION RECOMMENDING & APPROVING AUTHORITY

The following shall be the recommending and approving authority for promotion cases:

Location	Positions	Recommending Authorities	Approving Authorities
Branch	Executive / Section Head level or equivalent positions / Branch Head	Branch Head	FO
	Administrative/teaching/technical and support staff	Branch Head	FO or designee

46.4.1 Responsibilities of Appraisers:

46.4.1.1 Throughout the year (appraisal period) Appraisers/Line managers are expected to:

- Keep employees informed about how they are doing in relation to expectation;
- Spot any problems early and correct them;
- Praise and recognise good work;
- Make necessary adjustments to meet work objectives;
- Document employee performance.

46.4.1.2 At the time of appraisal, the following actions are required:

- Appraisers (administrative/functional as applicable) shall formally record, on the Performance Appraisal Form, ratings for each employee under their direct supervision.
- Objectives for new hires shall be set upon their confirmation for the coming appraisal period.

46.4.2 Following aspects shall be reviewed with employees:

46.4.2.1 Objectives set at the start of the year along with final scoring on the same;

46.4.2.2 Set objectives for the upcoming period (with mutual consent);

46.4.2.3 Review of competencies;

46.4.2.4 Feedback on strengths, performance improvement/development areas including measures to maintain or enhance strengths.

46.4.2.5 Employee acknowledgement shall be taken after discussion.

46.5 PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN

46.5.1 Employees, who have been rated as Potential Performers or Under Achievers, shall undergo a performance improvement plan (PIP).

46.5.2 Potential performers or Under Achievers shall be provided with a three months' performance improvement plan. The PIP period may be extended for another three months if deemed necessary by FO.



- 46.5.3 Similar plan shall also be offered to probationers recommended for an extension, at the end of probation period.
- 46.5.4 Role of Branch Head in PIP
- 46.5.4.1 Determining whether a PIP is appropriate in a given situation.
 - 46.5.4.2 Administering PIPs in conjunction with line managers to prevent bias.
 - 46.5.4.3 Providing continuous guidance and support to both the line manager and employee throughout the plan.
 - 46.5.4.4 In case of Branch, the concerned BH shall review at least one PIP from each branch and may choose to conduct a telephonic review for 50% of the PIPs. The Performance Improvement Plan review shall be recorded in the prescribed form.
 - 46.5.4.5 Concerned line manager should clearly discuss consequences for not meeting the objectives of the plan with the employee.
- 46.5.5 Completion of PIP
- 46.5.5.1 In case of successful PIP, confirmation of employment shall be processed for a probationary employee whereas continuity of services shall be recommended in case of a confirmed employee.
 - 46.5.5.2 In case of unsuccessful completion of PIP, employment of the concerned employee may be terminated after following the due process.

46.6 DEVELOPMENT AND COMMUNICATION OF PIP TO EMPLOYEE

- 46.6.1 Line managers shall prepare the PIP and shall also seek employee's feedback to encourage the employee to help identify areas of confusion and foster ownership. Line managers must be open to changes based on the employee's input; the perspective of concerned employee is no less valuable here for the success and effectiveness of the plan.
- 46.6.2 After fully discussing the plan, the manager may make modifications based on employee feedback. Once the final plan is acknowledged by the employee shall be locked.
- 46.6.3 If the employee is unable to commit to the PIP process, the Branch Head shall have to determine whether termination or other appropriate action should be taken in consultation of the FO and after following the disciplinary procedure.

46.7 ANNUAL INCREMENT

- 46.7.1 Salaries shall be reviewed annually and increments shall be awarded based on performance appraisal.
- 46.7.2 All regular employees hired before May 1 of the current calendar year shall be eligible for performance appraisal or as per discretion of FO for lesser or extendable period.



- 46.7.3 Employees on long leave in a calendar year for three or more consecutive months shall not be entitled to an increment for that particular year.
- 46.7.4 Increment effective date shall be January 1 each year. The date may vary based on business needs.

46.8 SALARY ADJUSTMENTS

The following guidelines shall be considered while recommending salary adjustment for employees at all levels:

- 46.8.1 Salary adjustment shall not be awarded to an employee with less than three years of service or as per discretion of FO for lesser or extendable period.
- 46.8.2 Salary adjustment may be recommended once every three years if required or as per discretion of FO for lesser or extendable period.

46.9 QUALIFICATION INCREMENT

- 46.9.1 Employees may be recommended for an increase in salary if they have improved their qualifications while in service to the company.

46.9.2 Criteria for Qualification Increment

An employee shall be entitled to an extra qualification increment only if he/she meets the following criteria:

- 46.9.2.1 An award-bearing course by a recognised local or foreign university/institution
- 46.9.2.2 B.Ed., M.Ed. or a Master's degree from a local/foreign university.
- 46.9.2.3 A professional degree directly related to the job of the employee e.g. a finance person attaining an MBA degree, specializing in finance, not in marketing.
- 46.9.2.4 A degree higher than the basic job requirement e.g. teachers in franchise network need to have a Bachelor's degree at the time of hiring. However, if they have gained a B.Ed. or M.Ed. during their tenure, then they are entitled to an increment.
- 46.9.2.5 Recommendation received two years after receiving the transcript/completion of degree/certificate shall not be entertained.
- 46.9.2.6 A transcript shall be acceptable in the absence of a degree.

46.9.3 Increment Reviewing Authority

The BH shall be the increment reviewing authority for all employees of Franchise network.

46.9.4 Increment Approving Authority

FO shall be the approving authority of increment of all employees in Franchise network.



46.10 PROMOTION PROCEDURE

46.10.1 Promotion Budget

Promotion budget shall be finalised each year before June keeping in view proposed/expected promotion recommendations.

46.10.2 Promotion Effective Date/month

Promotions shall generally take place at the beginning of calendar year. However, promotions may also take place at the beginning of the academic year, for Branch-based academic staff, if required.

46.10.3 Criteria for Promotion

Promotions shall be initiated/processed if:

46.10.3.1 An approved position(s) becomes vacant because of resignation, promotion, termination or any special situation.

46.10.3.2 A new position is created.

46.10.3.3 The promotion shall not be considered as a right of an employee solely based on the number of years served on a specific position. The promotion shall be directly linked to the followings:

- Qualification, ability, skills and competencies required to perform the job on a specific position.
- Overall, the work performance of an employee. Performance data shall be retrieved from annual performance appraisal record.
- Job enrichment i.e. quantifiable addition(s) in the responsibility and substantial change in the job description.

46.10.4 Promotion Committee Proceedings:

46.10.4.1 Upon receiving a promotion recommendation on relevant Promotion Criteria which includes experience, job knowledge, core competencies, interpersonal communication skills, decision making, professionalism and integrity, leadership and ambitions. Rating shall be assigned on the basis of above mentioned KPIs. BH shall coordinate meetings of the FO or designee.

46.10.4.2 All proposed promotions shall be discussed and finalised by a promotion committee, which shall be held each year in the month of January (preferably between the first and second week of January or as per need).

46.10.4.3 Promotion committee members shall record their recommendations based on the above mentioned KPIs.

46.10.5 Committee composition shall be as mentioned above in **Clause 46.4**. Whereas, there may be changes as per need and approval of the management.

46.10.6 Potential Assessment

The potential assessment test is a reliable scientific tool for predicting candidate performance, and for identifying the aspects of employee that are difficult to extract from a face-to-face interview.



- 46.10.6.1 Employees recommended for promotion to senior positions along with the BH position shall be assessed through a systematic Potential Assessment tool before their promotion decision is finalised.
- 46.10.6.2 Reports of potential assessment test shall be shared with both employee and committee members along with the Line Manager
- 46.10.6.3 Based on the findings of potential assessment reports the Line Manager shall determine the training and development requirements to fill performance gaps and prepare employees for advancement. Employees shall also coordinate with their Line Manager to finalise their respective development plans. This can also include mentoring, coaching, job rotation, secondment, educational programmes and formalised feedback process.

46.11 PROMOTION INCREMENTS

FO will decide fixed percentage of gross salary may be granted as a promotion increment.



47. PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT- RECOMMENDED

- 47.1 Franchise Network acknowledges that its success and achievements fundamentally lie with the knowledge, skills, expertise and motivation of its human resources. Franchise Network considers training as a job requirement and a means towards career path progression, succession planning and skill enhancement and so we encourage out NWAs to follow the same philosophy.
- 47.2 Franchise Network offers Teachers Training for all Teachers including those in NWAs.
- 47.3 Principals are encouraged to establish a positive learning environment for all employees of their Franchise network and make online, classroom, courses, and on-the-job training available to them as possible.



48. RETIREMENT- MANDATORY

48.1 PURPOSE

The purpose is to define a transparent process for employees who are to retire as well as to help FO/LM/BH to keep track of the procedural requirements.

48.2 PROCEDURE

- 48.2.1 The retirement age is 60 years for all staff members.
- 48.2.2 Each year on July 1, retirement takes place for those employees who reach the retirement age of 60 years on June 30.
- 48.2.3 When a permanent employee reaches normal retirement age, the BH may, with the approval of the FO, extend an employee's service beyond his/her normal retirement age for a further specified period (employee will retire at the end of the extended period of service) or re-employ the employee on contract after his/her retirement.
- 48.2.4 At the beginning of each financial year, the BH or designee shall officially inform all employees who shall be reaching the age of retirement within the following 12 months. This information shall also be provided to the FO before sharing with the employees.
- 48.2.5 For all critical positions, BH and concerned LM should identify successors and develop them for the upcoming role. In case, a trained resource is not available at the time an incumbent is retiring, the LM/BH may recommend extension, as mentioned above, to the FO.
- 48.2.6 Once prepared, the retiree list for the current and next year shall be sent to the FO for approval at least three months before the information is shared with the concerned employees and their line managers.

48.3 TWELVE MONTHS BEFORE RETIREMENT

- 48.3.1 LM/BH must hold a first pre-retirement meeting twelve months before retirement effective date. The purpose of this meeting is to remind the employee of the need to prepare for his/her retirement.
- 48.3.2 At this point of time, a successor must have been identified for development for the critical positions during the coming twelve (12) months. It shall be the responsibility of outgoing incumbent to train the successor for the future challenges and the concerned LM/BH must ensure a successor is ready to take on related responsibility upon assuming the job role.
- 48.3.3 For teaching and non-management positions, replacements shall be planned and hired.

48.4 DURING FINAL WEEK OF EMPLOYMENT

The BH shall issue a letter of thanks/appreciation to the retiring employees and handover the final settlement cheque to the retiree on the last working day unless a delay is caused by unforeseen circumstances.



49. RESIGNATION - RECOMMENDED

49.1 DEFINITION

A resignation refers to an employee's voluntary separation from the organisation other than by retirement, dismissal or termination of service.

49.2 RESIGNATION ACCEPTANCE AUTHORITY

The following shall be the resignation acceptance authorities:

Location	Positions	Acceptance Authorities
Branch	All Positions	FO

49.3 PROCEDURE

- 49.3.1 Employees at all levels are required to submit their resignation, through the System or manually as applicable, to their administrative line managers or BH (where applicable), in advance, as per terms and conditions contained in the letter of appointment/contract. A scanned copy of the signed and dated resignation letter must be attached with the resignation request on the System or manually (where applicable).
- 49.3.2 The BA of the technical and support cadre staff or a BH's designee at the branch level is required to raise the resignation request on their behalf, and a scanned copy of the signed and dated resignation letter must be attached with the resignation request on the System or manually (Where applicable)
- 49.3.3 If an employee provides verbal rather than a written notice of intention to end his/her employment, Branch Head/line managers shall obtain a confirmation of the resignation and communicate it to the FO.
- 49.3.4 Upon receiving the manual signed recommendation of acceptance of resignation specifying the last working day, the designated LM/Branch Head shall raise an 'on behalf of' resignation on the System and issue the resignation acceptance letter.
- 49.3.5 Resignation acceptance letter shall be copied to all the concerned persons/departments.
- 49.3.6 Employees are required to be present and functioning at their positions as scheduled during the notice period.
- 49.3.7 Employees are required to return all Branch property, equipment, identification cards, keys, documents, etc. in their possession on or before their last working day to the respective Branch Head/LM or the designated nominee.
- 49.3.8 Employees who have resigned are required to get clearance from all departments and positions concerned and shall pay to Branch if have any monetary obligations (may include loans, salary advances, service bond payments etc.) before their last official working day. Otherwise, the same amount shall be deducted/adjusted from the final settlement. In case of failure to clear Branch dues, the employee shall not be issued clearance and experience certificate.



- 49.3.9 Upon receiving clearance from all concerned, the respective Franchise representative shall start processing the final settlement of the employee who has resigned and forward it to the Franchise Finance Department for processing the final settlement cheque.
- 49.3.10 The resignee shall receive the final pay cheque, which also includes any un-availed annual and casual leave amount, as permitted by the leave policy. Any amount owed by the employee to the company shall be deducted from the employee's payable final settlement. If the amount owed by the employee to Branch is greater than the final settlement amount owed to the employee, the unpaid amount shall be paid by the employee through a cross cheque in the name of Branch.
- 49.3.11 Failure by the employee to meet these obligations shall result in termination in poor standing, restricting re-employment at Franchise Network.
- 49.3.12 The final clearance and settlement for all categories of employees of UCS shall be prepared at different levels as mentioned below:

Location	Clearance Responsibility	Final Settlement Preparation Responsibility
Branch	Concerned departing employee and LM/BH or his/her designee in the absence of the departed employee. Whereas, all concerned departments e.g. IT, Finance, Admin or any other department will make sure on-time clearance on receiving the resignation intimation where applicable.	Franchise BA representative shall prepare the claim and forward to Franchise Finance Department representative for processing of final settlement cheques

49.4 GENERAL GUIDELINES

- 49.4.1 Resignations shall be regarded as permanent and the individual shall, as of the effective date, forfeit all benefits in accordance with Franchise manual.
- 49.4.2 A permanent employee may resign from his/her services by giving the LM/BH a notice in writing or by depositing salary in lieu of notice period as specified in their terms of appointments.
- 49.4.3 Temporary or contractual employees may resign from their services as per the terms and conditions mentioned in the letter of appointment/contract.
- 49.4.4 The resignation shall be considered effective and the notice period of the employee who resigns shall start from the same day of resignation unless it is notified on the resignation acceptance letter that it applies from any other day. For online resignation requests, the date from which the resignation is effective is to be selected by the employee and the LM/BH can change it in case of any difference. The BH shall consider that date as final which is received on the request forwarded by the LM/BH for final processing. The last working day shall be calculated starting from the effective date of resignation and in case an exemption is granted in the notice period, the last working day shall change accordingly.



49.5 **NOTICE PERIOD**

- 49.5.1 Employees may resign from their service as per their employment status by giving notice in writing or payment in lieu thereof.
- 49.5.2 The resignation shall be tendered through the system. Whereas, a written resignation, duly approved by LM/BH shall also be attached with the system's resignation request.
- 49.5.3 The notice period for resignation shall come into effect from the date of acceptance of resignation.
- 49.5.4 An employee maybe asked to leave by the company without assigning any reason by giving notice in writing or payment of notice period salary in lieu thereof. However, no notice period or salary in lieu thereof shall apply if the services are being terminated on account of misconduct on part of the employee.

49.6 **PAYMENT IN-LIEU OF NOTICE**

- 49.6.1 If an employee fails to give notice, the management of Branch has the right to withhold employee dues equal to the notice period.
- 49.6.2 Where management of Branch does not require the employee to complete the notice period, payment in lieu of notice shall be made. If the employee is only required to work part of the required notice period, Branch shall pay out the remainder of the notice period.
- 49.6.3 Any payment in lieu of the notice shall be calculated on the normal rate of pay an employee would have received during the period before leaving or serving the notice period.



50. TERMINATION - RECOMMENDED

50.1 DEFINITION

Termination of employment may take place for a number of reasons. When employment termination becomes unavoidable, procedure as per Branch policies shall be adopted and adequate documentation shall be ensured.

50.2 PROCEDURE FOR TERMINATION

50.2.1 BH shall be required to initiate the process at least one month before the effective date of termination of a regular permanent/temporary employee(s) in all cases except termination with immediate effect and/or disciplinary termination.

50.2.2 Disciplinary termination shall be carried out, only after following procedures, as defined in the Code of Conduct.

50.2.3 Following is the list of reasons for non-disciplinary termination of services:

50.2.3.1 Surplus/Redundant position

50.2.3.2 Medical incapacity

50.2.3.3 Persistent poor performance

In case of the persistent poor performance of duties, the employee should be notified of the precise issue, given an opportunity to respond and generally provided with a reasonable period of time to improve (via PIP). However, if disciplinary action or termination is a likely outcome, there should be a prior warning that continued poor performance may result in such action.

50.2.4 Upon receiving intimation from the LM/BH, the concerned BH shall process the documentation for discontinuation of services in accordance with company policies keeping in view legal implications, if any.

50.2.5 Once requisite documentation is completed, the concerned employee shall be summoned to the BH. A BH representative along with the concerned LM/BH shall inform the employee about his/her termination decision with complete reasoning. In case of immediate termination, BH & BH shall ensure that all access rights (both System-based and physical) are revoked forthwith.

50.2.6 After intimating the decision of termination to the concerned employee, the concerned LM/BH shall take over all the responsibilities including all franchise property, equipment, identification cards, keys, documents, etc. Moreover, his/her dues shall be cleared on the same day/time.

Note: The Code of Conduct Policy contains details about the disciplinary action process and termination of services of employees at all levels.

50.3 RECOMMENDING AUTHORITY

The BH shall be the recommending authority for termination of services other than disciplinary termination.



50.4 APPROVING AUTHORITY

- 50.4.1 The FO or designee shall be the approving authority for termination of services, other than disciplinary termination, for all cadre positions based at the franchise network including executive cadre positions throughout franchise network.
- 50.4.2 The FO shall remain the approving authority for termination of services for his direct reports.

50.5 GENERAL GUIDELINES

- 50.5.1 Employees may be terminated for any reason other than misconduct by giving them advance notice in writing or salary in lieu of notice as specified in the terms and conditions of their letter of appointment/contract.
- 50.5.2 The services of temporary/contractual employees may be terminated upon completion of the job for which they were engaged or earlier by giving notice as per terms and conditions mentioned in the letter of appointment/contract.
- 50.5.3 The services of a contractual employee shall be terminated upon completion of contract or earlier in accordance with the terms and conditions of the contract.



51. HANDING OVER / TAKING OVER POLICY - RECOMMENDED

51.1 PURPOSE

51.1.1 Branch employees have been allocated resources to facilitate in performance of their job roles. The resources allocated to them need to be handed over to the successor/designated employee(s) in the manner prescribed in this Policy for the following reasons:

51.1.1.1 The resignation / termination of an existing employee.

51.1.1.2 In case of availing long leave or a consecutive leave without pay of 3 months or more.

51.1.2 The above requires the need for a control procedure based on which departing employees shall move in a way that shall not affect the flow of work and is in accordance with professional work etiquettes.

51.1.3 This policy also seeks to ensure the smooth and effective Handing Over / Taking Over of all physical assets, documents, authorities assigned in the System, knowledge, connections, etc., pertaining to a particular job position at the time of transition of responsibility between the predecessor and successor to the job.

51.2 SCOPE

51.2.1 The Policy shall be applicable to ALL joiners / departing employees of Franchise network.

51.2.2 The Policy shall also be applicable to relevant employees of Franchise network who have been assigned certain responsibilities as per this Policy.

51.3 RESPONSIBILITY OF HANDING OVER / TAKING OVER

51.3.1 The overall responsibility of smooth and effective HOTO task rests with the LM/BH of the departing employee. Concerned BH shall coordinate for timely completion of the process.

51.3.2 The overall responsibility of smooth and effective HOTO task rests with the LM/BH of the departing employee. Concerned BH shall coordinate for timely completion of the process.

51.3.3 Responsibility for HOTO of BH rests with concerned FO or designee.

51.4 RESPONSIBILITY OF JOINERS / DEPARTING EMPLOYEES

51.4.1 It is the moral and ethical responsibility of the departing employee to not withhold any information from the Franchise network. Any fact, data or information must be shared with the respective authorities before leaving.

51.4.2 It is also the responsibility of the departing employee to behave in a professional manner with the new hire and not misguide him/her about the workings and processes of the Franchise network. All information provided must be correct and unnecessary details should be avoided.

51.4.3 The departing employee is required to list down the important tasks to be performed at least 15 days before their last working date according to their priority.



- 51.4.4 The departing employee is required to handover the charge of duty along with any Franchise resources to the joining employee or otherwise to his/her Line Manager. The Line Manager shall ensure smooth and effective transfer of resources and duties to joining employee or any Official designated by him/her.
- 51.4.5 To obtain clearance, the departing employee shall handover Franchise resources/assets, as applicable, to designated Officials of custodian department/function and get clearance as follows:
- 51.4.5.1 Concerned Finance/Accounts Officials shall check the balances due to/from the departing employee from the System.
 - 51.4.5.2 Concerned BH shall take the charge of Franchisee provided residence, car, mobile phone or any other items allocated to the departing employee.
 - 51.4.5.3 Concerned Security Official shall take over the security access card, vehicle sticker, parking passes etc. from departing employees, as applicable.
 - 51.4.5.4 Concerned Library Official shall provide the clearance of library books issued to the departing employee.
- 51.4.6 The employee taking over the charge shall, in conjunction with the departing employee, takeover the necessary Franchise records and assets under the supervision of the concerned Line Manager. In case of any dissatisfaction, facts should be urgently communicated to his/her LM/BH as applicable.
- 51.4.7 Non-compliances/shortages not reported but subsequently discovered shall be inquired by the Officials involved in the HOTO / Clearance process to determine the Official responsible for it.

51.5 **PROCEDURE**

- 51.5.1 Clearance / final settlement of ALL employees shall be conducted in accordance with the provisions mentioned in **Section 52** of this Manual and respective clearance/final settlement forms shall be prepared accordingly.
- 51.5.2 Upon acceptance of resignation/termination of employees, concerned BH shall intimate, through system or email to all concerned Officials for their information and processing.
- 51.5.3 IT Officials and any other function(s) involved to ensure that all the soft data/information recorded in devices provided to the departing employee or kept by him/her in any shape/device have been obtained or erased in the manner prescribed in Fixed Assets Manual.
- 51.5.4 IT and other relevant official(s) shall ensure that all passwords/authorities assigned to departing employee in respect of System (i.e. e-mails, resources for online classes, files etc.) have been obtained and ceased. Any IT equipment provided to the departing employee shall be handed over to designate IT Official/any Official nominated by the BH. The same may be issued to the successor of departing employee on timely basis.



- 51.5.5 A cut-off date to execute the HOTO activity shall be mutually decided by the BH/LM and concerned BH. The agreed date shall be on or before the last working day. Concerned Officials shall be informed accordingly.
- 51.5.6 BH shall prepare the prescribed Forms of HOTO of BH, BA, (supported by necessary documents of accounting, fixed assets and Undertakings, as applicable) before the date of HOTO.
- 51.5.7 In case of HOTO of BH/BH, all receivables/payables balances shall be verified from the concerned persons in writing by the representative Official of Franchise Finance. Such verification can be obtained on the relevant ledger account. In case of vendors/suppliers (third parties), balance confirmation certificates, duly signed and stamped by them, shall also be obtained.
- 51.5.8 In case of HOTO of BH, physical verification of all the assets shall be conducted under supervision of BH or designee along with the concerned Support Staff. Fixed Assets verification shall be conducted in accordance with the procedure prescribed in the Fixed Assets Manual. Relevant documentation and Fixed Assets Verification Forms shall be reviewed and validated by the HOTO team. However, in case of BH, if the concerned BH provides the undertaking regarding 100% availability of fixed assets, the process of physical verification may be waived off with joint understanding of team members.
- 51.5.9 In case of HOTO of BH, a complete physical count of assets for the relevant premises would be conducted and the HOTO Form shall be filled under supervision of BH or designee.
- 51.5.10 In case of Librarian, physical verification of all library books and teaching aid items shall be supervised by the BH/BH with the help of joining librarian.
- 51.5.11 All the particulars in applicable HOTO Form(s) and relevant documents shall be checked and verified by the members of HOTO Team. Any shortfall (due to wilful neglect or fraud) in assets/balances of Franchise or unverified balances shall be communicated to LM of concerned area. Deductions on account of former mentioned shortfall shall be made from the end service benefits of the departing employee.
- 51.5.12 Applicable HOTO Form(s) and relevant documents shall be signed by:
- Employee handing over the charge
 - Employee taking over the charge
 - Members of HOTO Team
 - Branch Head (for all Branch based positions)
- Deficiencies/shortages observed shall be mentioned on the HOTO Form(s) and detail shall be provided, if required, on a separate Annexure signed by all the Officials involved.
- 51.5.13 The HOTO Team shall send the original HOTO Form(s) along with all documents to the concerned BH/BH and a copy to concerned FO for record.



52. CLEARANCE/FINAL SETTLEMENT- RECOMMENDED

52.1 DEFINITION

When employees leave service by way of resignation, termination or end of the employment contract, departmental clearance is required for initiation of the final settlement process. Failure to obtain clearance from all concerned may result in withholding of final dues.

52.2 RESPONSIBILITIES OF DEPARTING EMPLOYEES

52.2.1 All departing employee shall ensure the following:

- 52.2.1.1 Advances, amount owed to Franchise including service bonds and any loans taken from Franchise are repaid/settled;
- 52.2.1.2 All Franchises -provided items are returned; and
- 52.2.1.3 Obtain clearance through system or manually where applicable from all related departments on the prescribed Clearance Form on or before the last working day.

In case of non-availability of the departing employee, the respective LM/BH shall ensure that clearance is done on time.

52.3 RESPONSIBILITIES OF LINE MANAGER'S

52.3.1 LMs shall ensure that no issues relating to the departing employee are left unresolved. While working with the employee, LM must collect all items on or before the last working day that require clearance, including but not limited to the following:

- 52.3.1.1 Job/work-related material
- 52.3.1.2 Computer and related accessories
- 52.3.1.3 Security card (where applicable)
- 52.3.1.4 Attendance card (where applicable)
- 52.3.1.5 Perks (where applicable)
 - Car
 - Mobile phone
 - Laptop
 - Camera
 - Any other item

52.3.2 For certain positions that include BH and BH or any other position deemed appropriate by the FO, the departing employee needs to make sure that all formalities are completed as per the Handing/Taking over Document.

52.3.3 Upon processing of the resignation acceptance, termination and transfer letter, the clearance process shall be initiated and a copy of the concerned letter or related information shall be shared with relevant departments.



- 52.3.4 Following are the relevant departments which may be involved in the clearance process for employees at all levels. However, clearance requirements may vary based on the recommendation of relevant LM/BHs and the nature of the position:
- Administration
 - Finance
 - Accounts
 - IT
 - Library
 - Departing employee's own Department/Branch
- 52.3.5 Five (5) working days shall be available with the concerned authorities/departments for finalising the clearance. Extra time shall only be given if an appropriate reason is shared by the responsible department's representative with the concerned LM/BHs. The concerned BH/BH shall be kept in the loop in case extra time is granted for clearance to the department responsible for clearance or to the departed employee.
- 52.3.6 The FO or designee shall be the authority for awarding exceptions in case more than five working days' time is required for clearance.
- 52.3.7 Clearance authorities must share with the departing employee any missing/incomplete obligation on or before his/her last working day. In case of delayed information to the clearance authorities, a BH should play the role of a mediator and provide contact details for the departing employee so the relevant authorities can make contact. The departing employee shall be reached by official communication in case of sensitive matters including but not limited to finances, fixed assets and confidential information.
- 52.3.8 Keeping in view all the requirements, the clearance process must not take more than one (1) working week barring exceptions.

52.4 CLEARANCE PROCESSING

- 52.4.1 The departments/officials responsible for the items must sign off or approve the clearance form when each item/material issued to the employee is returned. In case the online System is not available then manual clearance shall be signed.
- 52.4.2 If a deduction has to be made for any lost or damaged item of Branch, a copy of the employee acknowledgement must reach the HR Department along with the final clearance form or must be attached (a scanned copy) to the System by the concerned authority in case of filling in the data in the System. In case of non-availability of the departing employee, BH/BH comments shall be considered as final.



52.5 PREPARATION OF THE FINAL SETTLEMENT

- 52.5.1 After receiving the Clearance Certificate Form along with the related documents, concerned BH shall prepare final settlement and forward it to the Franchise Finance representative responsible for preparing the final settlement cheque.
- 52.5.2 If a departing employee owes an amount to Branch, it shall be deducted from the final settlement unless deposited in Branch account by the employee.
- 52.5.3 In case of failure to clear Branch dues, the employee shall not be issued clearance and the experience certificate and shall not be eligible for re-hiring in any of the Franchise network.

52.6 TIMELINE

Keeping in view all the requirements, the clearance and final settlement process must not take more than three working weeks barring exceptions.

52.7 ISSUANCE OF EXPERIENCE LETTER

Experience Letter shall be issued by the Branch upon satisfactory clearance from all departments or positions concerned. A departing employee may receive the Experience Letter when he/she comes to pick up the final settlement cheque. No Experience Letter shall be issued if a departing employee owes money to Branch in the final settlement.

Note: The above mentioned clearance procedure must be followed at the time of resignation, termination from services, and Long Leave as well.



53. WORKING HOURS & ATTENDANCE - RECOMMENDED

53.1 SCOPE

- 53.1.1 The purpose of this Policy is to lay down the rules & regulations relating to working hours & attendance for employees of the Franchise network.
- 53.1.2 This policy would be applicable to all employees of the Franchise network. For the purpose of this policy "Employee" includes:
- Permanent
 - Contract
 - Part-Time
 - Probationers

53.2 WORKING HOURS

- 53.2.1 Employees shall observe the following office timings and working hours Branch:

Office	Office Times	Working Hours	Lunch Break (Minutes)
			Mon to Thur
Branch	7:30 am to 3:30 pm	7hrs 15min /day	45

- 53.2.2 Branch working hours & time shall be as advised by BH from time to time. The said timings may differ depending on the season and business requirements.

- 53.2.3 Branch staff shall report for duty as per the following table:

Position	Duty Times	
Branch Heads	30 minutes Before School Starts	90 minutes After School Ends
Teachers on duty	30 minutes Before School Starts	30 minutes After School Ends
Other teaching staff	15 minutes Before School Starts	15 minutes After School Ends
Other Administrative & Office Cadre Staff	*8 working hrs.	
Technical & Support Cadre Staff (Other than Guards)	*8 working hrs.	
Guards	12 working hrs.	

- 53.2.4 Branch Hours during summer vacations may be reduced as per instructions from the BH.
- 53.2.5 During the holy month of Ramadan, reduced office hours shall be observed as per the notification by FO.



53.3 ABSENT DEDUCTION

- 53.3.1 All absent days shall be treated as without pay. Deductions shall be based on calendar days. Deduction for sandwich off days, if any, shall also be made accordingly.
- 53.3.2 Deduction of absent days shall be made on a monthly basis with the cycle of the month starting from 21st of the month before last to the 20th of the last month i.e. for the month of September 20XX absent days deduction shall be from July 21st 20XX to August 20th 20XX.
- 53.3.3 The execution of absent deduction routine shall be run after the 20th of every month before the generation of the payroll.
- 53.3.4 All those employees who have raised application(s) even till 20th of a particular month or before the execution of routine shall be exempt from the absent day deduction and such applications shall be considered normal and all other applicable rules shall apply in such cases.

53.4 ATTENDANCE

- 53.4.1 Employees are expected to report to work as scheduled and on time. Employees shall mark their attendance on biometric devices installed in Branch.
- 53.4.2 Where biometric devices have not been installed, attendance shall be marked manually on attendance registers specifying the time in and time out. The manual registers shall be signed off by LM/BH on a daily basis.

53.5 PROCEDURE

- 53.5.1 Employees must get themselves registered on one or more biometric devices within two days of their joining. The timing schedule shall be updated, as per approved schedule for a particular Branch for new employees whereas off-day schedule and leave entitlement shall be updated automatically.
- 53.5.2 Registration on biometric devices and updating of the timing schedule shall be performed as per the following responsibilities matrix:

Location	Area	Responsibility	Timeline	Leave Approving Authority
Branch	Registration on biometric devices/ Updating of timing schedule	BH	Within two days of joining	LM/BH

- 53.5.3 Manual attendance registers should be available at all Branch. In the event of un-registered new joiners or where biometric devices have not been installed or are dysfunctional, attendance for all employees shall be marked manually on attendance registers specifying time IN and time OUT. The LM/BH shall sign the daily attendance on manual registers.



53.5.4 In case of dysfunctional devices “branch pending attendance” application shall be forwarded based on manual attendance marked on registers until the time a functional device is installed.

53.5.5 Employees are responsible for checking their attendance raise all requests/ applications in a timely manner and get any errors/ omissions rectified e.g. attendance not marked etc.

53.6 PUNCTUALITY

Punctuality is the foundation of office discipline and needs to be meticulously observed by all Franchise network employees. Sincere efforts should be made to follow Branch official timings. Branch(s) may choose to modify these timings based on operational needs, business exigencies and regulatory requirements.

53.7 LATE ARRIVAL

53.7.1 If an employee arrives late at his/ her place of work, then following rules shall be applicable where biometric devices are installed:

53.7.2 Late arrival in a single day shall be treated on the following basis:

Sr. #	Late Minutes (Single day)	Resulting Impact
1	01 to 60	Included in accumulation (as explained in the following table)
2	61 to 120	Short leave (0.25 casual)
3	121 to 180	Half leave (0.50 casual)
4	181 to 240	Three Quarter (0.75 casual)
5	241 onwards	Full day (casual)

Note: In case time in or time out is missing, a full day shall be included as late minutes.

53.7.3 If cumulative late arrival time is more than 60 minutes in a month, then deductions from employee’s Casual/Sick leave balance or salary (in-case casual/Sick leave balance not available) shall be made on the following basis:

Sr. #	Late Minutes (Accumulated During a Month)	Deduction of Casual/Sick Leave(s) as applicable
1	1 to 60	Nil
2	61 to 120	0.25 day
3	121 to 180	0.50 day
4	181 to 240	0.75 day
5	241 to 300	1.00 day
6	301 to 360	1.25 days
7	361 to 420	1.50 days



Sr. #	Late Minutes (Accumulated During a Month)	Deduction of Casual/Sick Leave(s) as applicable
8	421 to 480	1.75 days
9	481 to 540	2.00 days
10	541 to 600	2.25 days
11	601 to 660	2.50 days
12	661 to 720	2.75 days
13	721 to 780	3.00 days
14	780 onwards	0.25 days deduction for every 60 minutes

Note: LM/BH shall monitor the habitual late arrivals and issue warning letters if necessary.

53.7.4 Late-minutes and absent deductions routine, for a financial year (1st July to 30th June), shall be run in accordance with the following schedule:

- July 1st July to 20th July (First routine)
- Routine 21st of every month to 20th of the subsequent month up to 20th May.
- June May 21st to 30th June (last routine)

53.7.5 For the purpose of salary calculation and deductions, attendance not marked and late arrivals shall be calculated from 21st of a month to 20th of next month.

53.7.6 For Teaching Staff and Teachers Aids, the late minute deduction will be done first from their sick leave balance, then from casual. In case of no balance available the same would be treated as leave without pay.

53.8 LEAVES AND ABSENCE

53.8.1 LEAVES

53.8.1.1 Employees must intimate in advance to their LM/BH or at least within the initial few hours of the day in case they do not intend to show up for work or are late. However, this shall not apply for planned annual leaves, employees are expected to discuss and obtain approval well in advance from line-manager for such leaves. Failure to obtain verbal/written approval from competent authority at least one day before or after an absence shall be deemed as an unauthorised absence.

53.8.1.2 Frequent/ Habitual unauthorised absences may invoke disciplinary action.

53.8.2 HABITUAL ABSENCE

53.8.2.1 Habit of frequently being away from work, usually without intimation and approval of the concerned line manager.

53.8.2.2 Procedure

The following procedure shall be followed in case of habitual absenteeism:

- Line manager must verbally advise the employee to correct his/her behaviour.
- In case the employee does not heed the advice and remains persistent with the above behaviour the Line manager may issue a written



advisory (advice) note mentioning the instances of occurrences. A copy of the said advice, duly acknowledged by the employee, shall be placed in the employee personal file.

- In case the employee does not act upon the above advice or correct his/her behaviour after receiving intimation, concerned BH must notify the concerned LM/BH for further action.

53.8.2.3 Responsibilities of BH

- Upon receiving notification from BH regarding the habitual absenteeism of the employee, Concerned LM/BH shall issue a show-cause notice to the employee.
- In case of an acceptable response, the LM/BH may choose to close the case, however, in cases where the response is unacceptable disciplinary action as deemed appropriate in the given circumstances maybe initiated keeping the LM and FI/BH in-loop. If the employee fails to comply with office timings/schedule even after the proposed action, the FO may consider terminating his/her services.

53.8.3 UNAUTHORISED LONG ABSENCE

53.8.3.1 If an employee fails to intimate/submit an application against his/her absence, the following procedure shall be followed:

53.8.3.2 Procedure

- LM/BH shall attempt to contact the employee at their last known telephone number or emergency contact of the employee if he/she fails to notify the management of his/her absence for three consecutive days.
- If the employee remains unreachable or doesn't contact the Branch within the five days of his/her absence, the BH shall inform the concerned LM/BH, keeping in the loop the FO, who shall take-up the matter. Then follow the official process as applicable.
- Upon intimation, the concerned BH shall try to contact the employee. Show cause notice shall be issued within five days of intimation by the concerned, if no contact has been established.
- Show cause notice shall be sent via registered mail to the employee's address on record.
- Failure to respond to the notice within the stipulated time-frame mentioned there-in, the process for termination of services shall automatically be initiated.

53.8.3.3 Responsibilities of the BH

The process is summarised below:

Scenario	Action
Unauthorised long absence for ten or more days	Show cause notice
Acceptable response to show cause notice	Resolution of case
Unacceptable response to show cause notice	Appropriate disciplinary action
No response to show cause notice	Termination by virtue of Code of Conduct

Note: Unconfirmed employees absent without report for three (3) or more consecutive days shall be reported to LM/BH, who shall in-turn put their salary on hold with immediate effect.



53.8.4 EXCEPTIONS

- 53.8.4.1 The following absences shall not be considered under this procedure, however, documentation must be provided along with approval from concerned authorities, in order to qualify for such exceptions:
- Death of a family or household member
 - Extended illness
 - Disciplinary suspension days
- 53.8.4.2 An illness or injury shall be established when supported by:
- a medical certificate from a licensed medical practitioner or registered hospital
 - a statutory declaration or other reasonable evidence otherwise legally admissible.

53.9 LATE SITTING

Late sitting is generally discouraged as it is inefficient, inconvenient and not cost-effective, except in cases of business exigency and/or special assignments. Employees, who may sometimes have to work late in the evening should do so with the approval of the concerned LM/BH, intimate concerned admin and security staff in writing and shall be expected to reach office on time the following morning. Late sitting cannot be used as an excuse for coming late the following day.

53.10 TARDINESS/LATENESS

- 53.10.1 Tardiness is defined as coming to work after the designated start time. Employees who fail to report at their scheduled office time shall be considered late. Employees are expected to report to work and return from official breaks as notified from time to time.
- 53.10.2 Employees who are late in a month with or without prior intimation to the concerned Line manager designated official authority shall have casual/sick leave or salary deduction according to the criteria stated in the "Attendance and Working-hours Policy".

53.11 OFFICIAL VISITS/OUTSTATION VISITS

- 53.11.1 Employees going on an official outstation visit must submit an application at least one (1) day before or within three working days after the completion of outstation visit date for the record and marking of the attendance.
- 53.11.2 Official visits (partial or full) within the city should be applied as outstation (quarter/half/full) as opposed to late arrivals.
- 53.11.3 Attendance in/out should be marked in case of partial day visits along with raising an (quarter/half) outstation application.



54. LEAVE POLICY - RECOMMENDED

54.1 SCOPE

- 54.1.1 The purpose of this policy is to lay down the rules and regulations relating to various categories of leaves.
- 54.1.2 This policy shall be applicable to all employees of the Franchise network including probationers.

54.2 GENERAL PRINCIPLES

- 54.2.1 The leave cycle of one year shall commence with the beginning of the financial year i.e. July 1.
- 54.2.2 All employees of Branch are entitled to leaves in accordance with the provisions as outlined below in the relevant sections.
- 54.2.3 Leave for employees joining Branch during the year shall be calculated as follows:
- 54.2.3.1 If an employee joins UCS on or before the 15th of any month, then that month shall be included in the calculation of leave entitlement.
- 54.2.3.2 If an employee joins after the 15th of a particular month then that month shall not be included when calculating leave entitlement.
- 54.2.4 All leave applications shall be submitted for approval through online or in writing as the situation warrants.
- 54.2.5 All leaves shall be based on calendar days.
- 54.2.6 Off days or gazette holidays falling in between leave periods (sandwiched) shall be counted as part of that leave. For example, if leave is applied for Friday and Monday, then Saturday and Sunday shall be included in the leave. However, it shall not apply on quarter/half leaves/toil affixed and/or prefixed with formerly mentioned holidays.
- 54.2.7 Sandwiched off days, for which no leave application is raised, shall be treated as leave without pay.
- 54.2.8 Any leave or absence that exceeds the available balance or is taken without approval shall be treated as leave without pay.

54.3 LEAVE ENTITLEMENT

54.3.1 Permanent Employees

Type of Leave	Leave Entitlement		
	Executive & Administrative Cadre	Teaching Cadre & Teacher's Aide	Office, Technical & Support Cadre
Annual	20 days	N/A	20 days
Casual	15 days	05 days	10 days
Medical	10 days	05 days	10 days



Type of Leave	Leave Entitlement		
	Executive & Administrative Cadre	Teaching Cadre & Teacher's Aide	Office, Technical & Support Cadre
Hajj	15 days	15 days	15 days
Maternity	45 days	45 days	45 days
Long/ study	3 to 12 months	3 to 12 months	3 to 12 months

Note: Teachers are entitled to scheduled school vacations, in lieu of annual leave. Teachers may, however, be required to attend in-service training courses etc. during school vacations (for a maximum of five days during summer/winter vacation).

54.3.2 For regular, confirmed employees, leave balance shall be updated on July 1 every year and the previous year's balance of casual and medical leaves shall lapse (or be encashed in case of the former as defined in this policy).

54.3.3 Earned Annual Leaves shall be updated for the current year, whereas, total Casual and Medical leaves shall be displayed for the current year from July 1. In case an employee's employment status changes such as after retirement or due to any other reason, the prorated leave entitlement shall be granted for the duration before the said status change only, while new entitlement shall be applicable as per new terms and conditions.

54.3.4 If an employee in Teaching Cadre is moved to the Non-Teaching Cadre after availing summer vacations at the school, (s)he shall not be entitled to Annual Leaves for that particular financial year. From the next year onwards, the accumulation and utilisation of the Annual Leave shall be the same as in other cases of non-teaching cadres.

Example: If an employee moves from Teaching to Admin cadre between August till May of an academic year (or any other months during the year) after getting summer/long official vacation, then (s)he shall be entitled to Annual Leaves from coming July. The entitlement effective month can be redefined as per approval of the management in special circumstances.

54.3.5 If an employee in a Non-Teaching Cadre is moved to the Teaching Cadre and he/she has balance annual leaves then he/she may avail leaves before taking charge on the new position otherwise the balance annual leaves shall lapse.

54.3.6 Probationers

54.3.6.1 All rules mentioned for permanent employees shall also be applicable to employees on probation. Entitlement of leave shall be determined proportionately on a monthly basis.

54.3.6.2 During probation, Casual and Medical leaves shall be calculated on a monthly prorated basis. Upon the start of a new financial year, during an employee's probation period, the previous year's leaves shall lapse and the new entitlement shall be updated on a monthly prorated basis until the time the said employee gets confirmed.



54.3.7 Contract and Other Employees

Entitlements of contract and other employees shall be as specified in their employment contract/appointment letter.

54.4 LEAVE APPLICATION PROCEDURE

54.4.1 All employees are required to inform their LM/BH in advance or at the latest within the initial hours of the day in question if they need to take Casual or Medical Leave. Upon resuming duty, employees shall submit their leave application through online or manual to their approving authority.

54.4.2 The approving authority, at their discretion and in the interests of Branch, may approve or decline the application as business exigencies dictate.

54.4.3 If a leave application is declined, it shall be treated as leave without pay.

54.4.4 Leave application shall be on prescribed format attached as **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-023)**.

54.5 APPROVAL OF LEAVE

54.5.1 All leaves, other than Study Leave and Long Leave, shall be approved by the following authorities:

Cadres/Designations	Approving Authority
Branch Heads	FO or Designee
Teaching & other staff at Branch other than Branch Heads	Branch Heads or Designee

Note: If an application is not specifically rejected by the Approving Authority and remains pending for more than 30 days from date of application, it shall be automatically treated as approved by the System.

54.5.2 Study Leave shall be approved by the following authorities

Designations/Cadre	Approving Authority
Branch Heads	FO or Designee
Teaching & other staff at Branch other than Branch Heads	Branch Heads or Designee

54.5.3 Long leave shall be approved by the following authorities:

Designations/Cadre	Approving Authority
Branch Heads	FO or Designee
Teaching & other staff at Branch other than Branch Heads	Branch Heads or Designee

54.5.4 Extension of Long/Study Leave shall be granted as per the recommendation of LM/BH and approval of the FO.



54.6 CASUAL LEAVE

The following rules shall be applicable for Casual Leave:

- 54.6.1 An employee shall be granted Casual Leave as per his/her entitlement.
- 54.6.2 Casual Leave shall not be granted for more than 3 consecutive days at a time. However, in a situation where no annual leave balance is available, more than 3 days' Casual Leave may be taken out of available/earned balance with the permission of the approving authority.
- 54.6.3 Casual Leave may be combined with Annual Leave in special circumstances with the appropriate approval.
- 54.6.4 Casual Leave balance that has not been availed cannot be carried forward and it shall lapse automatically at the end of the financial year i.e. June 30.

54.7 MEDICAL LEAVE

The following rules shall be applicable for Medical Leave:

- 54.7.1 Medical Leave shall be granted to the employee only in the case of illness. Medical Leave should only be treated as an 'entitlement' in the case of genuine illness.
- 54.7.2 Employees availing Medical Leave exceeding three consecutive days may be required by the Approving Authority (as defined in **Clause 54.5.1**) to submit a medical certificate issued by a registered medical practitioner in support of his/her application. It shall, however, be the Company's prerogative to ask for a medical certificate even in cases of a shorter period of leave.
- 54.7.3 Un-availed Medical Leave balance cannot be carried forward and it shall lapse automatically at the end of the financial year i.e. June 30.
- 54.7.4 Medical Leave shall not be attached with Annual Leave unless the employee provides a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner.
- 54.7.5 In the event of prolonged illness:
 - 54.7.5.1 Annual Leave may be granted along with Medical Leave subject to approval by the Approving Authority (as defined in **Clause 54.5.1**);
 - 54.7.5.2 Leave without pay (for instance in cases of prolonged illness) exceeding 30 days shall be granted subject to the approval of the FO.

54.8 ANNUAL LEAVE

The following rules shall be applicable for Annual Leaves:

- 54.8.1 Employees are eligible to avail Annual Leave after completion of 12 months of continuous service from their date of joining subject to confirmation of employment. In special circumstances, the Approving Authority (as defined in **Clause 54.5.1**), may allow proportionate Annual Leave to the confirmed employee, after approval by the FO.
- 54.8.2 Annual Leave shall be earned and accumulated on a monthly basis.
- 54.8.3 Each Department/Office/Branch shall draw up a leave roster of its employees to manage leaves efficiently.
- 54.8.4 Annual Leave cannot be applied for less than 4 days in continuation. However, the residual or due balance of annual leave of fewer than 4 days may be availed for



any number of consecutive days. However, Annual Leave may be availed for any number of days after all Medical and Casual leave balances have been completely exhausted.

54.8.5 Annual Leave can be carried forward and accumulated up to a maximum of 30 days.

54.8.6 Branch shall not be left unattended during the summer vacation. In addition to the requisite security staff, at least one senior member of the Branch administration should be present on duty as designated by the BH.

54.9 MATERNITY LEAVE

The following rules shall be applicable for Maternity Leave:

54.9.1 Regular, confirmed female employees shall be eligible for Maternity Leave after completion of one year of continuous service.

54.9.2 Maternity Leave, with pay, can be availed twice (any time) during the course of employment with Branch.

54.9.3 The employee shall apply for leave at least 30 days prior to the first day from which leave is required.

54.9.4 Maternity leave can be attached to Medical/Annual/Casual Leave subject to approval by the Approving Authority (as defined in **Clause 54.5.1**)

54.9.5 Maternity Leave shall not be availed for less than 30 days in one stretch. In case of availing less than 45 days of leaves, the balance shall lapse automatically.

54.10 LONG/STUDY LEAVE

The following rules shall be applicable for Long/Study Leave:

54.10.1 Long/Study Leave shall be without pay.

54.10.2 Employees shall be eligible for Long/Study Leave after completion of one year of service.

54.10.3 Employees may apply for Long/Study Leave between three months to one year at a time, which is further extendable to a maximum of one more year.

54.10.4 Upon completion of Long/Study Leave, if the employee fails to apply for an extension or re-join the Branch or the relevant position does not remain available, his/her services shall be deemed culminated.

54.10.5 Leave applications shall be forwarded for approval at least one month before proceeding on Long/Study Leave. The leave application shall be approved by the competent authority as mentioned in **Clause 54.5.2** or **54.5.3**, as the case may be.

54.10.6 In the case of Long Leave or continuous leave without pay for 90 days or more, the employee's leave balance shall be prorated accordingly.

54.10.7 When employees plan to go on Long Leave or avail continuous leave without pay for 90 days or more, they need to consider prorated calculation and entitlement before availing leaves for the pre-leave duration.



- 54.10.8 In case an employee has already availed more leaves than are available at the time of application for such long/without pay leave, recovery shall be made upon joining or from final settlement in case of resignation.
- 54.10.9 If an employee is on Long/Study Leave for more than 3 (three) consecutive months during an appraisal/increment year, he/she shall not be eligible for any increment in that appraisal year.
- 54.10.10 An employee on Long/Study Leave shall be required to inform his/her LM/BH of their intention to return or otherwise at least one month prior to the last day of his/her leave.
- 54.10.11 After the Long/Study Leave period expires:
- 54.10.11.1 The employee may re-join the Branch on the date agreed with the Approving Authority, subject to the availability of a suitable position.
 - 54.10.11.2 An employee is not entitled to claim, as his/her right, a position and posting he/she held before proceeding on Long/Study Leave.
 - 54.10.11.3 Before the expiry of Long/Study Leave, the employee may apply for an extension. The employee shall need to inform the LM/BH in writing, and the request shall go to FO for approval. In case the employee does not apply for an extension or there is no vacant position available then the employee's services shall be terminated within a month of the end of the leave.
- 54.10.12 The full tuition fee, in accordance with the existing rate, shall become due for the children of any employee proceeding on Long Leave, effective from the month in which his/her leave starts. The admission fee and security, however, shall not be charged. (Leave without pay of more than 90 days in continuity shall also be treated in the same manner).
- 54.10.13 The employee's salary shall be suspended for the period of Long/Study Leave. On their joining, the respective office shall submit a rejoining report for the employee to the BH or designee.

54.11 HAJJ LEAVE

The following rules shall be applicable for Hajj Leave:

- 54.11.1 All Muslim regular, confirmed employees of Branch are entitled to 15 days paid leave for Hajj after completion of one year of service.
- 54.11.2 This leave shall be granted once during their employment.
- 54.11.3 Leave application(s) shall be forwarded for approval at least one month prior to proceeding on Hajj.
- 54.11.4 Within one month of return, the employee shall submit a copy of his/her Hajj documents and ticket (boarding pass) for confirmation of leaves otherwise this leave shall be treated as leave without pay.
- 54.11.5 Annual and/or Casual Leave can be attached to Hajj Leave with approval of the Approving Authority (as defined in **Clause 54.5.1**).



54.12 COMPENSATORY LEAVE (TOIL)

The following rules shall be applicable for Compensatory Leave:

- 54.12.1 Admin, Office, Support and Technical (excluding teacher's aide positions) cadre employees are entitled to Compensatory Leave.
- 54.12.2 An employee who is required to perform official duty (duly approved) after office hours or on an off day and/or gazette holiday (Including Outstations), shall be entitled to Compensatory Leave. Half Compensatory Leave shall be allowed for working between 4 to 6 hours in a single day whereas full Compensatory Leave shall be allowed for working of 6 hours or more in a single day.
- 54.12.3 Compensatory Leave may be availed within 60 days effective from the holiday/off day worked.

54.13 LEAVE ENCASHMENT

- 54.13.1 For the purpose of leave encashment, the calculation shall be based on the Gross Pay drawn (excluding all allowances) in the month of June of the previous financial year.
- 54.13.2 The following categories of leave may be encashed as per the specified terms:

54.13.2.1 Casual Leave

Un-availed Casual Leave balance shall be admissible for the encashment as follows:

- For all confirmed employees, except teaching staff /teacher's aide, up to half of the entitlement is admissible for encashment after the end of the financial year.
- Employees should have attained "confirmed" status in June's payroll before the end of the particular financial year for which encashment is being processed.
- For confirmed teaching staff and teacher's aide, the total balance of Casual Leaves is admissible for encashment.
- In case of cadre change during the year, prorated leave encashment shall be processed for the entitlement in both cadres. For example, an employee's cadre changes from Teaching to Admin in January. In such a case, the entitlement and rules related to the Teaching Cadre shall be applicable from July-December while the entitlement and rules related to the Admin Cadre shall be applicable from January-June.

54.13.2.2 Annual leave

The un-availed accumulated balance of Annual Leaves up to a maximum of 30 days in addition to leaves proportionately accumulated for the current year shall be encashed at the time of final settlement or may be adjusted against the notice period at the time of severance of the contract of employment.

54.14 EXCEPTIONS

The UCS management (HR) may consider exemptions from this policy as the situation may warrant.



55. CONVEYANCE POLICY - RECOMMENDED

55.1 SCOPE

- 55.1.1 The purpose of the policy is to establish the specific norms which detail employee business travel and related entitlements, regulate the authorization and reporting of travel and entertainment expenses within Pakistan.
- 55.1.2 The policy applies to all permanent employees of Franchise network. The policy shall also apply to contract employees subject to business needs or terms of their contract. All limits are maximum allowed limits and must not be exceeded.

55.2 AUTHORIZATION OF TRAVEL

- 55.2.1 Travel activity shall be initiated with the consent and verbal approval from the competent authority. The approving authority after determining the reasonableness of the expenses claimed, shall grant final approval.
- 55.2.2 All travel must be approved by the following mentioned authorities:

Designation of Travelers	Approving Authority
Branch Heads	Self – subject to terms and conditions mentioned in this policy.*
Teaching** & other staff at Branch	Branch Head

* The LM/BH should be informed.

55.3 WITHIN CITY TRAVEL

- 55.3.1 Employees shall be reimbursed their conveyance expense in accordance with the table summarized below;

Branch Heads along with all school-based positions not including office, Technical and Support Cadre positions (800 CC and 1000 CC car)	Existing Price of Super Petrol / 9 x kilometers travelled
Company provided Motorcycle	Existing Price of Super Petrol / 20 x kilometers travelled
Employee owned Car or Motorcycle	(Amount calculated as in case of company vehicle) x (1.5)

- 55.3.2 In the case of public transportation, all expenses shall be paid in actual
- 55.3.3 Expenses shall be claimed through Conveyance form attached as **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-024)**.
- 55.3.4 In case of Car/Motorcycle, claim shall be admissible in accordance with the mileage entitlement as per table given above. The focal point, for mileage measurement, shall be the employee's actual location of departure i.e. workplace/home, as the case may be.
- 55.3.5 An employee shall not be entitled to claim conveyance if a fuel allowance has been sanctioned because of the nature of his/her job, for instance, dispatchers etc.



55.4 **INTERCITY TRAVEL**

- 55.4.1 Employees shall claim conveyance as per table given above.
- 55.4.2 In the case of public transportation, all expenses shall be paid in actual.
- 55.4.3 In case of Car/Motorcycle, claim shall be admissible in accordance with the mileage entitlement as per table given above. The focal point, for mileage measurement, shall be the employee's actual location of departure i.e. workplace/home, as the case may be.

55.5 **EXCEPTIONS**

Exceptions in case for Branch based staff shall be approved by the FO.



56. CONFLICT OF INTEREST - RECOMMENDED

56.1 PREAMBLE

- 56.1.1 The employees of Branch and others, acting on Franchises' behalf, engage in a wide range of activities including but not limited to traditional academic activities, teachers and students exchange program, foreign trips, procurement of goods and services, construction, renovation and maintenance activities and investment of funds.
- 56.1.2 Conflicts of interest occur when an employee or immediate family member receives a personal financial benefit from the employee's position in the Company in a manner which may inappropriately influence the employee's judgment or compromise the employee's ability to carry out his/her responsibilities or could be a detriment to the integrity of the Company or its employees. All the employees and others, acting on Franchise's behalf, must be free from conflicts of interest that could adversely influence their judgment, objectivity or loyalty to Franchise in conducting its business activities and assignments. UCS management recognises that employees may take part in legitimate financial, business, charitable and other activities outside their job in Franchise Network, but any potential conflict of interest raised by those activities shall be disclosed promptly to the Management.
- 56.1.3 For the purpose of this Policy, a personal interest of employee shall mean the personal interest of the employee or any of his/her family members or dependents.

56.2 PURPOSE & OBJECTIVE

The purpose of this Policy is:

- 56.2.1 To highlight and illustrate potential conflict situations, some of which are not obvious.
- 56.2.2 To set out which activities can be managed (and how they can be managed), the Management requires that the concerned employee(s) shall always disclose an activity in which UCS is a party, directly or indirectly, if he/she is in doubt about whether it represents a conflict of interest.
- 56.2.3 Objective of this Policy is to avoid, if not possible then to minimise, the effect of the situations where a potential conflict of interest arises as a result of an activity in which UCS is directly or indirectly a party.

56.3 SCOPE

This policy shall be applicable to all employees of Franchise Network and all activities (events and transactions) in which UCS is a party.

56.4 SITUATIONS GIVING RISE TO CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Situations that may be considered as giving rise to an actual or perceived conflict of interest shall include the following;

56.4.1 FINANCIAL INTEREST IN VENDORS/CONTRACTORS

An employee shall be considered as having a personal or financial interest in vendors/contractors in the following situations;

- 56.4.1.1 Partnership, shareholding or other material interest in any company which



has or is in the process of negotiating a contract with UCS/Franchise network.

- 56.4.1.2 Partnership, shareholding or other material interest in any Bank, Financial Institution (FI), Development Financial Institution (DFI) or Non-banking Finance Company (NBFC) with which UCS or any of its sister concerns has a relationship as a client (as investor or borrower). FI's, DFI.s and NBFC's shall be considered as vendors for the purpose of this policy.
- 56.4.1.3 Personal interest in construction renovation and maintenance activities of UCS/Franchise network other than as in the official capacity.
- 56.4.1.4 Employees having a direct or indirect relationship with vendors/suppliers/contractors with which UCS/ Franchise network does or is likely to do business.

56.4.2 PERSONAL INTERESTS / RELATIONSHIPS

An employee shall be considered as having a conflict of interest in the following situations;

- 56.4.2.1 Performance appraisals and promotions of employees who are close relatives of the employees involved in decision making regarding such appraisals and promotions.
- 56.4.2.2 Where an employee is engaged in any commercial activities from which he derives direct benefit and it adversely affects the interests and primary obligations of UCS/ Franchise network or where such activity consumes an undue share of the employee's attention required to perform his/her duties.

56.4.3 GIFTS & GIVEAWAYS

Acceptance or use of gifts (excluding diaries, calendars, paperweights and other such items having a value less than PKR 5,000) and hospitality of material nature from vendors/suppliers, their representatives or other persons regardless of the nature of the gift.

56.4.4 SPONSORED VISITS

It includes the following;

- 56.4.4.1 Teachers exchange program and training visits in collaboration with local and international educational institutions, other than those planned and organised by the Management.
- 56.4.4.2 Foreign and local universities sponsored trips for employees or any of his/her family members.
- 56.4.4.3 Vendor/suppliers sponsored trips for employees or any of his/her family members.
- 56.4.4.4 Vendor/suppliers sponsored training programmes.

56.4.5 USE OF UCS FACILITIES

It shall mean a situation where an employee uses the UCS's administrative facilities to pursue personal business, commercial or consulting activities.



56.4.6 ANY OTHER MATTER

Any other matter that may give rise to a perceived or potential conflict of interest.

56.5 PROCEDURE FOR DISCLOSURE OF CONFLICT OF INTEREST

56.5.1 The responsibility to disclose actual, potential or perceived conflict lies on employees of Franchise network. When in doubt, the employees shall disclose an interest in advance to their LM/BH. Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form shall be filled and signed by the concerned employee. The same shall be submitted to the FO for approval.

56.5.2 Example: A book supplier/publisher sends an invite to the concerned staff of the Education Department for a fully sponsored foreign visit to attend an exhibition. Such a trip though not discouraged but should only be accepted after proper disclosure stating background facts and remedial action for mitigation of the potential conflict of interest and getting approval from concerned authority.

56.5.3 Failure to disclose a matter which later comes to the Management's attention as an actual, potential or perceived conflict of interest shall be subject to thorough investigation as a serious disciplinary offence.

56.5.4 The employee shall recuse himself/herself from consideration of that matter, till decision by the competent authority.

56.5.5 Any gifts/invitations of a material nature that are accepted must be disclosed to LM/BH. Should an employee have any doubt regarding the circumstances or propriety in relation to gifts, or hospitality, which may be offered should be declined by them or obtain advice from LM/BH.

56.6 RECORD KEEPING

A complete record of all activities involving conflict of interest shall be maintained by the BH and be placed in employee personal file.

56.7 EXCEPTIONS TO THE POLICY

In special circumstances, UCS management (HR) may approve exceptions to this policy as the situation may warrant, keeping in view the practical considerations.



57. LEGAL AND COMPLIANCE - MANDATORY

Franchise Management must ensure compliance with all applicable laws such as:

- Regulations of Government / Ministry of Education
- Labour Laws
- EOBI & Social Security
- Taxation laws
- general and industry specific laws
- Corporate laws



SECTION 7:

FINANCE & ACCOUNTS



58. CASH COLLECTION AT BRANCHES - MANDATORY

58.1 INTRODUCTION

In addition to a wide range of academic & extracurricular activities offered at Branch, optional co-curricular / social activities come up every now and then. Such activities are generally undertaken privately by students (at their option) or are initiated/supported by private bodies. A few examples of such activities is as under:

- Participation in Mathematics / Language / Science Competitions e.g. IKMC, IKLC etc.
- Participation in Art / Film / Drama Competition etc.
- Debate / Journalism contests
- School Magazine
- Bon-fire & farewell parties

Being an essential component of student grooming/development, UCS Management endeavors to encourage, facilitate and guide students to participate in/execute such activities. The FM shall supervise cash collection from interested students/vendors, in connection with all such activities as part of the facilitation process.

- 58.1.1 Branches are not allowed to collect cash, except for activities specifically approved by UCS Management.
- 58.1.2 The list of approved activities shall be forwarded by the UCS Management (Education Department HO) to Branch.

58.2 COLLECTION OF STUDENT FUND

- 58.2.1 Branch Head shall select the activities, from the approved list, to be participated in by Students.
- 58.2.2 School shall send a circular to parents containing detail of the activity (event, occurrence date, amount, last date of payment), to obtain their consent and identify potential participants.
- 58.2.3 Collection of SF shall be made by the concerned Class Teacher (CT) in accordance with the timelines mentioned in the circular.
- 58.2.4 Class Teacher shall obtain "Class List" (CL) from the OMS and record the amount received against the name of each student. The CT shall total the amounts received, mention the activity and sign the list.
- 58.2.5 The CT shall then submit the amount collected along with the CL to BA within two days from the last date mentioned in the Circular.
- 58.2.6 The BA shall provide the acknowledgement of amount received to CT.
- 58.2.7 BA shall prepare the summary of amount collected and submit the summary, amount and CLs to BH for approval.
- 58.2.8 BA shall keep memorandum record of the cash collected and the amount expended for the approved activity.



- 58.2.9 Statement of cash collected and the amount expended shall be duly signed by the FM.
- 58.2.10 Activities should be planned in a way that cash collection exactly matches the amount of relevant expenditure.
- 58.2.11 Branch Accountant shall not directly collect the cash and/or start liaison with students in the Branch.
- 58.2.12 In case some amount is left in the balance, the same shall be returned to respective students.
- 58.2.13 Under no circumstances the collection for a particular activity shall be used for any other activities and/or operational purposes.

58.3 SUBMISSION OF EXPENSES

- 58.3.1 BA shall prepare an Excel Summary of receipts & expenses, for each activity, and submit it to BH, on monthly basis.
- 58.3.2 All documents, vouchers and bills of expenses incurred from SF shall be submitted to UCS Management (HO/RO Finance) on quarterly basis.
- 58.3.3 Any observations shall be resolved by coordination with concerned BH.



59. BANK, CASH & PAYMENT PROCESS - RECOMMENDED

59.1 BANK

- 59.1.1 All fee collection bank accounts shall be opened in the name of Company and operated by the UCS Management. The Board of Directors of the Company will designate banks with which all banking transactions will be conducted and the Board may at its discretion add to, or delete from or vary the list of designated banks.
- 59.1.2 The bank accounts of the Branch will be operated by the FO or officials authorized by him/her. UCS Management shall transfer the funds to FO's bank account after deduction of Royalty and other charges.
- 59.1.3 Payments for more than PKR 10,000 in particular and all other payments in general should be made through crossed cheques marked "Payee Account Only". Exceptions may however be made for cheques to be issued for replenishment of petty cash/utility bills.
- 59.1.4 Only one cheque book for each bank account will be used at a time. Use of two or more cheque books simultaneously for a single bank account must not be allowed.
- 59.1.5 Spoiled cheques will be cancelled and retained for inspection.
- 59.1.6 The cheque books must always be kept under lock and key.
- 59.1.7 All bank payments from Branch bank account shall be made after obtaining approval from the FM on Bank Payment Vouchers.
- 59.1.8 All vouchers for banking transactions (receipts/payments) will be filed serially along with appropriate supporting documents.

59.2 PETTY CASH

- 59.2.1 In order to meet expenses or purchase of goods and services of a minor nature on a day-to-day basis a petty cash balance shall be maintained at Branches.
- 59.2.2 The maximum limit of closing balance of cash in hand is PKR 25,000.
- 59.2.3 This petty cash imprest will be replenished from time to time when the balance of cash is near to end.
- 59.2.4 Petty cash will be kept under lock and key for safe custody.
- 59.2.5 Physical balance of cash in hand should be reconciled with cash account on daily basis.
- 59.2.6 BH could at his/her own discretion may advance small sums of money to other Officials at Branch.
- 59.2.6.1 These advances however will only be given where the nature of work requires petty expenditure frequently so that such expenses can be met without delay.



- 59.2.6.2 These Officials shall incur the expenses in accordance with policies and procedures mentioned in this Manual and submit adjustments duly supported by invoices and/or proper documentation.

59.3 PAYMENT OF INVOICES

- 59.3.1 All the purchases shall be made in accordance with the Section “Procurement Activities” of this manual.
- 59.3.2 Payments of minor nature may be made through petty cash / bearer cheque. However, any payment exceeding PKR 10,000 shall be made through crossed cheque.
- 59.3.3 Once the payment voucher has been generated a cheque will be prepared for the net payable amount.
- 59.3.4 The cheque will be submitted to the signatory(ies) along with the payment voucher and the supporting documents. The payment voucher will be approved by the FM.
- 59.3.5 Acknowledgement of receipt will be obtained from Payee on Bank Payment voucher at the time of delivering the cheque. Photocopy of the cheque shall also be attached with the voucher.
- 59.3.6 With-holding tax should be deducted on all payments while considering the Tax Rate and the limit prescribed by the Income Tax Ordinance/Rules.
- 59.3.7 Branch Accountant has to ensure that Withholding Tax is deposited within the stipulated time.
- 59.3.8 Vouchers of all transactions (receipts and payments) shall be prepared by the BA and filed in sequential order, after obtaining approval from the FM.

59.4 BANK RECONCILIATION

- 59.4.1 Bank reconciliation statements are statements prepared to reconcile the bank balance as per the bank statement and as per the books of accounts on a particular date. These are prepared by comparing entries made in the books of accounts with those appearing in the bank statement.
- 59.4.2 BA shall be responsible for the preparation of monthly bank reconciliation statement(s) of bank accounts being operated by Branch.
- 59.4.3 Any long outstanding reconciling items appearing in bank reconciliation statement for a considerable period of time and have not yet been resolved will be thoroughly scrutinized to ensure the genuineness of the items. It should be ensured that no unidentified items appear as reconciling items.
- 59.4.4 Discrepancies if any, found in reconciliation will be thoroughly investigated, all necessary inquiries will be made to carry out adjustments.
- 59.4.5 FO shall carefully review the bank reconciliation statement and sign it as evidence.



60. MEMORANDUM REGISTERS AT BRANCH - RECOMMENDED

60.1 GUIDELINES

- 60.1.1 For the purpose of effective control, certain stock registers shall be maintained by Branches. Standard “Stock Registers” containing columns for receipt, issuance, balance and remarks shall be used for this purpose.
- 60.1.2 Different registers shall be used for different types of assets / items e.g. sports items shall be recorded in “Sports Items Stock Register”.
- 60.1.3 Separate pages/sections shall be used to record each item/article e.g. Board Markers shall be recorded on one page of the Register and Chart Papers on a separate one.
- 60.1.4 Index pages shall be used to identify location of items recorded in the Stock Register.
- 60.1.5 Receipts and issuance shall be recorded on timely basis in their respective column.
- 60.1.6 Remarks column may be used for “recipients’ acknowledgements” or “remarks” if any.
- 60.1.7 These registers shall be kept in safe custody and be updated regularly.
- 60.1.8 These registers shall be signed by the BH on bi-monthly basis.
- 60.1.9 Old Stock Registers for last Six Years shall be kept safe to comply with the tax laws.

60.2 STOCK REGISTERS

- 60.2.1 Following Stock Registers shall be maintained by the Branch.

Sr. No.	Stock Register	Maintained By
1	Fixed Assets Register	BA
2	Music Register	Music Teacher
3	Sports items Register	Sports Teacher
4	Teaching Aid Register	Designated Official by BH
5	Consumable Stationery Register	Designated Teacher



61. ROYALTY

- 61.1 The Network Associate pays the royalty to “United Charter Schools” (a business unit of Educational Services (Private) Limited) for use of its brand name. The royalty is charged at an agreed rate on the gross revenue as per the Franchise Agreement. Any discretionary discount on this may be granted by the UCS Management.
- 61.2 The designated bank (UCS collection bank account) is advised to deduct Royalty on behalf of UCS and applicable Govt. taxes, if any, from the fee received and credit the remaining amount to the Franchise’s bank account.
 - 61.2.1 Finance department UCS (HO/RO) shall receive the Bank Scroll showing challan numbers, fee received, amount of royalty, Govt. tax(es) and amount transferred out from fee collection account to the Franchise’s bank account.
 - 61.2.2 Finance department UCS (HO/RO) shall check the accuracy of Royalty Fee deducted by bank as shown on the scroll.
 - 61.2.3 The Royalty is calculated on the basis of student numbers as per OMS on the beginning of each month and the bill for outstanding royalty shall be sent to the FM. Other amounts owed by the campus shall be included in the bill distinctively.
 - 61.2.4 The revenue collected through tuition fee challan is recorded into OMS and the said receipt along with royalty thereon is recorded into General Ledger.
- 61.3 Reconciliation of Royalty amount shall be made on quarterly basis. Differences, if any, shall be discussed/resolved between FM and UCS Management (Finance department).



SECTION 8:

ASSETS & RELATED RECORDS - RECOMMENDED



62. FIXED ASSETS

62.1 TYPES

62.1.1 Fixed assets are those assets which have useful life of more than one year. Fixed assets are classified as under:

- Tangible Fixed Assets
- Intangible Fixed Assets

62.1.2 **Tangible assets** held by an enterprise for use in the production or supply of goods or services, for rental to others or for administrative purposes; and expected to be used for more than one financial period (12 months). Leased assets acquired under IFRS-16 are also included in this category.

62.1.3 **Intangible assets** are those assets which do not exist physically but carry financial and market values and appear as source of competitive advantage for the Company e.g. goodwill, patent, copyrights, software, licenses, etc.

62.2 CATEGORIES OF FIXED ASSETS

62.2.1 **Tangible Fixed Assets** have been classified into following broad categories:

- Land
- Building on Freehold land
- Building on Leasehold land
- Furniture & Fixtures
- Vehicles
- Computer Equipment
- Office Equipment
- Educational Equipment
- Ground Equipment
- Sports Equipment
- Library Books

62.2.2 **Intangible Fixed Assets** have been classified into the following broad categories:

- Software
- Website
- Licenses
- Patents & Copy Rights
- Goodwill

62.3 UTILIZATION OF ASSETS

62.4 Every Official shall use assets for Official purpose only and shall exercise reasonable care for its safekeeping. The use of fixed assets shall be in accordance with all applicable policies and country laws & regulations.

62.5 Off Campus/Office use, personal use of Company owned/leased assets, supplies/materials is prohibited. Exception may be granted FO in this regard.



63. SAFE CUSTODY OF ASSETS

63.1 RESPONSIBILITY

- 63.1.1 BH shall have responsibility for the safe custody of the assets of the Branch.
- 63.1.2 BH shall safe guard the Branch assets; however, primary responsibility for the said assets shall rest with concerned Officials to whom these fixed assets were assigned.
- 63.1.3 BA shall share the responsibility for lost/damaged assets resulting from negligence, intentional act, and failure to exercise reasonable care to safeguard, maintain and service the assets in their respective domain.

63.2 SAFE CUSTODY AT THE TIME OF VACATIONS, CIVIL WORK ETC.

Fixed assets of the Branch shall be properly safeguarded during:

- Closure and resumption of schools (vacations)
- Closure due to natural disasters (e.g. Covid-19 earthquake etc.)
- Civil work / Branch repair & maintenance work
- Movement of assets to other locations for school function events etc.

63.3 PHYSICAL VERIFICATION OF FIXED ASSETS

- 63.3.1 A periodic physical verification of fixed assets is necessary for accountability and control. This would confirm the existence of fixed assets against those appearing in Fixed Assets Register & GL.
- 63.3.2 Physical verification of all fixed assets (100%) shall be conducted at least once in a year.
- 63.3.3 Findings of physical verification of fixed assets shall be reviewed by the BH and submitted to FO.
- 63.3.4 Findings of physical verification, write offs shall be approved by the FO (write offs include; stolen, misplaced and/or destroyed assets).

63.4 PROCESS FOR INVESTIGATION OF MISSING / STOLEN ASSETS

- 63.4.1 In case of fixed asset(s) missing/stolen, the employee to whom the asset was assigned or who was responsible for its usage shall immediately inform the matter to his/her BH.
- 63.4.2 The BH shall immediately initiate a formal investigation in an effort to locate all missing/stolen assets.
- 63.4.3 An individual who, through misuse or neglect, causes or permits assets to be missing, stolen, damaged, or destroyed may be held responsible for the loss sustained. Written down value and market value may be considered to determine the amount of loss. In case of stolen assets, further process shall be conducted in accordance with the Code of Conduct Policy (**Section 40**).



64. DISPOSAL OF FIXED ASSETS

64.1 GENERAL

- 64.1.1 It is the policy of Branch to exhaust the usefulness of a fixed asset before its disposal.
- 64.1.2 BA shall inspect the assets to be disposed off. BA shall submit his/her inspection report to FM for review and approval.
- 64.1.3 Fixed assets shall be disposed off after obtaining written approval from FO.
- 64.1.4 Trade-ins shall be treated as proceeds of disposal and used in calculating the gain or loss on the disposal of the assets being traded in. The new asset acquired shall be recorded at its full cost i.e. it would not be reduced by the trade-in value of the old asset.
- 64.1.5 Gain or loss on disposals shall be determined by comparing sale proceeds with carrying value and the resulting gain or loss shall be included in the profit and loss account for the month. In case of write-off of assets, the recovery amount on account of insurance claim shall also be considered.

64.2 GUIDELINES FOR DISPOSAL OF IT EQUIPMENT

- 64.2.1 The Branch holds and processes large amounts of information using a wide variety of IT equipment (laptops, notebooks, servers, mobile phones, digital recorders, cameras, USBs etc.).
- 64.2.2 Such information/data and the equipment are required to be disposed-off in a secure manner, using cost effective and efficient methodologies.
- 64.2.3 For it such IT equipment will undergo appropriate physical destruction or an appropriate data overwrite procedure which irretrievably destroys any data or information held on that equipment.

64.3 REPAIR AND MAINTENANCE

- 64.3.1 Maintenance is the act of keeping assets in a usable condition, including preventative maintenance, normal repairs, replacement of parts and other activities needed to preserve the asset so that it continues to provide acceptable services and achieves its expected life.
- 64.3.2 All Branches will carry out periodic repair & maintenance of assets to preserve the assets in good working condition.
- 64.3.3 Once an asset is placed in service, a Branch may incur costs that may be categorized as:
- Repairs and maintenance of existing components
 - Replacement of existing components
 - Acquisition of additional components
- 64.3.4 The costs of normal, recurring, or periodic repairs and maintenance activities that are incurred after an asset is placed in service should be charged to expense. Major



repair and maintenance activities shall be capitalized in accordance with the accounting practice.

- 64.3.5 Responsibility to maintain fixed assets in proper working conditions rests with the BA. In this regard, the BA shall ensure that fixed assets are being properly looked after.

64.4 RECORDKEEPING AND AUDIT TRAIL

- 64.4.1 The relevant record shall be kept for a minimum period of Ten years.
- 64.4.2 A clear audit trail comprising of record of all core activities shall be maintained by the BA/Incharge Admin RO/Incharge Admin HO.
- 64.4.3 S&A Officials shall conduct the audit of fixed assets during periodic Branch audit visits. Compliance with prescribed procedures shall also be ensured with respect to parts of the workflow and authorization mechanism associated with RO and HO.

64.5 EXCEPTIONS TO THIS SECTION OF MANUAL

In special circumstances, FO may approve exceptions to this section as the situation may warrant, keeping in view the practical considerations.



SECTION 9:

REPORTING AND ADMINISTRATIVE MATTERS



65. PERIODIC REPORTS / DOCUMENTS TO BE SUBMITTED BY BRANCH TO UCS MANAGEMENT - MANDATORY

- 65.1 FM shall submit the reports / documents to UCS Management in accordance with the Franchisee Agreement.
- 65.2 FM shall forward student-wise and class-wise strength report to UCS Management, on monthly basis by 10th of the following month.
- 65.3 UCS Management shall determine the timelines, contents and formats of reports / documents to be submitted by the FM.
- 65.4 UCS Management may require additional information/reports/documents as deemed appropriate by the UCS Management.



SECTION 10: PROCUREMENT ACTIVITIES (RECOMMENDED)



66. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

66.1 Main purposes are as follows:

- Establish a framework for a common understanding of “Procurement”.
- Lay down detailed policies and procedures for efficient and effective procurement of best goods / services at the right value and time.
- Clarify the principle of segregation of responsibilities.
- Set down comprehensive control procedures for sourcing of potential vendors, procurement and other supply chain processes.

66.2 This Policy shall apply to all goods/items and services procured by Concordia Colleges.

66.3 CRM activities shall be dealt in accordance with the “CRM Activities” Section of this Manual.

67. BRANCH PURCHASE COMMITTEE (BPC)

67.1 MEMBERS OF BPC

67.1.1 BPC shall be constituted by the FO and may contain following members:

- Branch Accountant
- Two Teachers

67.1.2 Members of BPC shall exercise their duties and responsibilities with the utmost care, efficiency, impartiality and integrity.

67.2 FUNCTIONS OF BPC

67.3 BPC shall ensure that the proposed procurement actions are based, inter-alia, on fairness, integrity and transparency, and as such are impartial and unambiguous.

67.4 General functions of BPC would be as follows:

- Review that equal opportunity is provided to every genuine competitor.
- Review, evaluate RFQ, CSQ and related documents submitted.
- Review negotiated price, terms & conditions, where situation warrants. PC may choose to further negotiate with vendor for pricing, terms and conditions.
- Review suggestions / complaints by end users and vendors.
- Review and advise on whether proposed procurement actions are in accordance with the Procurement Policy and other policies and procedures applicable at the Branch.
- At least two members of BPC shall sign all the invoices/cash memos which are subject to raising of PR.

68. PROCUREMENT AUTHORITY

68.1 FO shall authorize concerned Officials to carry out, on Branch’s behalf, all procurement of goods and / or hiring of services. Generally, this authority is given to BH for routine/petty expenses whereas major procurements are approved by the FO.



69. BEST VALUE FOR MONEY & ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

69.1 BEST VALUE FOR MONEY PRINCIPLE

- 69.1.1 Procurement Official(s) are primarily responsible for ensuring the best value for money in the procurement and delivery process. The requisitioner, Procurement Official(s) are responsible for demand rationalization. The reviewing and approving authorities have the responsibility for ensuring that the said principle has been applied properly.
- 69.1.2 In this regard, the following factors need to be taken into consideration and weighted against end-users needs as objectively as possible:
- 69.1.2.1 **Cost-related factors:** such as cost, volume discounts, additional operating / maintenance costs, taxation, logistics etc.
 - 69.1.2.2 **Non-cost-related factors:** Factors or attributes that are related to the Branch's needs and requirements (e.g., technical merits of the offered goods, services or works; compliance with specifications; quality; timeliness of delivery; competence, reliability and financial condition of the prospective supplier; and compliance with contractual terms and conditions).
 - 69.1.2.3 **Market environment:** Overall market maturity and availability of alternative options.
 - 69.1.2.4 **Risk factors:** Any risk that may jeopardize the successful outcome of a procurement (e.g., financial viability and capacity of the supplier; legal exposure and liability; geo-political circumstances; price stability; and dependency).

69.2 ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

- 69.2.1 Honesty, fairness, transparency and courtesy are essential qualities that must be evident in negotiations with suppliers and other contractors.
- 69.2.2 Sharing of approved rates with the bidders / vendors is considered as a serious malpractice.

69.3 CONFLICT OF INTEREST

- 69.3.1 Any employee of the Branch involved in the procurement of goods, services and equipment on behalf of the Branch must disclose in advance any personal interest, which might impinge on, or might reasonably be deemed by others to impinge on his / her impartiality, in any matter related to his / her duties.
- 69.3.2 All relevant provisions stated in "Conflict of Interest Policy" shall apply on all employees involved in procurement process.



70. SOURCING

70.1 COMPETITIVE SOURCING

- 70.1.1 Through process of competitive sourcing, a reasonable number of vendors would be registered to carry out efficient, organized and transparent procurement process. The term vendor includes the supplier of goods, service providers and subcontractors for the purpose of this Policy.
- 70.1.2 Competitive sourcing will help in vendor selection, continuous evaluation and maintaining a responsive network of vendors to achieve Company's objectives.
- 70.1.3 Members of BPC shall search for suitable vendors for a particular procurement.
- 70.1.4 Members of respective PC may meet with vendors for negotiations of price, contractual terms, technical specifications etc.

71. ASSESSMENT & REGISTRATION OF VENDORS

71.1 GENERAL

- 71.1.1 BPC shall assess the potential vendors based on the criteria mentioned in **Clause 71.2** of this Manual.
- 71.1.2 In assessing vendors BPC may also obtain information from other sources, such as commercial databases, publications, trade associations and information from other suppliers, subcontractors, clients etc. of the potential vendor.
- 71.1.3 All vendors are required to disclose any relative or related person working with the Branch.

71.2 ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Following factors shall be considered while assessing the potential vendor(s):

- 71.2.1 Company Profile:
- General information about the vendor and its products / services.
 - Experience in providing respective goods and / or services. Preferably, the vendor should have been in business for a period of at least three (3) years.
- 71.2.2 Vendor's client base.
- 71.2.3 Financial stability:
- Consider financial information i.e. financial statements, tax returns etc. of vendor to determine financial stability (where applicable).
 - Factors (if any) such as deficit in net worth, insolvency, major litigation, liens etc. shall be evaluated carefully.
- 71.2.4 Vendor's performance history:
- Valid references (preferably three) confirming good performance, from clients to whom the vendor has provided products / services over the past twelve (12) months.



71.2.5 Capability / Relevance / Suitability of the products or services offered to the Company:

Designated Officials / BPC may visit premises / factory of potential vendor(s) to evaluate the vendor's capability of providing the goods / services of desired quantity and quality. Relevance / Suitability of goods / services provided by the vendor within stipulated time shall also be assessed.

71.2.6 Payment terms:

The payment terms offered by the vendor e.g. credit period, discounts, mode of payment etc. shall be evaluated.

71.2.7 Quality of products:

Adherence to desired quality standards of the products or services offered shall be evaluated. Certificate of quality issued by a recognized independent organization to be submitted (where applicable).

71.2.8 Logistics:

The ability to provide a national network of agents or authorized dealers for delivery of goods / services (where applicable) shall be reviewed.

71.2.9 After sales service:

Vendor's ability to provide after sales support and warranty claims shall be assessed.

71.2.10 Vendor's compliance level with applicable legislation shall be inquired.

71.2.11 Any other factors which in opinion of BH or BPC are required to be assessed.

71.3 REGISTRATION OF VENDORS

71.3.1 The procurement shall be made from registered vendors.

71.3.2 After the assessment of vendor, BPC may recommend to record the vendor's name in "Vendors Register" after obtaining approval from the BH.

71.3.3 Following are the minimum elements to be incorporated in the Vendor Register, upto the extent applicable:

71.3.3.1 Name, office address, factory / warehouse address (where applicable), contact numbers, CNIC / NTN, STRN & PRA registration number.

71.3.3.2 Copy of certificate of incorporation (for privately held companies only).

71.3.3.3 Latest certified / audited financial statements or similar information on the financial reliability of the applicant.

71.3.3.4 General information about the vendor and its products / services, including copies of standards of quality certification (where applicable) for the products / services the vendor wishes to register; and

71.3.3.5 Vendor profile and letter of reference from at least three (3) clients to whom the vendor has provided goods / services over the past twelve (12) months (where applicable).



- 71.3.4 BA shall ensure that the particulars of vendor have been entered in Vendor Register as registered vendor and notify the vendor thereof in writing.
- 71.3.5 BH shall review and ensure periodically that the Vendor Register is being maintained and updated effectively on regular basis. Such review shall be conducted at least once in a calendar year.
- 71.3.6 All original applications, supporting documents for evaluation, correspondence and relevant information shall be retained by the BA.

71.4 PERIODIC EVALUATION OF REGISTERED VENDORS

- 71.4.1 BH shall be responsible for the timely evaluation of vendors. BPC shall perform the periodic evaluation of registered vendors, at least once in two years.
- 71.4.2 The BH shall approve the evaluation of vendors registered, in accordance with the following guidelines:
- 71.4.2.1 Response of vendor to RFQ.
 - 71.4.2.2 Reasonableness of prices quoted.
 - 71.4.2.3 Fulfillment of delivery schedule.
 - 71.4.2.4 Quality and quantity of goods provided / services rendered.
 - 71.4.2.5 Timely response to Branch's requests to rectify discrepancies, and resolve claims.
 - 71.4.2.6 Quality and timeliness of after sales services
 - 71.4.2.7 Adherence to warranty provisions
 - 71.4.2.8 Compliance with other contractual terms and conditions or special requirements.
 - 71.4.2.9 Any significant change from the information provided in the VRA.
 - 71.4.2.10 Direct or indirect involvement in malafide practices as mentioned in **Clause 72.2** of this Manual.
 - 71.4.2.11 Discrepancies pointed out by the end users, if any.

72. BLACKLISTING OR REMOVAL FROM VENDOR DATABASE

- 72.1 Vendors shall be blacklisted based on the facts which lead to financial loss and damage the goodwill / reputation of the Branch/UCS. However, repeated non-compliance of agreed terms and condition may also become a reason of blacklisting of registered vendors.
- 72.2 Following factors may lead to blacklisting or removal of registered vendor:
- 72.2.1 Lack of response or acknowledgement to invitations to submit a quote / bid / inquiry.
 - 72.2.2 Genuine concern about the vendor's ability to satisfactorily perform contractual obligations, such as capability to provide desired quantity of goods or rendering of services in stipulated time.
 - 72.2.3 Providing the goods not in accordance with the specified quality/specification/brand as agreed.



- 72.2.4 Providing the goods of low quality specification of same brand resulting in manipulation of rates.
- 72.2.5 Consistently quoting high prices.
- 72.2.6 Failure to perform in accordance with the terms and conditions of the contract.
- 72.2.7 The vendor is believed to have engaged in criminal activity indicating lack of business integrity or honesty.
- 72.2.8 Abusive, unethical or unprofessional conduct.
- 72.2.9 Indulgence in corrupt and fraudulent practices while obtaining or attempting to obtain a procurement contract e.g. submission of fake quotations.
- 72.2.10 Conviction of fraud, corruption, misappropriation, theft, forgery, bribery or any other criminal offence.
- 72.2.11 Submission of false information.
- 72.2.12 Bankruptcy
- 72.2.13 Any other significant matter.

However, evidence of any of the above factors, should not automatically translate into blacklisting or removal from the Vendor Register. Mitigating factors should be thoroughly considered by BH, prior to recommend blacklisting / removal.

73. PROCUREMENT PLANNING

73.1 ANNUAL PROCUREMENT PLAN (APP)

- 73.1.1 BH shall be responsible for planning of operational expenditure to be incurred in his/her Branch. Time lines of major expenditure such as annual paint work, school functions, extracurricular activities etc. shall be discussed with FO.
- 73.1.2 End users / Requisitioners are responsible for forwarding yearly procurement requirements for their respective domains to the BA/Official designated by the BH.
- 73.1.3 BA/designated Official shall review the requirements and discuss any changes with BH for rationalization.
- 73.1.4 While procurement planning, launching of new classes, requirements of fixed assets etc. shall also be considered and rationalized.
- 73.1.5 BA shall allocate values to the quantities requested for procurement in consultation with other members of BPC, while allocating the values following shall also be considered:
 - Timing of purchase.
 - Rates obtained from registered vendors / market.
 - Existing contract with registered suppliers.
 - Past three (03) years purchase pattern and experience.



- Government legislation.
- Duties and taxes.
- Freight requirements.
- Any other factors requiring consideration in determination of expected cost of budgeted item.

73.1.6 Time required for preparation of RFQ, submission of quotations by vendors, evaluation of quotations, review / approval of submissions and the need for negotiations and drafting of contract, shall also be considered during preparation of APP.

73.1.7 BH shall consider the following factors while reviewing the plan:

- Due planning process has been followed.
- Rates have been properly allocated to different items.
- Accuracy of APP.
- Any other factor which is necessary for effective and efficient budgeting.

73.1.8 The procurement plan shall be approved by the FO.

73.1.9 The APP may be updated semi-annually, if required.



74. PROCUREMENT OF GOODS / SERVICES

74.1 PURCHASE REQUISITION (PR)

- 74.1.1 PR shall be mandatory for procurement transaction of exceeding PKR 5,000.
- 74.1.2 PRs shall be prepared manually.
- 74.1.3 The PR shall explicitly specify the date when the item is required.
- 74.1.4 BH shall approve the PRs upto PKR 10,000/-. PRs of above amount shall be approved by the FO upon BHs recommendation.
- 74.1.5 The format of PR is attached as **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-026)**.

74.2 ISSUANCE OF RFQ

- 74.2.1 Procurement of items having value more than PKR 25,000 require competitive bidding.
- 74.2.2 Members of BPC shall determine the potential recipients of RFQ. BA shall float the RFQ (in accordance with the guidelines provided in following clauses of this section) under intimation to BH. Any exception in this regard shall be approved by the BH.
- 74.2.3 RFQ, generally contain the following information necessary for decision making:
 - Description / specification of services / goods
 - Quantities
 - Delivery time and place
 - Credit terms and mode of payment & discounts
 - Warranty
 - Taxation & Government dues
 - Period of validity of RFQ
 - Inspection and acceptance clauses
 - Timelines
- 74.2.3.1 Specifications / Description of goods
 - Comprehensive description of goods / services with detailed specification and quality requirements provided by the concerned department should be mentioned in the document.
- 74.2.3.2 Delivery time and place

The document shall state the delivery time and place of required goods or services. In case of partial shipments, the delivery time and place of each shipment should be clearly mentioned.
- 74.2.3.3 Credit terms and mode of payment & discounts

The document shall state the credit period, mode of payment, trade discounts and early payment discounts offered by Vendors.
- 74.2.3.4 Inspection clause

The requirement for inspection / pre-inspection shall be included in the documentation and the necessity for such inspection and methods to be used shall be clearly stated.



74.2.3.5 Timelines:

The BA shall state the deadline for receipt of quotations, bids, tenders and opening time in the RFQ.

74.3 CLARIFICATION / AMENDMENT / CANCELLATION OF RFQ

- 74.3.1 Above mentioned requests shall be submitted to BH. BH shall review these and appropriate action shall be obtained with the approval of FO.

74.4 RECEIPT, SAFEGUARDING AND WITHDRAWALS OF SUBMISSIONS

- 74.4.1 Submissions shall be received by BA. BA shall immediately mark time and date on submissions received through courier / hand delivered. Due care shall be taken to ensure that the all submissions (including electronic submissions) can be authenticated, are sufficiently secure and have confidentiality preserved.
- 74.4.2 Submissions received after the last date of RFQ shall be accepted after obtaining approval from the BH. Unaccepted late submissions shall be destroyed or returned to the respective vendor, if so requested.
- 74.4.3 Submission may be withdrawn by a vendor through intimation to BA. BA shall ensure that withdrawn submission is not included in the CSQ and BH shall be intimated immediately.

74.5 COMPARATIVE STATEMENT OF QUOTATIONS (CSQ)

- 74.5.1 After scrutiny of the quotations received against RFQs, the CSQ shall be prepared, checked by the designated Official / BA.
- 74.5.2 Minimum three vendors shall be included in the CSQ. In case of less than three vendors, the exception shall be granted in accordance with **Clause 74.6**.
- 74.5.3 CSQ shall contain necessary information e.g. price, specifications, quantity, delivery time, payment terms, warranty, after sales service etc., as applicable. In case of any change in terms and conditions, as a result of meeting with vendors, the vendor(s) shall be asked to submit revised quotation etc.
- 74.5.4 The comparative items given in the CSQ shall be identical or comparable with each other. Where comparable items are not available, the Official responsible for procurement shall provide the valid reasons for non-availability of comparatives.
- 74.5.5 All Officials responsible for executing procurement shall ensure to avoid following practices:
- 74.5.5.1 Obtaining quotations from group / cartel of related vendors
 - 74.5.5.2 Keeping / demanding blank letterheads from vendors or preparation of invoices / quotations on their behalf
 - 74.5.5.3 Submission of fake / overstated bills
 - 74.5.5.4 Obtaining two (02) / three (03) quotations from the same vendor or his / her related vendors even if they are registered with different names.
- 74.5.6 BH shall provide their recommendations on CSQ and forward it to for approval.



- 74.5.7 Franchisee Management shall review the CSQ and use “Best Value for Money Principle” (**Section 69**) and exercise judgment to select the best suited vendor. The selection of vendor shall be made in writing.
- 74.5.8 The CSQ shall be approved by the FO.
- 74.5.9 The format of CSQ is attached as [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-027\)](#).

74.6 EXCEPTIONS TO QUOTATIONS (LESS THAN THREE QUOTATIONS)

In following cases, general requirement of at least three quotations may be relaxed, however, reasons should be clearly mentioned on CSQ / PO and be evaluated by the authorities at the time of granting approval:

- 74.6.1 In case of certain items, there may be a single source / vendor available for such product e.g.:
- 74.6.1.1 In case of Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM), Sole distributor / authorized agent,
 - 74.6.1.2 Where specific performance is required e.g. hiring of lawyer or artist
 - 74.6.1.3 Where procurement of items / services is mandatorily required from government agencies.
- 74.6.2 Where rates for a particular item are known to be standard throughout the market.
- 74.6.3 In case of repeat orders to same vendors at similar terms as mentioned in CSQ approved by FO within preceding six months.

74.7 ISSUANCE OF PO / WO

- 74.7.1 PO shall be prepared, reviewed and approved by the BA, BH and FO respectively.
- 74.7.2 For the purpose of this Manual the term PO includes Service Order (SO) and Work Order (WO).
- 74.7.3 Terms and conditions mentioned in the PO should be finalized carefully as these supersede the terms and conditions negotiated at earlier stages. In case of significant changes, vendor shall be asked to submit revised quotation or provide explicit acceptance on PO in this regard.
- 74.7.4 PO shall be handed over to the vendor, by the designated Official or BA for vendor's acceptance.
- 74.7.5 Advance, if any, shall be issued by BA, duly approved by BH in accordance with the terms mentioned on PO.
- 74.7.6 All documents pertaining to the procurement and record shall be maintained by the respective BA.
- 74.7.7 The format of PO is attached as [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-028\)](#).



75. SUPPLY OF GOODS

75.1 INSPECTION OF GOODS

- 75.1.1 Post-delivery inspection shall be performed immediately for all goods received. Pre-inspection of goods may be carried out by the designated procurement Official(s) duly authorized by the FO in accordance with terms and conditions agreed with the vendor.
- 75.1.2 Items/assets purchased/delivered shall be handed over to end-users by designated Officials or members of BPC. However, IT equipment shall be received by the BA and inspected by Official having technical knowledge (IT Official). The Official receiving the goods/concerned IT Official shall check / verify that the specifications, quantity and quality of goods received matched with PO / PR.
- 75.1.3 Where required, any other technical expert shall be part of inspection team along with Officials assigned responsibility of inspection. In case of IT and Security equipment inspection shall be conducted by concerned IT and Security/Admin Officials respectively.
- 75.1.4 Inspection comments shall be incorporated in the GRN / PR / Invoice (in accordance with **Clause 75.2**) and duly signed by all Officials involved in the inspection (before obtaining the approval of GRN/Invoice).

75.2 RECEIPT OF GOODS

- 75.2.1 Goods received, inspected and accepted / rejected shall be documented through appropriate document as follows:
- 75.2.1.1 Goods Received Note (GRN) shall be prepared for fixed assets of any value and other items (Opex) having value PKR 25,000 or more whether the purchase of goods comprise of an individual item or bulk items. Specific provisions pertinent to GRN described in **Section 75.3** of this Manual shall also be followed.
- 75.2.1.2 In case of Opex items purchased by Branch having value more than PKR 5,000 but less than PKR 25,000, the acknowledgement of receipt shall be provided on the respective PR.
- 75.2.1.3 In case, where the value of Opex items received is PKR 5,000 or less, the acknowledgement of the goods received may be provided on the invoice / cash memo.
- 75.2.1.4 Goods rejected shall be dealt in accordance with the **Section 75.4** of this Manual.
- 75.2.2 Upon satisfaction, Official(s) responsible for inspection, as mentioned in **Section 75.1** of this Manual, shall deliver the items/assets to end user(s). End-users shall document any discrepancy, found at the time of receipt of items/assets, on GRN / PR / Invoice, as the case may be.



75.3 GOODS RECEIVED NOTE (GRN)

75.3.1 Following Officials shall involve in preparation and approval of GRN:

Prepared By	Checked By	Approved By
BA	BH	FO

75.3.2 In case of IT equipment provided to Branches following procedure shall be followed:

75.3.2.1 The IT equipment shall be delivered to concerned BA.

75.3.2.2 The BA shall inform the concerned IT Official for inspection.

75.3.2.3 The concerned IT Official and BA shall perform the inspection of IT equipment and write comments in "Inspection Remarks" column of the GRN. The GRN shall be approved by the BH.

75.3.2.4 The BA shall retain the Original GRN and handover a copy of it, certified by BH, to the IT Official.

75.3.3 All GRNs shall be sequentially numbered. Branch shall assign serial numbers to manual GRNs starting with Branch code. New serial shall be used for each financial year.

75.3.4 BH shall ensure that the GRN has been prepared within 7 working days of receipt of goods.

75.3.5 Fixed Assets / Items which are required to be recorded in Stock Register, shall be recorded in their respective Stock Registers by the concerned Official(s). The respective stock entry reference (folio number) shall be mentioned on the document upon which the recipient's acknowledgement was obtained (invoice/PR/GRN).

75.3.6 Format of GRN is attached as [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-029\)](#).

75.4 REJECTION / GOODS RETURNED

75.4.1 Defective items or items not in accordance with the specifications given in the PO shall not be accepted and be returned to the vendor. Concerned IT Official / BA shall return the defective goods by stating the rejection factors in writing e.g.:

75.4.1.1 A reference to the PO number;

75.4.1.2 A description of the goods being returned;

75.4.1.3 The value of goods as shown in the PO;

75.4.1.4 Reason(s) for the return of the goods;

75.4.1.5 Additional remarks, if required, to explain the reason for the return of the goods;

75.4.1.6 Instruction to vendor on the action required by the Company i.e. replacement of the returned goods or the issue of an appropriate credit or refund in respect of its value;

75.4.1.7 The transportation method by which the goods are returned to the vendor, and whether the cost is to be borne by the Company or vendor.

75.4.2 A copy of "rejection letter" may be placed in record.



75.5 INVOICE PROCESSING AT BRANCH

- 75.5.1 At least two members of BPC shall sign the PR/Invoice of value exceeding PKR 5,000.
- 75.5.2 BA shall check the approved documents e.g. PR, PO, CSQ, Invoice, GRN (as applicable) and record the accounting entry in the System. BA shall submit the voucher and documents to BH for approval.
- 75.5.3 BH shall review the voucher and documents submitted and upon satisfaction grant approval of the transaction, by signing the voucher. Vouchers having value more than PKR 10,000 shall be approved by the FO.
- 75.5.4 BA may release the payment to vendor after fulfillment of procedure in accordance with policies mentioned in this Manual.

75.6 PAYMENTS

- 75.6.1 All the legitimate payments shall be made through crossed cheques in favour of vendor.
- 75.6.2 Cash purchases can be made for items valuing up to PKR 10,000. However, in case of emergency, the limit for the purposes of cash purchase may be extended with the approval of the BH. Subsequently the same shall be approved by the Franchisee Management.
- 75.6.3 The invoice shall be stamped "PAID" in order to avoid redundant recording of the same in the system.
- 75.6.4 BA shall post the entry after ensuring that the entry has been posted in the correct head of accounts.
- 75.6.5 The procurement shall be made either directly or through issuance of advance to employee, adjustable upon purchase process completion.

76. RECORDKEEPING

- 76.1.1 The procurement related record shall be kept for a minimum period of Ten years.
- 76.1.2 For review by Franchisee Management, a clear trail comprising of record of all core activities shall be maintained by concerned Procurement Officials / BA.

77. EXCEPTIONS TO THIS SECTION OF MANUAL

In special circumstances, FO may approve exceptions to this Manual as the situation may warrant, keeping in view the practical considerations.



SECTION 11:

CONSTRUCTION RENOVATION AND MAINTENANCE (CRM) ACTIVITIES



78. CONSTRUCTION, RENOVATION AND MAINTENANCE (CRM) ACTIVITIES - RECOMMENDED

78.1 OBJECTIVES

- 78.1.1 As a result of increase in students' strength, construction, renovation and maintenance (CRM) of buildings is needed on regular basis.
- 78.1.2 The purpose of this chapter is to:
 - 78.1.2.1 Establish a framework to monitor and/or execute CRM activities.
 - 78.1.2.2 Lay down procedures for efficient & effective management of CRM activities at right value and time.
 - 78.1.2.3 Clarify the principle of segregation of duties, by specifying several distinct functions within overall CRM process.
 - 78.1.2.4 Lay down relevant internal control procedures to verify the selected CRM activities before payment to third parties/contractors.
- 78.1.3 CRM activities exceeding PKR 10,000 shall be approved by the FO.

78.2 BEST VALUE FOR MONEY & ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

- 78.2.1 Best Value for Money Principle

Best Value for Money is one of the general principles that should be given due consideration while carrying out CRM activities. Concerned Officials, especially of Construction/Works department, need to ensure that the best possible outcome has been achieved by taking into account all relevant costs and benefits associated with CRM activities.
- 78.2.2 Ethical Considerations
 - 78.2.2.1 Honesty, fairness, transparency and courtesy are essential qualities that must be evident in negotiations with suppliers and other contractors.
 - 78.2.2.2 Sharing of approved rates with the bidders/vendors is considered as a serious malpractice.
- 78.2.3 Conflict of Interest
 - 78.2.3.1 Any employee of the Branch involved in CRM activities on behalf of the FO must disclose in advance any personal interest, which might impinge on, or might reasonably be deemed by others to impinge on his/her impartiality, in any matter related to his/her duties.
 - 78.2.3.2 All relevant provisions stated in "Conflict of Interest Policy" shall apply on all employees involved in CRM activities.

78.3 SOURCING (SELECTION & REGISTRATION OF CONTRACTORS / VENDORS)

- 78.3.1 Competitive sourcing will help in contractor/vendor selection, continuous evaluation and maintaining a responsive network of vendors to achieve School's objectives.



78.3.2 For day to day repair and maintenance activities, the BPC shall search for suitable contractors / vendors. Sourcing/registration of contractors/vendors for CRM activities shall be made in the same manner as prescribed in “Procurement Activities” section of this Manual.

78.3.3 Processes prescribed for Sourcing i.e. Vendors Registration, Evaluation, Blacklisting etc. prescribed in “Procurement Section” of this Manual shall also be followed for the purposes of CRM activities.

78.4 PROCEDURE FOR ROUTINE REPAIR AND MAINTENANCE ACTIVITIES

78.4.1 Repair & maintenance (R&M) of assets including the school building, paint / polish work shall be carried out when required. The maintenance expenses shall be recorded as Branch’s operational expenses.

78.4.2 Construction/works Officials authorized by FO / UCS Management shall visit the Branch to review the major R&M activities and ensure that premises are being properly maintained.

78.4.3 The BA shall initiate the PR as per the approved budget.

78.4.4 The PR shall be approved as mentioned in the “Procurement Section” of this Manual.

78.4.5 Members BPC shall identify the potential contractors from the Vendors Register.

78.4.6 Quotations are not required to execute R&M activity with a total value of PKR 50,000/- or less.

78.4.7 BA shall forward the RFQ to potential contractors/vendors, if applicable.

78.4.8 RFQs shall be forwarded to potential contractors (minimum of three). Forwarding of RFQs and handling of submissions received shall be dealt in accordance with the provisions mentioned in the “Procurement Section” of this Manual.

78.4.9 CSQ shall be prepared by the BA and signed by the BPC. The BH shall select a suitable contractor and document the reason/basis for selection.

78.4.10 The R&M activity shall be performed under the supervision of BA. The BA may obtain guidance from Construction/Works Officials designated by the FO.

78.4.11 Upon completion of the task, the BA and BPC shall review/check the bill and activity performed and sign the bill upon satisfaction.

78.4.12 The bill and related documents, if any, shall be submitted to BH for review. Upon satisfaction, BH/FO grant approval of the bill & documents.

78.4.13 Entries in books of accounts, payment to vendor shall be dealt with in accordance with applicable financial policies and procedures.



79. CONSTRUCTION, RENOVATION AND MAINTENANCE

79.1 GENERAL - MANDATORY

- 79.1.1 In case of CRM activities, Franchisee owner shall ensure the following:
- 79.1.1.1 CRM activities shall be in accordance with the education standards, color scheme of UCS and as per required matrix of the UCS Management.
 - 79.1.1.2 Franchisee shall ensure the Health and Safety standards.
 - 79.1.1.3 Costs incurred are adequate and in consultation of Construction Department HO.
 - 79.1.1.4 CRM activities have been duly approved from concerned government or development authorities, if required.
- 79.1.2 Any reimbursements or advances to Franchisee shall be in accordance with the Agreement with the Franchisee. Any exception in this regard shall be approved by the UCS Management.

79.2 RESPONSIBILITIES OF ACCOUNTANT AT SITE - RECOMMENDED

- 79.2.1 Site Accountant shall administratively report to the Project Incharge.
- 79.2.2 Contractor shall submit the bill to Accountant at site.
- 79.2.3 Site Accountant shall ensure the following:
- 79.2.4 The bill is:
- 79.2.4.1 Properly signed by the contractor and dated
 - 79.2.4.2 On letter head of contractor
 - 79.2.4.3 In the name of the Company
 - 79.2.4.4 Prepared on proper format (running bill format) duly agreed by the Contractor and concerned Manager Projects
 - 79.2.4.5 All the measurement/quantity sheets are signed by the contractor's representative.
 - 79.2.4.6 Necessary documents are attached.
- 79.2.5 Site Accountant shall be responsible for maintaining imprest sanctioned for the project.
- 79.2.6 Site Accountant shall be responsible to maintain following records relevant to the project:
- 79.2.6.1 Cash payments made and receipts (if any), to be entered in the System.
 - 79.2.6.2 All costs incurred for the project
 - 79.2.6.3 Inventory of materials purchased, issued and materials in hand.
- 79.2.7 Site Accountant shall forward all records to Franchisee Management on fortnightly basis and at completion of the project.



79.3 RESPONSIBILITIES OF SITE ENGINEER - RECOMMENDED

- 79.3.1 Accounts In-charge at site shall hand over the bill to Site Engineer, for checking/verification.
- 79.3.2 The Site Engineer (SE) shall check/verify the following:
- 79.3.2.1 Information of opening work done (work already claimed in previous bills) has been entered correctly.
 - 79.3.2.2 Measurements, quantities, claimed in current bill, are correct.
 - 79.3.2.3 Rates have been charged in accordance with the approved priced BOQ/Estimates/Rate List.
 - 79.3.2.4 Any increase/decrease in rates, is in accordance with the contract.
 - 79.3.2.5 Genuineness and need of Excess / Additional Work (after developing a variation order).
 - 79.3.2.6 Material used, quality and quantity of work done is as per contract, specifications and related documents.
 - 79.3.2.7 Amount on account of utilization of Company resources, by the contractor, has been deducted from the bill e.g. electricity, water at site etc.
- 79.3.3 The SE shall sign measurements, abstracts of cost, quantity sheets & bill after checking/verification and forward the same to the Project Incharge/works.

79.4 RESPONSIBILITIES OF PROJECT INCHARGE - RECOMMENDED

- 79.4.1 Project Incharge shall be responsible for execution/supervision of work at site according to drawings, design and specifications with the help of his/her subordinates. He/she shall also check the quality of work at site by conducting various tests according to engineering practices.
- 79.4.2 In absence of any SE, Project Incharge shall be responsible for the tasks assigned to SE in this Module.
- 79.4.3 Project Incharge shall validate the rates based on current market prices for those items which are not part of BOQ or contract.
- 79.4.4 After checking/verification of the bill, Project Incharge shall sign the bill and forward it to Franchisee Management.
- 79.4.5 FO shall approve the bill and forward it to BA/BH.

79.5 RESPONSIBILITIES OF BRANCH ACCOUNTANT - RECOMMENDED

- 79.5.1 BA shall ensure the accuracy and authenticity of documents based upon relevant controls, especially deduction/adjustment of mobilization advance, retention money, penalty, recovery and withholding tax.
- 79.5.2 Designated Accounts Official shall check and sign the bill and ensure the compliance of policies and procedures. He/she shall also prepare and attach the voucher with the bills.



79.6 PROJECT CLOSE OUT - MANDATORY

- 79.6.1 Project Incharge shall be responsible for activities pertinent to the Project Close Out.
- 79.6.2 Project Incharge shall conduct the final inspection and issue Completion Certificate in consultation with the end user.
- 79.6.3 Where necessary, Project Incharge shall obtain Completion Certificate from relevant legal authorities.

79.7 EQUIPMENT/MATERIAL REGISTER - RECOMMENDED

- 79.7.1 Project Incharge or Site Engineer (if any) shall be responsible to maintain and keep updated record of equipment/material received/issued in connection with CRM activities.
- 79.7.2 A stock register shall be used for this purpose. SE or Manager Projects, as the case may be, shall check and sign the register, periodically.
- 79.7.3 Inward/outward gate passes shall be used for handling construction equipment/material. Internal usage shall be handled vide Issue Requisition.
- 79.7.4 Gate passes shall also be used for personal assets/items brought in by the contractor for construction.
- 79.7.5 A separate stock register shall be maintained for scrap obtained as result of demolition. Its utilization/disposal shall be recorded in the same register.

80. GENERAL GUIDANCE FOR PROCUREMENT - RECOMMENDED

- 80.1.1 Major purchases e.g. cement, iron, tiles, paint material etc. shall preferably be made directly from manufacturer.
- 80.1.2 Procurement of construction related material shall be made by the designated Official designated by FO. Provisions mentioned in Procurement Section of this Manual shall also be followed, as applicable.

81. PAYMENTS & RECORD KEEPING - RECOMMENDED

- 81.1.1 Separate bank accounts shall be opened for certain major projects. This account shall be credited with the amount of advance sanctioned by the Franchisee Management, at different intervals, for that specific project. Signatories to this bank account shall be in accordance with the approval by the FO.
- 81.1.2 All the payments shall be made through crossed cheques.
- 81.1.3 Tax deductions (With-holding Income / Sales tax etc.) as per law, shall be made from payments to third parties, in accordance with the rates prescribed from time to time. Any amount withheld in this regard shall be deposited into Government Treasury or adjusted within the stipulated time.
- 81.1.4 Advances to contractors/vendors, booking of invoice and payments shall be dealt in accordance with the approval provided by the FO.



- 81.1.5 FO may sanction a reasonable amount of imprest upto **PKR 100,000**, for petty cash expenses, to Site Accountant.
- 81.1.5.1 Approving authority (FO) shall also prescribe the list of petty expenses to be incurred from this imprest.
 - 81.1.5.2 Generally, the imprest shall be used to pay petty expenses such as freight, fuel, loading/unloading charges and day to day minor expenses at site.
 - 81.1.5.3 Site Accountant shall not make any direct payment to labor of the sub-contractor/supervisor.
 - 81.1.5.4 Imprest shall be replenished after submission of **paid bills** by the Site Accountant.
- 81.1.6 A clear trail comprising of record of all core activities shall be maintained for each CRM activity.

82. RECORD RETENTION PERIOD

The aforesaid record shall be maintained for at least Ten (10) Years.



SECTION 12: MARKETING



83. INTRODUCTION

83.1 OBJECTIVE & SCOPE

- 83.1.1 The purpose of this document is to lay down the policies and procedures for the Marketing operations of “UCS Franchise network” to ensure alignment of their marketing strategy with the overall brand strategy.
- 83.1.2 This document is applicable to Marketing operations being conducted by UCS staff in the branches.
- 83.1.3 The objective is to develop and implement marketing strategies in consultation with college leadership and other stakeholders, keeping in mind the competition in order to create maximum awareness resulting in positive word of mouth and admissions.
- 83.1.4 Suggest how to create effective and timely branding campaigns and promotions executed.
- 83.1.5 UCS Management (Senior Manager Marketing) shall be responsible for ATL operations all across Pakistan which can be mobilized for the organization’s positive projection of brand.
- 83.1.6 Increase outreach to the students and parents to increase admissions targets. As per present practice the target data will be shared with franchises/branches by UCS Management (Senior Manager Marketing).
- 83.1.7 This Module will cover the following areas:
- Planning & Strategy
 - Execution of Campaigns (Advertisement & Branding)
 - Provision of marketing collateral

84. BRAND - MANDATORY

84.1 GENERAL

- 84.1.1 The Brand Name is United Charter Schools (UCS).
- 84.1.2 The following types of schools operate under the Network:
- Pre Schools
 - Primary Schools
 - Secondary Schools
 - Comprehensive Schools
- 84.1.3 A formal agreement is executed with branches to operate schools under the “United Charter Schools” banner, in accordance with terms and conditions contained in such agreement. These NWAs are ambassadors of the brand name owned by the UCS.
- 84.1.4 The UCS Management (Senior Manager Marketing) is responsible for ATL marketing activities. However, the walk-ins and local marketing activities are responsibilities of the branches.



- 84.1.5 In its objective to increase the student body at the branches, the UCS Management (Senior Manager Marketing) may adopt the following tactics:
- 84.1.5.1 Advertisements in print and electronic media and any other communication channels available.
 - 84.1.5.2 UCS may be encouraged to send their students to participate in various TV programs including programs on current affairs, science etc. Such media appearance will enhance brand awareness and brand image among general public;
 - 84.1.5.3 Creating awareness of UCS brand through organizing various events such as quiz competitions, concerts, ensuring presence of students and faculty at various workshops, seminars and other similar activities. Branches can conduct their own events to increase their brand reach in their locality. Branch Heads shall organize the activity after consultation with Franchise Owner.
 - 84.1.5.4 Execution of digital social media campaigns from UCS Management (Senior Manager Marketing) to generate admission leads for the Branch with their coordination (where required).
 - 84.1.5.5 Community pages at various social networking websites may also be created on the internet to increase awareness of the brand in the public. A main page is created and branches are suggested to repost material from there (<https://www.facebook.com/UnitedCharterSchools>)
A summary of the contributions of the Network towards provision of quality education, building a constructive society, and various facilities provided to the students of the college may be highlighted in such pages. It should be noted that a quality assurance check is done before publishing on social media pages so to make sure that the brand identity is not hampered. Branches will share their contents with marketing department for posting on Official Social Media Pages.
- 84.1.6 UCS Management (Senior Manager Marketing) has developed a document on **Brand Guidelines Annexure (UCS-FSOM-030)**. This document includes details on:
- The Logo, and its usage in different mediums
 - The Color Schemes of UCS Marketing activities
 - Usage, design and style of Branch Boards
 - Usage in Titles
 - Social Media Guidelines
 - Style Guide
- 84.1.7 This document is developed to ensure that all Branches follow a uniform brand and design. All Branch Heads shall have a copy of this document and shall be responsible to maintain the Brand as instructed in it.



85. MARKET RESEARCH - RECOMMENDED

85.1 GENERAL

- 85.1.1 Market Research provides important information for the identification of the target market, assessing target market needs, market size and potential and existing competition. Such information helps an organization in tailoring its overall Marketing Strategy to meet the specific requirements of its target market(s).
- 85.1.2 Market Research is a continuous process and it is suggested to conduct market research at least every two (02) years in consultation with Franchise Owner.
- 85.1.3 Branch Heads reserve the right to exercise judgment whether services of a professionally qualified firm should be procured for conducting the market research. If services of a third party are hired to provide these market research services, a formal agreement shall be executed in this regard, containing the terms and conditions to govern such services.
- 85.1.4 The key steps involved in house market research process are as follows;
- Determining the objectives desired to be achieved from the research
 - Research design
 - Developing research questionnaires
 - Fieldwork or data collection
 - Drafting a report on research findings and facts
 - This process is defined in Flow Charts fig 2.
- 85.1.5 Data collection through market research is normally recorded using questionnaires. Branch Heads may be involved in developing the questionnaires with the marketing agencies keeping in view the objectives to be achieved through the research activity. The questionnaires may be communicated to the intended recipients in any manner that is, through the phone or personally, or through using any other technology available, like email, web form etc. The questions shall be clear and specific to the objectives aimed to be achieved. Efforts shall be made to ensure that the questions are a mixture of:
- Open ended questions requiring a detailed response,
 - Questions which require answers in simple 'yes' and 'no'.
- 85.1.6 Following steps are involved in developing a questionnaire. The exact order may vary somewhat:
- Determine the information being sought.
 - Choose a question type (structure and degree of disguise) and method of administration (for example, written form, email or web form, telephone, interview, verbal interview)
 - Determine the form of response required
 - Choose the exact question wording
 - Arrange the question into an effective sequence



- Specify the physical characteristics of the questionnaire (paper type and size, number of questions per page, layout etc.)
- Test the questionnaire and amend it on the basis of test results.

85.1.7 Field Work or Data Collection shall be made by using **Annexure (UCS-FSOM-031)**

85.1.8 The definition of field work has become broad, with the advent of the advancement in technology in recent times. Field work is associated with any activity involving the collection of data and converting it into information, whether carried out in the field, or one's workstation. Field work involves the following;

- Personal interviews of individuals (in-home, shopping mall intercept, or computer-assisted personal interviewing etc.)
- Personal interviews of focused groups (for example, in classroom)
- Telephone calls made to the selected population from the target market
- Traditional mails or emails
- Desktop research over the internet

85.1.9 The staff collecting the data through field work must have a charismatic personality, in order to ensure that the target audience is left with a pleasant impression about the person and the organization. For reasons explained in the foregoing paragraph, the staff conducting the research should:

- Receive training about personality development and communication skills.
- The staff interacting personally with the target markets should have a presentable personality.
- Staff conducting interviews on the telephone should speak clearly, and in a polite tone. Harsh tones must not be used.
- Staff conducting these activities can reach out to Head office PRO for guidance on how to conduct market research staff training.

85.2 MARKET RESEARCH REPORT

85.2.1 The entire market research project shall be documented in a written report which should address the following;

- Executive summary
- Objectives of the research
- Research approach
- Research design
- Specific research issues identified
- Data collected
- Procedures adopted for data analysis
- The major facts and findings along with appropriate recommendations

85.2.2 Marketing Research report shall be reviewed by Branch Head and explanation shall be sought from researcher(s) if required. The findings shall be presented in the report comprehensively, in a manner to ensure that the decision makers fully



understand the relevant facts and findings, and enable them to make effective and efficient decisions. The post implementation review will be performed by Senior Marketing Manager.

85.3 **SWOT ANALYSIS**

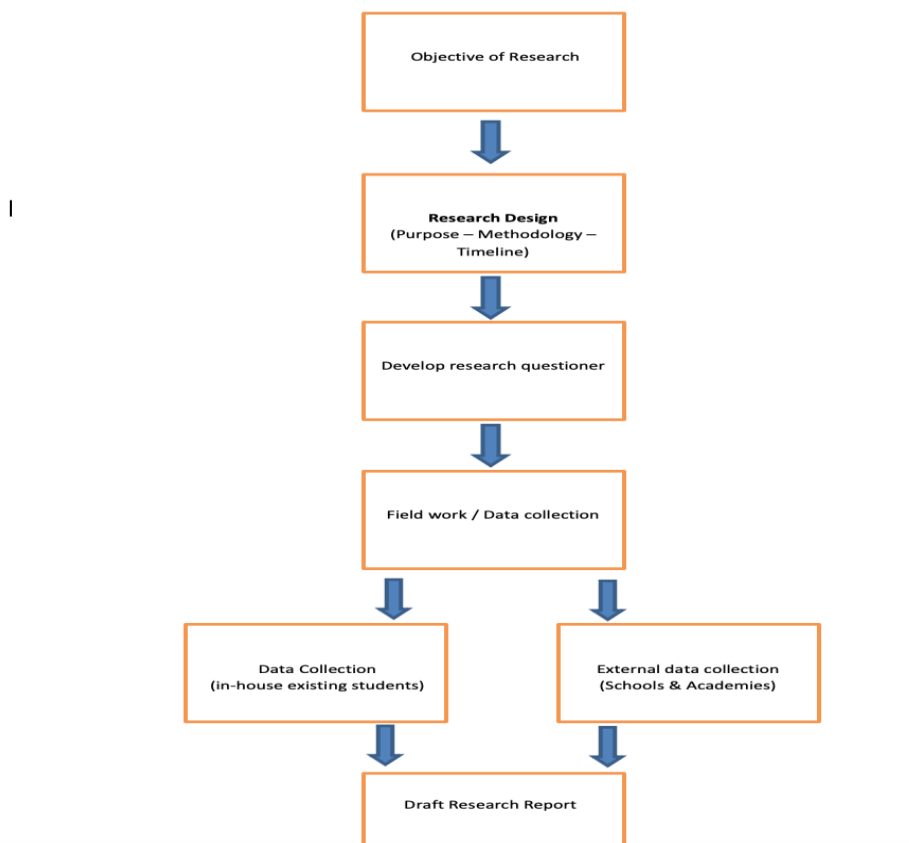
85.3.1 A SWOT Analysis is the foundation of the Strategic Planning process for the Marketing Plan and includes an analysis of both the internal factors (to identify strengths and weaknesses) and external factors (to identify opportunities and threats).

Internal Factors	Strengths	Weaknesses
External Factors	Opportunities	Threats

85.3.2 Once the Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats are determined, prospects of growth shall be identified. These reports are helpful in determining the further process and identifying best practices.

85.4 **FLOW CHART**

Fig 2





86. MARKETING STRATEGY - RECOMMENDED

86.1 MARKETING STRATEGY

- 86.1.1 The Marketing Strategy is a roadmap for a broader and comprehensive action plan. Thus, it should have a reflection of the overall corporate objectives in terms of accomplishing goals and timelines.
- 86.1.2 Care should be taken to ensure that the Marketing Strategy is aligned with the overall organizational objectives. The strategy shall be based upon the following;
- Market size
 - Current and future market opportunities
 - Organizational strengths
 - Difference between our offerings and those of competitors
 - Cost/ benefit considerations
- 86.1.3 Branch Heads and Franchise Owners shall discuss the specific Marketing requirements for their respective Branch for the coming year. Branches can reach out to the UCS marketing team for suggestions.
- 86.1.4 Once the strategy is developed, it will be presented to the relevant Franchise Owner and Senior Marketing Manager for review and suggestion.

86.2 MARKETING PLANNING AND IMPLEMENTATION

- 86.2.1 Planning for Marketing is a continuous process starting from outlining the objectives and targets. The internal objectives and targets set at the branch level should be in line with the desired milestones. Such alignment in objectives shall ensure accomplishment of the objectives at the entity level.
- 86.2.2 Marketing plan objectives shall be in accordance with the SMART approach.
- Specific
 - Measurable
 - Attainable
 - Realistic and relevant
 - Time bound
- 86.2.3 Branch Heads are suggested to formulate annual reports to understand their objectives and milestones. Such a report shall include a comparison of the planned objectives with actual results, including reasons for negative variances.

86.3 STAKEHOLDER ANALYSIS

- 86.3.1 Stakeholder Analysis' is a model for identification of the stakeholders of any organization. A stakeholder is any person or group who has any interest in the organization, direct or indirect. It is an important tool for the management to identify stakeholders in their organization.



86.3.2 The model is used to identify stakeholders and their interests in the organization. The Stakeholder Analysis helps to identify the most important stakeholders, and then formulate a strategy to satisfy the interests of such stakeholders.

86.3.3 The stakeholder analysis should start with the identification of key stakeholders and their business interests. It is essential to determine their influence on the Operations of UCS Franchise Network.

86.4 STEPS IN STAKEHOLDER ANALYSIS

86.4.1 Following shall be considered:

- Identify the stakeholders and their interests.
- Assess the potential impact on the operations of UCS if the interests of identified categories of stakeholders are not satisfied.
- Devise a management strategy for satisfying the interests of the concerned stakeholders.
- Assign responsibilities for implementation of the devised strategies.
- Review, monitor and adapt to actual results on comparison with budgets.

86.4.2 Such analysis forms the basis for developing an appropriate Marketing Strategy and Marketing Plan.

86.4.3 The analysis should be conducted annually. A formal report on the Stakeholder Analysis should be reviewed.

86.5 SITUATION ANALYSIS

86.5.1 The personnel conducting the Situation Analysis should also identify gaps with best industry practices together with their recommendations for removal of such gaps.

86.5.2 The findings of the analysis should be documented in a formal report and presented to UCS Management. These findings shall be considered in development of the Marketing Plan.

86.6 TARGET MARKET

UCS Management Target Market is identified and defined as students and their parents who have given examinations for Matriculation and Intermediate. The Marketing Strategy shall always focus on the satisfaction of the interests of the aforementioned stakeholders. Branches shall adopt the principle:

“Know your customers better know their profile, their likes, dislikes, expectations etc.”

86.7 POSITIONING STRATEGY

86.7.1 Positioning Strategy is an effort by the organization to establish a strong perception in the minds of prospective and existing stakeholders.

86.7.2 Positioning is closely related to market segment focused and involves creating a unique, consistent, and recognized customer perception about UCS programs and brand image.



86.7.3 Information regarding the product positioning may also be obtained from a series of questions:

- Whom are our programs for?
- What is our unique selling proposition?
- Who is our competitor?
- How do we differ from our competitor?
- What are our sustainable competitive advantages?

86.8 MARKETING PLAN

A Marketing Plan is a document providing a road map for the strategy implementation for the accomplishment of the set objectives. It should be an important part of the overall business plan of the Organization.

86.9 PROCEDURES FOR MARKETING PLAN

86.9.1 Goal Setting

- Corporate Objectives
- Mission

86.9.2 Departmental Objectives

- Analyzing the Current Situation
- Stakeholders' Analysis
- Situation Analysis and SWOT Analysis

86.9.3 Developing the marketing Strategy

- Marketing strategy and action plan in line with agreed objectives

86.9.4 Resource Allocation and Monitoring

- Marketing Budget
- Detailed Marketing Plan

86.10 CAMPAIGN TIMELINES

Campaign timelines have been described in [Annexure \(UCS-FSOM-032\)](#).



87. MARKETING OPERATIONS

87.1 GENERAL

87.1.1 Normally the Branches Marketing Budget will be covering the following activities:

- Public relations, including meeting expenses
- Printing
- Mailing
- Brochure/ leaflet design cost
- Advertising
- Cable advertising
- Radio advertising
- Social media advertising
- Hoardings
- Event organization cost

87.1.2 Branch Head shall compile and monitor financial expenditure

88. MARKETING TACTICS - RECOMMENDED

88.1 ADVERTISING AND MARKETING COMMUNICATIONS

88.1.1 An advertising and marketing communications strategy should support the marketing plan.

88.1.2 Advertising may be through any of the electronic, print and Digital media options available to UCS, and other communication modes available.

88.1.3 UCS should focus on heavy advertisement campaigns in the months preceding the admission period. They should focus on both 'above the line' and 'below the line' advertising activities.

88.1.4 Above the line advertisement is advertising in any kind of print or electronic media whereas below the line marketing is related to out of home advertising activity.

88.1.5 The advertising and communication team should consider the following elements while running an advertising campaign.

88.1.5.1 The marketing team responsible for advertising and communication must be aware of UCS brand, as it is now and where the management wants to take it in future (as per organizational goals, objectives and vision). It includes corporate branding including brand relationships, improving the brand image and advertising of the brand.

88.1.5.2 The marketing team must be aware of the positioning of the brand in the minds of the targeted population. They should be aware about where the Company wants the product to be positioned (as per organizational goals, objectives and vision). How the UCS brand is positioned is the most important aspect of a marketing communications plan.



- 88.1.5.3 Marketing people should be able to assess the Psycho-Dynamics of the market (people/ target market/ potential customers). Also, demographics of the market (area, population, income bracket, gender, etc.) should be addressed through marketing efforts.
- 88.1.5.4 Marketing team must be aware of exactly what they want the advertising campaign to accomplish. An impact analysis should be conducted immediately after the advertising campaign. A formal analytical report must be presented to Senior Manager Marketing for review.
- 88.1.5.5 Sr. Manager marketing should delegate the responsibility to develop a formal advertising and communication plan for every quarter. The plan should be reviewed and discussed with UCS Management.
- 88.1.5.6 The advertisements carried out must be standardised across all the locations. A uniform message should be conveyed by all marketing communications. *There must be a “thematic harmony in all the communication channels used to run a campaign.*
- 88.1.5.7 If a TV advertisement carries a particular logo, images and message, all newspaper adverts, point-of-sale materials (mobiles, buntings, calendars, charts etc.), E- marketing etc. should carry the same logo, images or message, or one that fits the same theme.
- 88.1.5.8 A communication policy should be formalized and established which should be duly approved by the Project Head of UCS after reviewed by Senior Manager Marketing.

88.2 STUDENT FACILITATION PROJECTS

88.2.1 Developing partnership with various renowned brands:

- 88.2.1.1 Organizing various events by UCS such as quiz competitions, entertainment gatherings such as bonfires, concerts, and debate competitions etc. would not only develop creativity among our students but also enhance the brand value of UCS.
- 88.2.1.2 Organizers should also engage the parents of students to the maximum extent because they would be aware of our efforts. This would serve the purpose of enhancing our brand image through positive word of mouth. The parents can be engaged through mailing to them pamphlets and leaflets regarding the marketing efforts being made by the Company. Moreover, the teachers at the NWA schools should have knowledge of the marketing campaigns, and they should communicate the same to parents at the parent-teacher meetings arranged.
- 88.2.1.3 The marketing function should try to develop partnerships with various renowned brands and seek to obtain their sponsorship. Such efforts would not only reduce the cost of these events to our entity but their association with us would add value to our brands.



SECTION 13:

DOCUMENT APPROVAL



Beaconhouse Group
Franchise School Operations Manual

Doc No: UCS-FSOM
Rev: 00
Date: 01-01-2022

89. APPROVAL

	Signature	Date
Deputy Director – UCS		
Director S&A		



SECTION 14:

LIST OF ANNEXURES



90. LIST OF ANNEXURES

Sr. No.	Title	Annexure Reference
1	Registration Receipt - System generated	UCS-FSOM-001
2	Student File Check List	UCS-FSOM-002
3	Leave Application For Students	UCS-FSOM-003
4	Withdrawal Order - System generated	UCS-FSOM-004
5	Withdrawal and Security Refund Form - System generated	UCS-FSOM-005
6	Record Change Form - Google Form	UCS-FSOM-006
7	Class Room Observation Form	UCS-FSOM-007
8	Disciplinary Actions associated with infractions	UCS-FSOM-008
9	Template for Recording Bullying Behaviour	UCS-FSOM-009
10	Medical history form.	UCS-FSOM-010
11	Parental permission (consent) for medication administration	UCS-FSOM-011
12	Parental permission (consent) for administration of off-the-counter medicines	UCS-FSOM-012
13	Parental Permission (consent) for medical treatment and emergency transportation	UCS-FSOM-013
14	Consequences of Misuse of Telecommunication Devices	UCS-FSOM-014
15	Interview Evaluation Form - Executive, Admin, Non-Teaching Staff	UCS-FSOM-015
16	Interview Evaluation Form - Teaching Staff	UCS-FSOM-016
17	Employee Reference Check form	UCS-FSOM-017
18	Security Reference Check Form (For All Cadre)	UCS-FSOM-018
19	Personal Information Form(Executive, Admin, Office Staff)	UCS-FSOM-019
20	Joining Report (For All Cadre)	UCS-FSOM-020
21	Exit Interview Form (Executive, Admin Staff)	UCS-FSOM-021
22	Probation Evaluation Form	UCS-FSOM-022
23	Leave Application For Teacher	UCS-FSOM-023
24	Conveyance Form	UCS-FSOM-024



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Sr. No.	Title	Annexure Reference
25	Certificate to Compliance with Company Policies & Procedures	UCS-FSOM-025
26	Purchase Requisition – Manual	UCS-FSOM-026
27	Comparative Statement of Quotations	UCS-FSOM-027
28	Purchase Order – Manual	UCS-FSOM-028
29	Goods Received Note - Manual	UCS-FSOM-029
30	Brand Guidelines	UCS-FSOM-030
31	Questionnaire Template	UCS-FSOM-031
32	Campaign timelines	UCS-FSOM-032

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